HT NEW DELHI

Wednesday, October 21, 2026

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Silent shareholders hold the key to Tata Motors' Iveco deal ▶P1

'Free cash flow to fuel growth, create value for Jio investors' ▶P1

THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA.
INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY

BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON(1): FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

HT NEW DELHI

Wednesday, October 21, 2026

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India Inc braces for muted salary hikes in 2027 ▶P1

Govt to overhaul tax refund schemes for exporters ▶P1

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PARAS HEALTH
Partners In Health

PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

(Please scan the QR Code to view the RHP and the Abridged Prospectus)

Our Company was incorporated as 'Arbian Frozen Foods Private Limited', a private limited company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated December 21, 1987, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi & Haryana, at New Delhi. Our Company became a deemed public company as per Section 43A(1)(a) of the Companies Act, 1956 with effect from July 1, 1993, consequent to which its name was changed to "Arbian Frozen Foods Limited", by deletion of the word 'Private'. Consequent to the amendment in Section 43A(2)(a) of the Companies Act, 1956 by the Companies (Amendment) Act, 2000, our Company was re-converted from a deemed public company to a private limited company and the name of our Company was changed to 'Arbian Frozen Foods Private Limited' and the certificate of incorporation consequent to the change in name of our Company was endorsed by the Registrar of Companies, NCT of Delhi & Haryana, at New Delhi on June 16, 2003. Subsequently, pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board on June 19, 2003 and by our Shareholders on July 9, 2003, the name of our Company was changed from 'Arbian Frozen Foods Private Limited' to 'Paras Healthcare Private Limited' to reflect the change in its business activity from frozen foods to healthcare services and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent to the change in name of our Company was issued by the Registrar of Companies, NCT of Delhi & Haryana, at New Delhi on July 21, 2003. Our Company was subsequently converted from a private company to a public company, pursuant to resolutions passed by our Board on June 3, 2024 and by our Shareholders dated June 4, 2024, consequent to which its name was changed to "Paras Healthcare Limited.", and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon conversion to public limited company was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on July 18, 2024. Subsequently, pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board and Shareholders on July 31, 2025 and September 5, 2025, respectively, the name of our Company was changed from "Paras Healthcare Limited." to "Paras Healthcare Limited", and a fresh certificate of incorporation was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on September 29, 2025. For details of changes in our name and registered office, see "***History and Certain Corporate Matters***" on page 318 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 ("Red Herring Prospectus" or "RHP").

Corporate Identity Number: U85110HR1987PLC035823
Registered and Corporate Office: 1st Floor, Tower B, Paras Twin Towers, Golf Course Road, Sector 54, Gurugram – 122 002, Haryana, India
Contact Person: Rahul Kumar, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, **Telephone:** +91 124 430 2163, **Email:** cs@parashospitals.com, **Website:** www.parashospitals.com

OUR PROMOTER: DR. DHARMINDER KUMAR NAGAR

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH OF PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED (THE "COMPANY" OR THE "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹14,500.00 MILLION (THE "OFFER") COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹5,000.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH ("OFFERED SHARES") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹9,500.00 MILLION, COMPRISING UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹3,000.00 MILLION BY DR. DHARMINDER KUMAR NAGAR (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER") AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹6,500.00 MILLION BY COMMELINA LTD (THE "INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDER", AND TOGETHER WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS") (SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THE OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION

NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH OFFERED / AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
Dr. Dharminder Kumar Nagar	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹3,000.00 million	2.35
Commelina Ltd	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹6,500.00 million	114.15

*****As certified by Suri & Sudhir, Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026.*

PRICE BAND: ₹660 TO ₹693 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 660 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 693 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 21 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 21 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS (1.14)%.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 159.68 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 152.07 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO OF 67.81 TIMES.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹660 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹693 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	7,575,757	5,000.00	7,215,007	5,000.00
Offer for Sale	14,393,938	9,500.00	13,708,513	9,500.00
Total Offer Size	**21,969,695**	**14,500.00**	**20,923,520**	**14,500.00**
Post Offer Market Cap	**108,561,944**	**71,650.88**	**108,201,194**	**74,983.43**

BID/OFFER PERIOD

BID/OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON: FRIDAY, 23 OCTOBER, 2026#

#UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date.

We are a clinical specialty-led hospital platform providing tertiary and quaternary healthcare services through a network of eight hospitals with an aggregate bed capacity of 2,211 beds as of June 30, 2026 across North India, Bihar and Jharkhand. We operate under the "Paras Health" brand, with a presence in five states and one union territory - Gurugram and Panchkula in Haryana; Patna and Darbhanga in Bihar; Kanpur in Uttar Pradesh; Udaipur in Rajasthan; Ranchi in Jharkhand; and Srinagar in the union territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(2) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS. | THE EQUITY SHARES WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 75% OF THE OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL BIDDERS PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 15% OF THE OFFER | RETAIL INDIVIDUAL BIDDERS PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 10% OF THE OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS ("BRLMs").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THE RESOLUTION DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/KPIS DISCLOSED IN THE *"BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE"* SECTION ON PAGE 140 OF THE RHP VIS-A-VIS THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S) AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN THE *"BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE"* ON PAGE 140 OF THE RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For further details please see "Risk Factors" beginning on page 21 of the RHP.

1. **Losses in the recent past:** Our Company has incurred losses during the three months period ended June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2025 and 2024 of ₹(10.24) million, ₹(579.83) million and ₹(153.31) million, respectively, on a consolidated basis. While we were profitable in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscal 2026, we cannot assure you that we will continue to remain profitable in the future. Further, in each of the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2025 and 2024, our Company had the lowest RoCE and RoE and the highest debt to equity ratio in comparison to our peers listed in India.
2. **Losses incurred by our Subsidiaries:** Our Subsidiaries, Paras Healthcare (Ranchi) Private Limited and Plus Medicare Hospitals Private Limited have collectively incurred a loss of ₹(203.82) million, ₹(520.89) million, ₹(822.38) million and ₹(872.69) million during the three months period ended June 30, 2025 and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. We cannot assure you that these Subsidiaries will turn profitable in the future.
3. **High dependence on employees**: We are highly dependent on doctors, nurses, other healthcare professionals and housekeeping and support staff for our operations. As of June 30, 2026, we had a team of 5,315 medical professionals and support staff, comprising 1,084 doctors (of which 940 doctors are resident medical officers and consultants and 144 doctors are visiting doctors), 1,937 nurses and 2,294 other personnel (including other healthcare professionals and housekeeping and support staff). We have experienced high attrition rates of 12.01%, 16.09%, 60.38%, 66.74% and 65.27% in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. If we are unable to reduce or manage the attrition rates of these professionals, our business, results of operations and financial condition may be adversely affected.
4. **Concentration in North India:** Five of our eight hospitals are located in North India, which include our hospitals in Gurugram and Panchkula in Haryana, Udaipur in Rajasthan, Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir, and Kanpur in Uttar Pradesh. Any disruption, loss of business or adverse developments affecting one or more of our hospitals located in North India, or the regions in which they are located, could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations and financial condition. The table below sets forth details of the revenue from operations generated from each of our hospitals in North India for the periods / years indicated:

Hospitals	Revenue from operations									
	Three months period ended June 30, 2026		Three months period ended June 30, 2025		Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%
Our hospitals in North India (A)	3,200.95	68.07%	2,464.02	66.89%	10,609.74	66.07%	8,851.95	68.40%	7,601.32	67.33%
Our hospitals outside North India (B)	1,501.83	31.93%	1,219.85	33.11%	5,449.78	33.93%	4,088.68	31.60%	3,689.07	32.67%
Total (A+B)	**4,702.78**	**100.00%**	**3,683.87**	**100.00%**	**16,059.52**	**100.00%**	**12,940.63**	**100.00%**	**11,290.39**	**100.00%**

5. **Wilful Defaulter**: The name of one of the members of our Promoter Group, Harbaksh Singh Khangura appears in the CIBIL wilful defaulter database in relation to defaults reported in 2014 against a company where he served as a director until November 30, 2013. While our Promoter Group member has confirmed that he has not been associated with the affairs of such company since November 30, 2013, had no involvement in its affairs thereafter, has not received any communication declaring him a defaulter or a wilful defaulter and has formally written to CIBIL Transunion and the lenders requesting removal of his name from the defaulter database, we cannot assure you that his name will be removed from the CIBIL defaulter database or that he will not be subject to any adverse proceedings or rulings in the future.
6. **Dependence on cardiac sciences, oncology sciences, neuro sciences, gastro sciences, orthopedics and sports injury and renal sciences (collectively, "CONGOR") specialties:** We generate a significant portion of our revenue from the provision of CONGOR specialties at our hospitals, which contributed 74.35%, 75.30%, 74.70%, 71.92% and 72.34% of our revenue from operations in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any adverse developments in the demand for such services could adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition.
7. **High Costs**: The provision of healthcare services involves high costs such as employee benefit expenses, retainers and consultants fee and purchases of stock-in-trade, which together accounted for 66.13%, 64.40%, 65.08%, 63.69% and 66.95% of our total expenses in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. In the past, we have been unable to pass on the increase in our costs to our patients, which has impacted our revenue from operations and profitability. If our costs increase in the future and we are unable to pass them on to our patients, or if we are unable to grow our revenue in line with our costs, our business, results of operations and financial condition may be adversely affected.
8. **6 out of our 8 hospitals are located on leased premises**: We operate 6 of our 8 hospitals on leased premises and these six hospitals collectively contributed to 61.32%, 58.41%, 60.53%, 55.75% and 55.11% of our revenue from operations in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025, and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. In addition, except for our Registered and Corporate Office, our Gurugram Hospital and our Udaipur Hospital (which is owned by our wholly-owned Subsidiary, PMHPL and leased to our Company), all of our hospitals are located on land that we have leased from third parties. Accordingly, our ability to continue to operate a substantial portion of our hospital network is dependent on the continuation and renewal of our arrangements with lessors and other counterparties.
9. **High contingent liabilities:** The table below summarises our contingent liabilities, along with as a percentage of our net worth, as at the dates indicated:

Particulars	Contingent Liabilities									
	As at June 30, 2026		As at June 30, 2025		As at March 31, 2026		As at March 31, 2025		As at March 31, 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth
Total Contingent Liabilities	3,984.42	89.55%	3,403.15	97.60%	3,905.01	98.88%	3,795.90	135.33%	2,886.23	85.26%

A significant portion of contingent liabilities (₹2,986.17 million as of June 30, 2026), as set out above, pertained to the corporate guarantee issued by our Subsidiary, PMHPL, which is in the nature of secondary collateral security in respect of certain credit facilities availed by our Company from HDFC Bank Limited, comprising term loan and cash credit facilities. The corporate guarantee is available to the lender only as an additional secondary security and is enforceable only after the lender has recourse to the primary security package created in respect of the relevant credit facilities. Subsequent to June 30, 2026 and pursuant to the revised sanction letters issued by HDFC Bank Limited dated July 25, 2026 and August 7, 2026 in respect of PMHPL and our Company, respectively, the corporate guarantees provided by our Company on behalf of PMHPL aggregating to ₹319.37 million, and the guarantee issued by PMHPL on behalf of our Company aggregating to ₹2,986.17 million as on June 30, 2026, have been waived by HDFC Bank Limited in accordance with the revised sanction terms.

10. **Outstanding litigations**: There are certain outstanding legal proceedings involving us that are pending at different levels of adjudication before various courts, tribunals and other authorities. Such proceedings could divert our management's time and attention and consume financial resources in their defence or prosecution. Any unfavourable decision in connection with such proceedings, individually or in the aggregate, could adversely affect our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. **The details of Price/Earnings, Earnings per share, Return on Net Worth, Net Asset Value Per Equity Share, Enterprise Value (EV)/ EBITDA Ratio for our Company and peer group for Fiscal 2026 are as below:**

Name of the company	Revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	Face value per equity share (₹)	P/E ratio (on Cap Price)	Enterprise Value (EV)/ EBITDA Ratio (At Cap Price)	EPS (Basic) (₹ per share)	EPS (Diluted) (₹ per share)	Net Worth	Return on Net Worth (%)	Net Asset Value per Equity Share (₹)
Our Company (Paras Healthcare Limited)	16,059.52	1	159.68	24.11	4.34	4.34	3,949.41	12.98%	39.11
Listed Peers									
Aster DM Quality Care Limited	46,432.20	10	91.89	40.73	7.53	7.52	45,758.60	9.70%	88.32
Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Limited ("**AHEL**")	252,285.00	5	59.36	32.59	135.04	134.94	94,801.00	21.95%	657.58
Fortis Healthcare Limited ("**FHL**")	91,278.40	10	55.43	28.88	13.80	13.80	98,955.50	11.08%	131.07
Global Health Limited ("**GHL**")	44,103.00	2	64.46	34.03	20.71	20.66	39,615.70	15.15%	147.06
Jupiter Lifeline Hospitals Limited ("**JLHL**")	14,997.87	2	42.92	25.79	5.92	5.92	15,440.84	13.41%	47.10
Krishna Institute of Medical Sciences Limited ("**KIMS**")	39,046.00	2	116.41	40.64	6.03	6.03	22,474.00	11.01%	56.17
Manipal Health Enterprises Limited	109,356.00	2	87.00	36.89	7.71	7.67	84,261.30	12.37%	63.26
Max Healthcare Institute Limited	100,650.00	10	62.10	35.69	14.83	14.76	107,466.30	14.33%	109.53
Narayana Hrudayalaya Limited	78,960.35	10	43.41	22.67	39.67	39.67	45,372.58	19.74%	222.02
Yatharth Hospital and Trauma Care Services Limited	12,071.72	10	55.16	33.12	18.20	18.20	17,805.62	10.36%	184.79
		Average of Listed Peers	**67.81**	**33.10**					

12. **Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is negative and is (1.14%) on restated and consolidated basis**
13. **Average Cost of Acquisition for our Promoter (who is also a Selling Shareholder) and the Investor Selling Shareholder:**

S. No.	Name of the Selling Shareholder	Number of Equity Shares held	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹)
1.	Dr. Dharminder Kumar Nagar (Promoter Selling Shareholder)	73,519,238	2.35
2.	Commelina Ltd (Investor Selling Shareholder)	16,604,375	114.15

14. **Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares:** The weighted average cost of acquisition of all shares transacted in last one year and the three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is set out below:

Period	Weighted average cost of acquisition (WACA) *(in ₹)*	Upper end of the Price Band is 'X' times the WACA	Range of acquisition price: Lowest price – Highest price *(in ₹)*
Last one year	Not Applicable#	Not Applicable#	Not Applicable#
Last three years	43.15	16.06	Nil - ₹237.00

 # There were no transactions in the last one year.

15. **Weighted average cost of acquisition, Floor Price and Cap Price**

The Floor Price is 2.78 times and the Cap Price is 2.92 times the weighted average cost of acquisition based on the last five primary and secondary

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transactions as disclosed below:

Types of transactions	Weighted average cost of acquisition (₹ per Equity Share)#	No. of times at Floor price (i.e. ₹ 660)	No. of times at Cap price (i.e. ₹ 693)
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Primary Issuances	NA	NA	NA
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Secondary Transactions	NA	NA	NA
Since there were no primary or secondary transactions of securities during the 18 months prior to the date of the RHP to report under 1 or 2 above, the information for price per share of the Company based on the last five primary or secondary transactions where the Promoter/members of the Promoter Group, Selling Shareholders or Shareholder(s) having the right to nominate director(s) on the Board of the Company, are a party to the transaction, during the three years prior to the date of the RHP irrespective of the size of the transaction, has been disclosed below.			
(a) Based on primary issuances	237.00	2.78	2.92
(b) Based on secondary transactions	237.00	2.78	2.92

 # As certified by Suri & Sudhir, Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026.

16. **Performance of BRLMs' Past Issues**: The 3 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 83 public issues in the past three years, out of which 25 issues closed below the IPO price on listing date:

Name of BRLM	Total Issues	Issues closed below IPO price on listing date
JM Financial Limited	44	14
BofA Securities India Limited	4	0
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited	19	7
Common issues of above BRLMs*	16	4
Total	**83**	**25**

** Issues handled where there are common BRLMs.*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. Pre-IPO Placement - In the Draft Red Herring Prospectus, our Company had provided for a further issue of specified securities as may be permitted in accordance with applicable law to any person(s), for an amount aggregating up to ₹1,000.00 million prior to filing of the Red Herring Prospectus. However, our Company has not undertaken and does not propose to undertake a Pre-IPO Placement.
2. There have been no other transactions of shares aggregating to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company by our Promoter and Promoter Group from the DRHP filing date.
3. The aggregate pre-Offer and post-Offer shareholding, of each of our Promoter, members of our Promoter Group, and additional top 10 Shareholders (apart from Promoter and Promoter Group), is set forth below:

S. No.	Name	Pre-Offer shareholding as at the date of the Price Band Advertisement		Post-Offer shareholding as at the date of Allotment[1]			
				At the lower end of the Price Band (₹660 per Equity Share)		At the upper end of the Price Band (₹693 per Equity Share)	
		No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Percentage of total pre-Offer paid up Equity Share capital (%)	No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Percentage of total post-Offer paid up Equity Share capital	No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Percentage of total post-Offer paid up Equity Share capital
Promoter Selling Shareholder							
1	Dr. Dharminder Kumar Nagar	73,519,238	72.80%	68,973,784	63.53%	69,190,234	63.95%
Sub-total (A)		**73,519,238**	**72.80%**	**68,973,784**	**63.53%**	**69,190,234**	**63.95%**
Promoter Group (other than our Promoter)							
1.	Gurdeep Kaur Nagar	1	Negligible	1	Negligible	1	Negligible
2.	Ranya Nagar	1	Negligible	1	Negligible	1	Negligible
Sub-total (B)		**2**	**Negligible**	**2**	**Negligible**	**2**	**Negligible**
Public Shareholders (top 10 Shareholders) (other than our Promoter and Promoter Group)							
1.	Commelina Ltd	16,604,375	16.44%	6,755,891	6.22%	7,224,866	6.68%
2.	360 ONE Special Opportunities Fund - Series 12	5,147,679	5.10%	5,147,679	4.74%	5,147,679	4.76%
3.	Axis New Opportunities AIF - Series II	3,668,439	3.63%	3,668,439	3.38%	3,668,439	3.39%
4.	360 ONE Special Opportunities Fund - Series 13	1,286,920	1.27%	1,286,920	1.19%	1,286,920	1.19%
5.	360 ONE Special Opportunities Fund - Series 11	421,941	0.42%	421,941	0.39%	421,941	0.39%
6.	360 One Equity Opportunity Fund - Series 4	210,970	0.21%	210,970	0.19%	210,970	0.19%
7.	360 One Private Equity Fund - Series 2	126,583	0.13%	126,583	0.12%	126,583	0.12%
8.	Kapil Garg	20	Negligible	20	Negligible	20	Negligible
9.	Vikas Kumar Kansal	19	Negligible	19	Negligible	19	Negligible
10.	Jalaja Divakaran Sunil	1	Negligible	1	Negligible	1	Negligible
Sub-total (C)		**27,466,947**	**27.20%**	**17,618,463**	**16.23%**	**18,087,438**	**16.72%**
Other Public Shareholders							
Sub-total (D)		**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**
Total (A+B+C+D)		**100,986,187**	**100.00%**	**86,592,249**	**79.76%**	**87,277,674**	**80.66%**

[1] Assuming full subscription in the Offer. The post-Offer shareholding details as at Allotment will be based on the actual subscription and the Offer Price and updated in the Prospectus, subject to finalization of the Basis of Allotment.
Also, the above table assumes there is no transfer of shares by these shareholders between the date of the advertisement and allotment (if any such transfers occur prior to the date of Prospectus, it will be updated in the shareholding pattern in the Prospectus).

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of JM Financial Limited

*The **"Basis for Offer Price"** section on page 140 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com for the **"Basis for Offer Price"** updated with the above price band.*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids	
Bid/ Offer Programme	
EVENT	**INDICATIVE DATE**
ANCHOR INVESTOR BID/OFFER PERIOD OPENED AND CLOSED ON	Monday, 19 October, 2026
BID/OFFER OPENS ON	Wednesday, 21 October, 2026
BID/OFFER CLOSES ON	Friday, 23 October, 2026[1]
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	Monday, 26 October, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA*	Tuesday, 27 October, 2026
Allotment of Equity Shares/ Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	Tuesday, 27 October, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	Wednesday, 28 October, 2026

Note:

[1] UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Offer BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, as partially modified by the T+3 notification and SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of our Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation in accordance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular and any subsequent circulars or notifications issued by SEBI in this regard.*

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. Indian Standard Time (**"IST"**)
Bid/Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIBs other than QIBs and NIIs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 05:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their Bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their Bids.

ASBA# Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

#ASBA (defined above) is a better way of applying to Issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT Notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "***Offer Procedure***" on page 539 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes &intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll-free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES

In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid / Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Banks, as applicable.

This is an Offer in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in compliance with Regulation 6(2) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein at least 75% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**" and such portion, the "**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis, in accordance with SEBI ICDR Regulations (the "**Anchor Investor Portion**"), out of which 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as follows: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% shall be available for allocation to Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds and Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the price at which allocation will be made to Anchor Investors ("**Anchor Investor Allocation Price**"), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations and any under-subscription of 6.67% of the Anchor Investor Portion reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the remaining QIB Portion (the "**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIB Bidders including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. If at least 75% of the Offer cannot be Allotted to QIBs, then the entire application money will be refunded forthwith. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not more than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders ("**NIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations of which (a) one-third portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹200,000 and up to ₹1,000,000; and (b) two-thirds portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹1,000,000, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price and not more than 10% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (defined hereinafter) in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism, in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or by the Sponsor Banks, as applicable under the UPI Mechanism, to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see "***Offer Procedure***" on page 539 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN , UPI ID and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, investors are requested to see "***History and Certain Corporate Matters***" on page 318 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see "***Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection***" on page 633 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of Share Capital of our Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorized share capital of our Company is ₹125,000,000 comprising of 125,000,000 Equity Shares of face value ₹1 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of our Company is ₹100,986,187 comprising 100,986,187 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each. For details of the capital structure of our Company, see "***Capital Structure***" on page 101 of the RHP.

Names of the Initial Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company along with their allotment are: 10 Equity Shares each to Sunil Kapur, Ashok Narang, Veena Chandok, G. K. Sahni and Shailendra Chandok. For details of the share capital history and capital structure of our Company see "***Capital Structure***" on page 101 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares to be Allotted through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 20, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see *"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"* beginning on page 633 of the RHP. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been, and a signed copy of the Prospectus shall be, delivered to the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013, respectively.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the draft offer document and this does not constitute approval of either the issue or the specified securities stated in the Offer document. The investors are advised to refer to page 512 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of the SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of the NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 515 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of the BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by the BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 515 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the Risk Factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 21 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS			REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
JM Financial Limited 7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai – 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 3030 **E-mail:** parashealthcare.ipo@jmfl.com **Investor Grievance ID:** grievance.ibd@jmfl.com **Website:** www.jmfl.com **Contact person:** Prachee Dhuri **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000010361	**BofA Securities India Limited** Ground Floor, A Wing, One BKC, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 8000 **E-mail:** dg.parashealth_ipo@bofa.com **Investor Grievance ID:** dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com **Website:** https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india **Contact person:** Sayantan Bhattacharyya **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000011625	**Nuvama Wealth Management Limited** 801-804, Wing A, Building No. 3, Inspire BKC, G Block Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai – 400 051, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 **E-mail:** parashealthcare.ipo@nuvama.com **Investor Grievance ID:** customerservice.mb@nuvama.com **Website:** www.nuvama.com **Contact person**: Pari Vaya **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000013004	**MUFG Intime India Private Limited** ***(Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited)*** C-101, Embassy 247 Park, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West) Mumbai 400 083, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 810 811 4949 **E-mail:** parashealthcare.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Investor Grievance ID:** parashealthcare.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Website:** www.in.mpms.mufg.com **Contact person:** Shanti Gopalkrishnan **SEBI Registration No.:** INR000004058	**Rahul Kumar** 1st Floor, Tower B, Paras Twin Towers, Golf Course Road, Sector 54, Gurugram – 122 002, Haryana, India, **Tel:** +91 124 430 2163 **E-mail:** cs@parashospitals.com Bidders may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any Pre-Offer or Post-Offer related problems, such as non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF RHP: Investors should note that Investment in Equity Shares involves a high degree of risk and investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the Risk Factors contained herein, before applying in the Offer. Full copy of the RHP is available at the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, the website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, the website of our Company at www.parashospitals.com and the website of BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, BofA Securities India Limited and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus is available on the website of our Company at www.parashospitals.com, the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, BofA Securities India Limited and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Application forms can be obtained from the Registered Office of **Paras Healthcare Limited, Tel**: +91 124 430 2163 and the **BRLMs – JM Financial Limited**, **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 3030, **BofA Securities India Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6630 8000 and **Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 and **Syndicate Members: JM Financial Services Limited**, **Telephone:** + 91 22 6136 3400, **Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. ASBA has to be availed by all the investors. For details on ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to "***Offer Procedure***" on page 539 of the RHP. Further ASBA Application forms can be obtained from Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of banks that are available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and the websites of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The investors are required to fill the Bid Cum Application form and submit the same to the relevant SCSBs at the specific locations or registered brokers at the broker centers or RTA or DP's. The SCSB's will block the amount in the account as per the authority contained in application form. On allotment, amount will be unblocked and account will be debited only to the extent required to be paid for allotment of shares. Hence, there will be no need of refund.

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS: Almondz Global Securities Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Eurekha Stock & Share Broking Services Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, India Infoline Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited, Religare Securities Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, Axis Capital Limited, SBICAP Securities Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Limited, IIFL Wealth Management Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, YES Securities (India) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Sharekhan Limited, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, 360 ONE WAM Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Keynote Capital Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta, Equiras Securities Pvt Ltd, Finwizard Technology Pvt. Ltd, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Pvt Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Securities Ltd, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd.

BANKERS TO THE OFFER:

Escrow Collection Bank and Refund Bank: ICICI Bank Limited

Public Offer Account Bank: HDFC Bank Limited

Sponsor Banks: ICICI Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Rahul Kumar
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Gurugram
Date: October 19, 2026

PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an Initial Public Offer of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with the RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of the Company at www.parashospitals.com, on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the websites of JM Financial Limited, BofA Securities India Limited and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com, respectively. The potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk. For details, potential investors should refer to the section titled "***Risk Factors***" on page 21 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "**U.S. Securities Act**") or any other applicable law of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (a) in the United States only to persons reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) pursuant to the private placement exemption set out in Section 4(a) of the U.S. Securities Act, and (b) outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales are made.

Adfactors

HT NEW DELHI VOL. 20 NO. 252

Wednesday, October 21, 2026

mint

Think Ahead. Think Growth.

mint primer

What do clean fuel norms mean for car buyers?

BY AYAAN KARTIK

To promote cleaner fuels and efficient engines in the world's third-largest automobile market, the government will roll out CAFE-III and BS VII norms over the next three years. *Mint* examines the impact of these regulations on carmakers and buyers.

HT

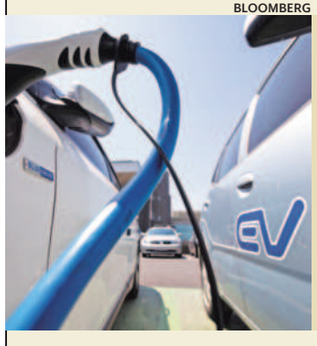
1 Why do CAFE norms matter for car buyers?

The government plans to implement the third iteration of CAFE norms from April 2027, pushing carmakers to include more clean-fuel vehicles in their portfolios. For car buyers, an expanding lineup of cleaner models—spanning EVs, hybrids, and CNG options—is expected across all price ranges over the next few years. While EV launches have picked up pace over the past two years, more hybrid models are anticipated in both big and small SUVs in the coming years. Firms are also expected to widen the availability of CNG, which holds the second-highest fuel market share behind petrol vehicles.

2 What does BS VII mean for automakers?

Rather than simply tightening emission limits, BS VII is expected to bring a fundamental shift in how emissions are tested and regulated. The norms are likely to bring testing closer to real-world driving conditions on roads while expanding the range of pollutants and testing conditions covered. They are also expected to bring electric vehicles and other powertrains within the regulatory framework, while bringing tyres under its wider ambit. For car buyers, this could mean cleaner vehicles, but also more sophisticated engines and pricier technology as carmakers adapt to stricter testing requirements.

BLOOMBERG



3 Will vehicles cost more?

Yes. Meeting tighter efficiency and emission standards requires investments in cleaner engines, hybrid systems, and advanced testing under BS VII. As pricier technologies spread across segments, average car prices could rise. However, exact increases will vary by vehicle and tech, with market competition likely limiting how much additional cost is passed to buyers.

4 Will the industry benefit?

The biggest advantage for the industry will be alignment with global emission standards. As global carmakers use India as a manufacturing hub, vehicles built for stricter domestic rules can easily serve similar overseas markets, boosting Indian plants' role in global supply chains. Component makers will gain as carmakers invest in cleaner engines, batteries, and emission controls. Though capital-intensive, this transition will drive adoption of new tech and make Indian vehicles more competitive abroad.

5 How can both norms help EVs gain?

Both regulations indirectly strengthen the case for EVs by making petrol and diesel cars pricier and more complex. CAFE III pushes carmakers to improve fleet efficiency, while BS VII imposes stricter emission limits. Meeting these standards requires adopting hybrid tech and cleaner engines in traditional vehicles. With zero tailpipe emissions, EVs offer firms an easier path to raise compliance. While EVs won't replace petrol cars right away, these rules encourage firms to expand EV choices across segments.

QUICK EDIT

Anti-AI trade yet?

With heavy investments already having gone into artificial intelligence (AI) development and infrastructure, investors now seem to be growing impatient for evidence of success, at least as reflected in how this technology helps businesses perform better. Tuesday's drop in the stocks of South Korea's tech majors was a sign of nervousness. The shares of Elice Group, which builds AI infrastructure, crashed more than 30% from their initial public offering price after they made their market debut. Shares of SK Hynix fell 4.9% and those of Samsung Electronics slid 3.2%, pulling the broader Kospi index down 3.7%. To be sure, AI stocks in the US rose on Monday, but those gains came after several successive days of losses. There is hope that a selloff in AI stocks will turn the attention of global investors to India, which is being seen as an "anti-AI trade." That said, it's premature to say if the global AI rally is fizzling out. Some of the recent selling may have to do with upcoming AI-firm results. Their upward path is under watch as analysts try to assess whether the industry is meeting or failing its promise. The spillover effects of an AI bubble burst, though, may hurt even if the anti-AI trade gains traction.

QUOTE OF THE DAY

We grow value per customer by giving people more to do on our network, not only by charging more per gigabyte.. At Jio, our objective is to create greater value from our network capabilities for both customers and shareholders.

AKASH AMBANI
JIO PLATFORMS MD

He was speaking in an interview.

INSIDE

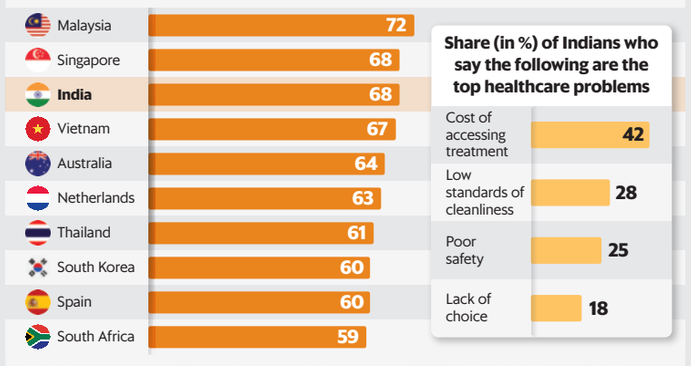
Mark to Market | HDFC to be on fast track soon >P4
Global | Death toll rises to 73 in Houthi strike on Yemen training camp >P8
Money | The magic of a Swiss winter without breaking the bank >P11
Views | Paris is burning and this holds a key fiscal lesson >P12
Business of Life | Can an AI assistant be your chief of staff? >P14

mint | DATA BITES

HOW DO INDIANS VIEW HEALTHCARE SERVICES?

More than two-thirds of Indians say they trust their healthcare system and quality of treatment, well ahead of some developed countries like Australia and South Korea, despite flagging costs and cleanliness as key issues.

Share (in %) of respondents who say they trust healthcare systems and can access quality healthcare*



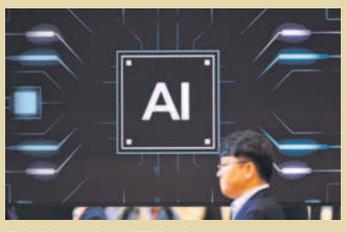
Share (in %) of Indians who say the following are the top healthcare problems

*Includes top 10 among 32 countries surveyed. Survey covers 22,528 adults, including 1,000 Indians.

Data: Anjishnu Das
Graphic: Manu Choudhary

Source: Ipsos Health Service Report 2026

COLUMNS



RAHUL MATTHAN
HOLD USERS OF SELF-LEARNING AI LIABLE FOR ANY HARM DONE >P13

Niranjan Rajadhyaksha
THE IMF'S LATEST OUTLOOK SENDS MIXED SIGNALS ON GLOBAL GROWTH >P12

R.V. Anuradha & Prachi Priya
INDIA'S CARBON MARKET WILL NEED WIDER SUPPORT SYSTEMS >P12

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PLAIN FACTS

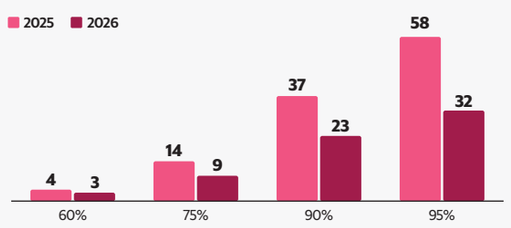
HOW GLOBAL SHIFTS COULD IMPACT INDIA

BY DEEPA VASUDEVAN | feedback@livemint.com

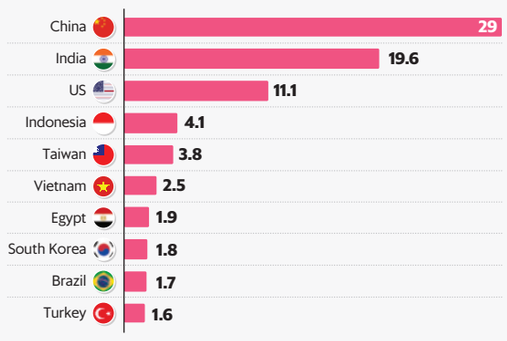
The world economy may have remained resilient in 2026, but volatility and unpredictability are far from over, and their impact could weigh on India's growth trajectory as well.

Global growth is concentrated among a few economies, even more than before

Number of countries accounting for the following share of global growth (in %)

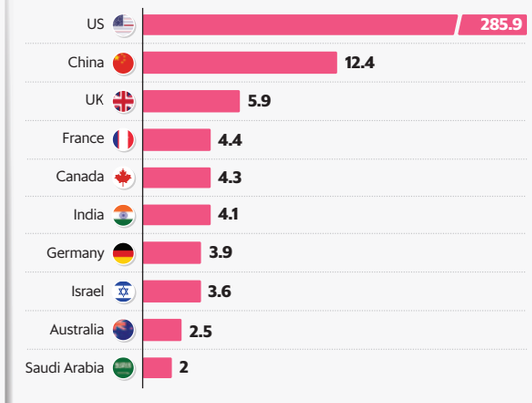


Share in global growth (in %), by top 10 contributors



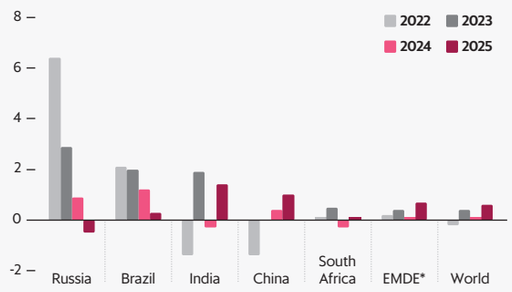
US and China have been the biggest beneficiaries of private investment in AI

Top 10 countries by global private investment in AI (in $ billion)



Uncertainty has made growth forecast tougher, especially among emerging markets

One-year growth forecast error* (in %)



India has relatively weak net international investment position among top economies

Values (in $ trillion) for the top 10 economies*

	GDP (PPP)	NIIP
China	44.55	3.3
US	32.64	-26.54
India	19.19	-0.37
Japan	7.32	3.4
Germany	6.55	3.59
Indonesia	5.48	-0.25
Brazil	5.27	-0.84
UK	4.78	-0.35
France	4.76	-0.7
Turkey	4.03	-0.34

*Calculated based on the actual growth of each year minus the projected growth given in April of the same year. EMDE: Emerging market and developing economies, as defined by the IMF.

*Based on 2026 GDP at purchasing power parity in current dollar prices. NIIP: Net International Investment Position, which means the total value of foreign assets a nation owns minus its liabilities, is for 2024, the latest available year.

Source: World Economic Outlook Oct 2026, International Monetary Fund, Stanford AI Index Report 2026, author's calculations

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PRATEEK KUMAR/MINT

AT A GLANCE

- Since 2020, ongoing global crises have driven high volatility and uncertainty, disrupting medium-term economic forecasts and growth trajectories.
- While war in West Asia and surging oil prices drag down global growth, rapid AI investment offsets these negative macroeconomic impacts, keeping global growth resilient.
- But growth is concentrated in a few nations, with China, India and the US generating nearly 60% of global GDP expansion in 2026, and countries leading in AI also reaping benefits.
- Amid uncertainty, India must strengthen its national balance sheet against external financial risks while transforming its strong AI adoption potential into AI development.

Since 2020, repeated crises—from a pandemic to major wars—have disrupted growth, trade, and prices. By 2022, experts framed this state as VUCA (volatility, uncertainty, complexity, ambiguity). Four years on, global conditions remain volatile due to geopolitical friction, rising inflation and yields, and rapid AI shifts. Medium-term forecasts remain elusive, threatening long-term prospects for emerging markets like India, which targets sustained 7%-plus growth.

HOW GLOBAL GROWTH ADDS UP

Data from the International Monetary Fund's (IMF) World Economic Outlook database reveals three key trends: world growth is highly concentrated, disruptions from West Asia and AI pull in opposite directions, and AI adoption has become a growth wild card.

To measure a country's contribution to global real growth, the IMF combines its real domestic growth rate with its share of world GDP at purchasing power parity (PPP). Domestic growth shows expansion speed, while PPP share weights its global significance. For example, Bahrain's 11.2% contraction in 2026 barely moved global growth because its economy accounts for under 0.05% of world GDP in PPP terms. Conversely, China's 4.4% expansion carries massive weight due to its 19.8% world GDP share.

CONCENTRATED GROWTH

In 2026, 32 economies contributed just over 95% of global growth, down from 58 in 2025. China alone brought in 28%, and the top three—China, India, and the US—contributed nearly 60% of world GDP growth. This creates systemic risk—a sharp downturn in either the US or China will reverberate around the world and trigger slowdowns in many countries. It also gives the top two growth drivers considerable economic leverage, which is increasingly being used. US's withholding of advanced chip sales to China and China's export controls on key rare earths are examples of how economic advantages are being weaponized.

Global growth is estimated at a resilient 3.1% in 2026 despite two ongoing wars and the greatest oil supply shock since the 1970s. The war in West Asia and the surge in AI-related investments pull growth in opposite directions. At a global level, the AI boom has offset the negative impact of higher oil prices. But resilience in aggregate growth conceals country-specific pockets of uncertainty. Thus, GDP growth for the world and the emerging market group has been higher than forecast for three years straight, but the same is not true for individual emerging economies. For instance, India and China underperformed in 2022, while the Russian economy grew far more than predicted. Last year, Russia was the only country in the BRICS group to underperform.

AI: THE WILD CARD

Participation in the AI story has emerged as the key growth differentiator between countries. The macroeconomic impact of AI operates in three phases: research and development to build frontier AI models; building AI infrastructure; and implementing AI in businesses and daily transactions. Currently, a handful of countries that dominate the first and second phases enjoy the economic benefits of AI. The US and China lead the world in AI innovation, and are also the largest recipients of AI-related investment. Smaller economies such as Taiwan, South Korea, the Netherlands, and Malaysia benefit from being key suppliers of AI-related hardware. Indeed, tiny Taiwan has been among the top five contributors to global growth for two consecutive years.

India has defied these trends by maintaining a robust growth trajectory despite being a net energy importer and lacking a strong AI narrative. But this growth momentum cannot be taken for granted. That is because the long-term impact of geopolitics and technology is largely unknown.

With little control over external volatility, it is in our interest to focus on addressing two key domestic vulnerabilities. First, India lags in AI model development, but it has the conditions that favour large-scale AI adoption. There's a large pool of AI-literate talent: India is ranked third globally in AI-related research articles published over the last decade, and its AI skill penetration rate is nearly three times the global average. It scores well on policy vision and commitment and the government's ability to deliver e-services (Oxford's Government AI Readiness Index 2025). With a large young population, 800 million smartphones and over 100 million weekly ChatGPT users, there is a strong market for AI tools. The challenge is to adapt AI models to domestic use cases and to use them to raise productivity.

CAPITAL CATCH

While converting AI absorption into productivity gains, and from there to higher GDP growth, will take time, the country needs capital to fund enabling infrastructure, and investors demand macroeconomic stability. The past few years have shown that the old model of financing current account deficits with capital inflows may not work in a world of volatile capital flows, geopolitical risk, and trade disruptions. Among the top five economies by GDP PPP, India has the worst net international investment position, or NIIP (excluding the US, whose status as the reserve currency issuer and global hegemon lets it get away with a much worse NIIP).

This makes it a net debtor nation, one that relies on fickle foreign inflows to pay its trade account dues. The other members of the top five club—Japan, Germany and China—all run solid current account surpluses. Thus, until India improves its current account balance and is able to attract stable foreign capital, its economy will remain vulnerable to external crises. Building a stronger national balance sheet is fundamental to growth resilience.

Deepa Vasudevan is an independent writer in economics and finance.

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Wednesday, October 21, 2026

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Indians willing to pay ₹50,000 extra for costliest iPhone ▶P3

Rubio sees trade deal near, role for Venezuela oil ▶P2

SENSEX **73,852.9** ↔ **0.00** NIFTY **22,888.95** ↔ **0.00** DOLLAR **₹94.93** ↔ **₹0.00** EURO **₹106.39** ↔ **₹0.00** OIL **$107.61** ↑ **$1.4** POUND **₹126.72** ↓ **₹0.23**

Silent investors key to Tata's Iveco deal

Tata needs support from 80% of Iveco investors for delisting

Ayaan Kartik
ayaan.kartik@livemint.com
NEW DELHI

Tata Motors Ltd will need to win over most of Iveco's silent shareholders—roughly three in four investors who stayed away from Friday's special shareholder meeting—to complete its €3.9 billion acquisition and delist the Italian truck maker, *Mint's* review of the vote outcome shows.

About one in three non-promoter votes cast were against resolutions linked to the Tatas' proposed takeover, including appointment of its executives to the board of Iveco, headquartered in Turin with its parent incorporated in the Netherlands. The opposition points to a tough battle ahead for India's largest truck maker as it races for the 80% shareholder acceptance needed for full control of Iveco.

Tata Sons chairman Natarajan Chandrasekaran, Jaguar Land Rover chief executive P.B. Balaji and Tata Motors managing director Girish Wagh are among the top executives set to join Iveco's board if the deal goes through.

Shareholders holding about 52.9% of Iveco's common shares, including promoter Exor with 27%, backed the deal-related resolutions, while those with 11.6% voted against them. Remaining shareholders, holding about 35.5%, did not vote at the extraordinary general meeting.

This means Tata must persuade shareholders owning about 27% of common shares from among those who didn't vote, assuming those voting against the resolution don't subscribe till the deadline.

Opposition to the deal has not subsided even as Tata sweetened the offer by 2% from €14.10 a share to €14.40 on 9 October.

"A large percentage of voting happens in the last 48 hours, so the company is confident of securing the shareholders and reaching the required threshold. It is typical of

TURN TO PAGE 5

VOTING WOES

It's a tough battle ahead for India's largest truck maker as it races to secure shareholder nod for full control of the Italian firm

A bumpy road to Iveco

- **Shareholders accounting** for 64.5% of Iveco's common shares participated in the 16 October EGM.
- **Holders of** 52.9% of common shares backed key deal-related resolutions, while 11.6% opposed them.
- **Remaining 35.5%** did not vote, leaving their intentions uncertain.
- **31.19% of** Iveco's shares were tendered under Tatas' offer as of 19 October.
- **Tata Motors** needs another 27% from silent shareholders to meet the 80% acceptance mark (assuming the EGM voting reflects tendering).
- **If acceptance** falls between 66.67% and 80%, Tata can waive the higher threshold and proceed with the buy, but it can't go in for delisting or restructuring.

Source: Mint research based on the companies' filings

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SATISH KUMAR/MINT

'Free cash flow to fuel growth, create value for Jio investors'

Team Mint
feedback@livemint.com

Akash Ambani, managing director of Jio Platforms, focuses on scale, technology and the promise of long-term value. BLOOMBERG

Akash Ambani would rather talk technology than himself. In an email interview ahead of the company's initial public offering opening on Wednesday, the managing director of Jio Platforms focuses on scale, technology and the promise of long-term value, drawing heavily on the Jio story his father Mukesh Ambani built.

Akash comes across as a technology enthusiast who spent the past decade in the trenches, helping build Jio from its 2016 launch into one of India's most consequential digital businesses. This quiet confidence comes from being part of the grind, where ambition was matched by execution at extraordinary scale. For Akash, Jio is not just a telecom giant; it is a technology company built on an indigenous stack, with connectivity as its foundation.

As Jio prepares for what could be India's biggest IPO, he is stepping into a new role: telling its story to public-market investors alongside his sister, Isha. The stakes are real: Akash must now convince investors he can do more than carry forward his father's legacy—that he can turn Jio's extraordinary scale into enduring value for millions of shareholders.

Beyond connectivity, what are the two or three milestones investors can use to judge whether the full-stack and overseas managed services bet is creating incremental returns? How will you report this?

Our message to retail investors is to understand Jio Platforms as a long-term technology and digital services business, which has multiple growth engines. With India's rapid digitalization and mass adoption of next-gen digital technologies, Jio has a very large and expanding target addressable market in the form of growing mobile data usage, migrating customers to higher-quality digital experiences, expanding home broadband and fixed wireless access, deepening enterprise relationships.

We will be happy to report our progress with the value-added services, and overseas managed services from time-to-time post-listing.

You have stated that this IPO eliminates $3 billion in net debt and that future growth will be funded from about 30% free cash flow. However, 5G utilization is still about one-third, home

TURN TO PAGE 10

INTERVIEW

Lender, broker push for IPO retail participation>P7

DON'T MISS

AFP

Health ministry, PCI divided on pharmacist service rules

An unprecedented row has erupted between the Union health ministry and the Pharmacy Council of India (PCI) over recently notified regulations governing the recruitment, promotion and service conditions of government pharmacists. >P2

Fortum nixes Glida sale, plans to run EV charging unit

Finnish state-run energy utility Fortum Oyj has scrapped the plan to sell Glida, its electric vehicle (EV) charging network business in India, to the promoters of the Gurugram-headquartered JBM Group, said two people aware of the development. >P6

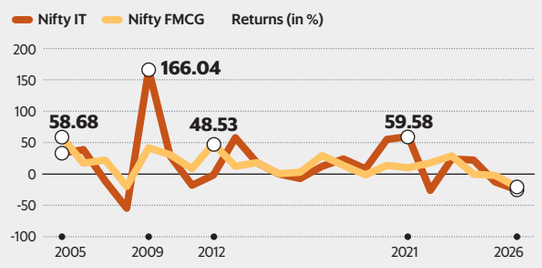
Auto parts makers forging global tie-ups for tech edge

At least three Indian auto component makers—Sona Comstar, Gabriel India and Varroc Engineering—tied up with global auto part firms looking to expand their India play to add products and capabilities in new technologies and catch up with rivals. >P5

NOTE TO READERS The Media Marketing Initiative on Page 3 is the equivalent of a paid-for advertisement and no *Mint* journalist was involved in creating it. Readers would do well to treat it as an advertisement.

Hard to beat

IT and FMCG may find it hard to recreate their blockbuster runs.



Source: NSE

mint

SATISH KUMAR/MINT

Defensive stock buyers desperate as options thin

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MUMBAI

For years, investors seeking refuge during market swings gravitated towards IT and consumer staples stocks, but that strategy is looking less reliable today as both sectors wrestle with slowing growth, rising competition and shifting investor expectations.

A sector is defensive "when earnings volatility is amongst the lowest, when the ownership of this sector is quite low, and expectations are low," said Harish Krishnan, chief investment officer, equity at Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC.

The numbers tell the story. Over the past three years, the Nifty IT index has gone nowhere, while the Nifty FMCG index has fallen 16%. In contrast, Nifty 50 has gained 17%, according to *Bloomberg* data.

Fund managers say these sectors no longer have the combination that once made them dependable safe havens: low expectations, limited investor ownership and steady earnings.

Bloomberg data showed that Nifty IT surged 166% in 2009 and 60% in 2021, while Nifty FMCG gained 59% in 2005 and 48.5% in 2012—returns that market participants believe may be difficult to replicate.

"I agree," says Trilok Agarwal, fund manager at Ambit Asset Management, adding that those periods were driven by exceptional circumstances rather than normal business cycles.

The 2009 and 2021 IT rallies were driven by post-crisis recovery and a digitalization boom, but with both sectors maturing, growth is slowing amid AI disruption, stronger competition and changing consumer behaviour.

FMCG companies are battling disruption from direct-to-consumer brands and quick-commerce platforms, while IT firms face uncertainty over technology spending and questions about how AI could reshape the industry.

As a result, investors looking for stability are casting a wider net. Many are now favouring businesses with predictable earnings and strong cash flows in sectors such as healthcare, telecom, utilities and financials, alongside income-generating assets such as real estate

TURN TO PAGE 6

Pay hikes in 2027 may be muted as companies battle higher costs

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India Inc is bracing for muted salary hikes in 2027 as rising costs, geopolitical uncertainty and a sluggish job market squeeze compensation budgets, with bigger rewards likely reserved for top performers, hiring experts said.

Higher crude oil prices amid the West Asia conflict, surging inflation, the Reserve Bank of India's rate hike and changing attrition trends are converging to complicate salary decisions, they said. With consumer demand under pressure and businesses more cautious about spending, companies are likely to exercise greater discipline in compensation budgets, even as they compete to retain critical talent.

Consulting firms Deloitte and WTW (Willis Towers Watson) expect average salary increases to remain flat in 2027. Aon, meanwhile, projects nominal salary hikes of 9.1%, broadly in line with 2026, and real wage growth, adjusted for inflation, of 5.1%, from 4.3% in 2026. In banking, salary increases could average 6-7% in FY27, down from 8-9% in FY26, according to recruitment firm ABC Consultants.

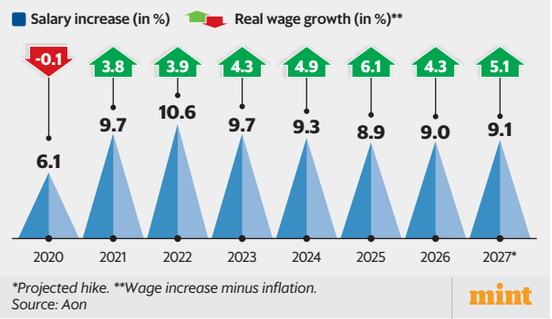
Employers typically roll out annual increments in April-May, though some do so a few months later. Work on salary hikes, promotions and bonuses has, however, begun.

"Three forces are converging: cost pressure from geopolitical conflict, attrition falling across every industry, and more Indian professionals returning home than leaving. Put together, they point to one outcome, which is that average salary increases in 2027 will

TURN TO PAGE 4

Pay prudence

Rising costs and volatile geopolitics are set to keep compensation budgets tight.



**Projected hike. **Wage increase minus inflation.*
Source: Aon

mint

SATISH KUMAR/MINT

Exporters' tax refund schemes set for overhaul

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The government is looking to overhaul two flagship schemes that refund domestic taxes and levies paid by exporters, seeking to make payouts more targeted and funds better spent at a time when global uncertainties are weighing on Indian shipments. Two panels have been set up to review and reframe these schemes that help Indian goods stay competitive overseas, three people close to the development told *Mint*.

The move follows a recommendation by the expenditure finance committee (EFC) late last month for better targeting after the commerce and textiles ministries sought a total of about ₹2 trillion for next five years for Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) and Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies (RoSCTL) schemes.

Move follows recommendation by the EFC late last month. AFP

The schemes were rolled out with the aim of keeping exports zero-rated, in sync with global best practices, where exports are not to carry domestic taxes. The refunds cover embedded central and state levies outside the goods and services tax (GST) regime—including those on fuel and electricity, stamp duty and mandi tax—which are paid on inputs consumed in the production of exported goods.

While the RoDTEP scheme covers a range of sectors, including exporters in special economic zones and bonded warehouses, RoSCTL is largely focused on garments.

The panel on RoDTEP has been set up under Director General of Foreign Trade Lav Agarwal, while the RoSCTL one is headed by additional secretary in the textiles ministry Arti Kanwar. Both panels have senior government officials and industry executives.

Their recommendations are likely to be discussed during the Union budget deliberations and could form basis of the revamped frameworks for the two critical programmes.

The proposed overhaul of these marquee schemes comes when exporters, grappling with the West Asia and Ukraine wars and other external headwinds, seek timely and adequate refunds of taxes and levies paid on inputs.

Currently, a committee set

TURN TO PAGE 6

Gene editing lets crops tell farmers they're feeling stressed

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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What if a plant facing attack from insects or disease could send out an early-warning signal by, say, emitting a glow or turning its leaves purple?

A handful of startups are using gene editing and sensors to do just that, programming plants to "tell" farmers when they are under stress before visible symptoms appear.

The idea is that if plants can show they are struggling earlier, farmers can take targeted action to nip problems in the bud. Instead of spraying huge swaths of farmland with fungicides and herbicides to stave off pests and disease, farmers can treat small sections of their crop as needed, reducing reliance on chemicals that eventually leach into soil, waterways and drinking water.

"Plants naturally give us visible information about their physiology in a number of ways—wilting, for example," says Alexander Jones , a professor at the University of Cambridge who focuses on plant biology. "But these signs can come too late for us to act."

Shely Aronov, chief executive of California startup InnerPlant, explains that when plants are attacked they start to activate genes to protect themselves. "Those reactions happen very fast and they're different, depending on the stress," she says.

Startups are designing plants that glow or turn purple when disease or pests strike. MINT

InnerPlant's technology works by engineering plants at the DNA level. Those traits are then passed down to the seeds they produce. "It's kind of like adding a line of code, so that once the plant is reacting to, say, fungal pressure, it's going to start producing a protein that creates an optical signal," says Aronov.

In the case of InnerPlant, that optical signal is a glow given off by the plant that is invisible to the human eye but detectable by tractors with cameras in the field, drones or satellites.

InnerPlant is backed by farming-equipment giant Deere, which invested in the startup in 2022 and has equipped its John Deere smart tractors with cameras that can detect the signals being given off by the plants.

"The plant being able to tell you itself what is going on versus you having to look for visual effects was very compelling," says Dan Leibfried, vice president of marketing and shared services at Deere. "InnerPlant is definitely one of those disruptive technologies that I fundamentally believe will transform the industry over time."

Elsewhere, Indiana-based Insignum AgTech is designing corn crops whose leaves turn purple in reaction to fungal diseases and pests. "When you see disease it's too late," says Chief Executive Kyle Mohler.

Mohler hails from a farming family who grow corn and soybeans. He says that like most farmers, his family used to spray chemicals on every acre

TURN TO PAGE 4

Goods import from Britain fell 16.8% in August and September to $1.36 billion. REUTERS

Exports of goods to UK rises 8% in August and September

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India's merchandise exports to the United Kingdom rose 8% on an annualized basis to $2.43 billion in August and September this year, the first two months after the India-UK free trade agreement came into force from mid-July, according to latest trade data.

Goods imports from Britain, however, fell 16.8% in these two months to $1.36 billion, data showed.

The India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) was operationalized on 15 July.

According to the data, India's merchandise exports to the UK fell about 4.2% to $1.2 billion in July, saw about 10% year-on-year growth to $1.26 billion in August , and a 5.5% increase to $1.17 billion in September.

While Indian exports saw a steady growth from July, imports from the UK saw a sharp decline in September.

Hindustan Times

Shipments of British merchandise in July rose by nearly 12% to $639 million. Imports year-on-year surged over 24% to $733 million in August , only to see a sharp 40% fall to $630 million in September , mostly on account of lower imports of silver.

The two economies are yet to witness the full potential of CETA as traders from both sides are gearing up, government officials and trade experts said.

A comprehensive analysis of the reasons for growth and fall would be possible after country-specific, commodity-wise granular data is released, which come with a lag, they added.

According to provisional trade data for the first-half of 2026-27 released by the commerce ministry on 15 October, India's merchandise exports to the United Kingdom rose by 7.22% to $7.32 billion in April-September 2026 as compared to $6.83 billion April-September 2025.

Health ministry, PCI divided on pharmacist service rules

The ministry declared the rules invalid saying PCI issued them without government approval

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PCI maintains that it published the regulations in the Gazette of India with the Centre's approval, says it has acted within its statutory powers. AFP

An unprecedented row has erupted between the Union health ministry and the Pharmacy Council of India (PCI), a statutory body under the ministry, over recently notified regulations governing the recruitment, promotion and service conditions of government pharmacists.

The ministry has declared the rules invalid, according to a circular dated 12 October, saying they were issued without government approval, according to two government officials. *Mint* has reviewed the circular.

The PCI, which had published the regulations in the Gazette of India on 10 June "with the approval of the Central Government", maintains that it acted within its statutory powers.

The Pharmacist Recruitment, Promotion and Service Regulations, 2025 seek to establish an independent cadre of government pharmacists, their recruitment, promotions, service conditions and responsibilities.

12 Oct Date of ministry circular declaring the rules invalid

10 Jun Date on which PCI published the rules in gazette

The health ministry has emphasized that no such approval was ever granted and concluded that the regulations were *ultra vires* the Pharmacy Act, 1948, and beyond the legal powers of the PCI, rendering them *non est* (non-existent) in the eye of law, the circular said.

Ultra vires, with roots in Latin, refers to actions that exceed legal authority.

"The preamble to the said PCI notification claims that the Regulations were framed 'with the approval of the Central Government'," the 12 October circular read.

"These regulations have been issued without the approval of the Central government, and as opined by Department of Legal Affairs (DoLA), the impugned regulations are *ultra vires* the Act and beyond the authority of the PCI and are therefore *non est* in the eye of law." *Non est*, again from Latin, means "does not exist".

The ministry has directed the health secretaries of all states and Union territories, hospital divisions, the Directorate General of Health Services and the Central Government Health Scheme to take note of the order. Further, recruiting authorities and government healthcare departments have been instructed not to initiate or consider any administrative or regulatory action based on the invalid framework, the circular noted. The PCI contends that the health ministry was informed about the new regulations.

"The Council has acted strictly within its statutory powers under the Pharmacy Act to safeguard public health and reform the profession. While qualifications have evolved over the years to BPharm, MPharm and PharmD, government pharmacists were still stuck with decades-old pay scales and structures. We formulated these recruitment and promotion regulations to address these legitimate demands," PCI president Montu Patel told *Mint* on the phone.

Addressing the ministry's claim that the gazette notification was unapproved, Patel said, "Authorities were kept fully informed. We repeatedly sought their permissions but received neither an affirmative nor a negative reply. We eventually wrote to them stating that in the interest of the profession, we would proceed to notify the regulations, which we did with their complete knowledge. We have documented proof of every communication and will present all records."

The ministry in response to *Mint*'s queries pointed out that the PCI "is entrusted with regulating standards of pharmacy education". "It is important to distinguish between regulation of pharmacy education and matters relating to recruitment, promotion, pay scales and cadre restructuring, which are governed by the applicable rules and procedures of the respective Central and State Government employing authorities," it added.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

US, India 'very, very close' to trade deal, says Rubio

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US secretary of state Marco Rubio (left)meets external affairs minister S. Jaishankar in Mumbai on Tuesday. REUTERS

The US and India are "very, very close" to a trade agreement, with only a small number of items yet to be decided upon, US secretary of state Marco Rubio said on Tuesday, expressing optimism that the pact would be in place very soon.

"We're very, very close. I would say we're about as close as you can be without having executed the agreement," Rubio told the press in Mumbai. "I think there's a small number of items to wrap up, so I think that will happen shortly—we're hoping; it should."

"Obviously the state department doesn't negotiate trade agreements, but we are very much involved in what's happening," he said.

Rubio described India as an important commercial and business partner of the US, referring to bilateral defence cooperation and India's membership of the Quad, a strategic partnership between India, the US, Japan and Australia, focusing on security, technology and stability in the Indo-Pacific.

"This is the most populous country in the world; it's the largest democracy in the world. It's an important commercial partner and business partner of the United States. We also do a lot of defence cooperation. They're a key member of the Quad. They're a strong strategic partner," he said.

In FY26, India's exports to the US grew marginally to $87.31 billion from $86.51 billion a year ago, while imports surged by 17.2% to $53.45 billion from $45.62 billion in FY25. Overall bilateral trade rose 6.5% to $140.76 billion in FY26 from $132.2 billion. India had a trade surplus of $33.9 billion in FY26, down from $40.9 billion in FY25.

Rubio said trade was one of two subjects that featured in his conversations with counterparts around the world, the other being demand for air interceptors.

The top US official's visit to India is scheduled to run until 22 October, according to the external affairs ministry.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

India to build access-controlled bypasses to curb city congestion

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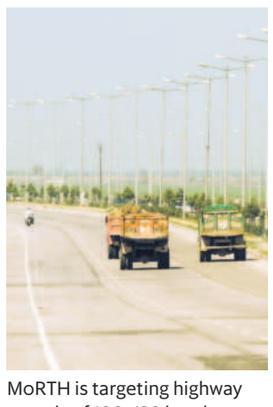

MoRTH is targeting highway speeds of 100–120 kmph. MINT

India plans to develop ring roads and highway bypasses around cities and towns as access-controlled corridors with distance-based tolling, aiming to keep them dedicated to through traffic and prevent them from becoming congested urban roads as settlements expand and local traffic increases, according to the road transport ministry's new urban decongestion policy.

The ministry of road transport and highways (MoRTH) has finalized a revised decongestion policy mandating that national highway projects undertaken for urban decongestion be developed as fully access-controlled corridors with a minimum four-lane configuration and closed tolling facilities. The aim is to preserve highway speeds of 100–120 kmph, separate long-distance passenger and freight traffic from local movement, and prevent unregulated roadside development from eroding the benefits of public investment, according to the policy that was notified last month. *Mint* has reviewed the policy.

Earlier plans on ring roads and bypasses did not have a specific provision for being developed as access-controlled networks. This resulted in unregulated ribbon development along the National Highways that soon impeded smooth flow of traffic and created congestion, negating the benefits of the investment made in the development of the ring road or the bypass.

"Wherever a ring road is constructed, we would go for closed tolling, which would mean that vehicles would have to pay for the distance travelled on such roads, which would also be access-controlled," a person aware of the government's plans said.

Under closed tolling, motorists would pay according to the distance travelled rather than a single fixed charge for entering and using a road. However, smaller exits within cities may be exempted from tolling where traffic volumes are low and the cost of installing tolling infrastructure is not justified, the person said. Such exemptions would be considered to minimize inconvenience for local commuters while retaining the principle of access control.

Queries emailed to MoRTH went unanswered.

Mint reported in June that the government planned a ₹2 trillion programme to develop a 10,000-km network of ring roads and bypasses around 400–500 cities and towns.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

'US suffers from dollar phobia, not Brics'

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Anil Sooklal, South Africa's high commissioner to India.

Brics is not trying to create a common currency; instead, the grouping wants to make it easier for members to trade in their own currencies and develop alternative payment systems that reduce dependence on the US dollar, according to South Africa's high commissioner to India, Anil Sooklal.

Sooklal told *Mint* the push is not about challenging the dollar for its own sake. Rather, it reflects growing unease among emerging economies about the way the US uses tariffs, sanctions and its dominance of the global financial system. "It is not Brics that suffers from dollar phobia. It's the US that suffers from dollar phobia," he said.

His comments come after the Brics summit in New Delhi, where the bloc's 11 members agreed a joint declaration despite differences over conflicts, trade and other geopolitical issues. Sooklal said that the outcome was the result of months of Indian diplomacy and engagement with member nations before leaders gathered for the summit.

Dismissing talk of a shared Brics currency, he said the bloc is focused on practical steps such as increasing local-currency trade and building alternative payment mechanisms. Those efforts reflect how many developing countries are adapting to what they see as a more fragmented global order.

It is not Brics that suffers from dollar phobia. It's the US that suffers from dollar phobia, Sooklal said

Sooklal, who served as South Africa's Brics sherpa in 2023, added that the manner in which the US has weaponized trade causes more harm to countries than bombing them.

He said the New Delhi Declaration reflected months of quiet Indian diplomacy rather than a last-minute compromise at the summit table. He contrasted Brics's outcome with the G20, saying no declaration should be expected from the grouping this year.

The G20 is an intergovernmental forum comprising 19 sovereign countries, the European Union, and the African Union. The US will host the 2026 G20 Leaders' Summit on 14-15 December, with discussions likely to focus on prosperity, energy security, technological innovation, and resilient supply chains.

Sooklal said African members Ethiopia, Egypt and South Africa also played a role in building consensus, particularly in engaging Iran.

"If you follow the Brics, most of the time the 'mainstream press' is very dismissive of the Brics until the Brics meets. Then they get a bit worked up about it," said S. Jaishankar, minister of external affairs, at the session on *Ruptures & Ramparts: Building Bridges for a Changing World*, organized on the margins of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly by the Observer Research Foundation, Reliance Foundation, UN in India and the Permanent Mission of India to the UN.

"We are saying let's consolidate trading local currencies, deepen that, let's create our own payment platform and instruments, which has been under discussion since 2023," Sooklal said.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

MINT SHORTS

India voices concern over UN's liquidity situation

United Nations: India has voiced concern over the "challenging" liquidity situation of the United Nations this year. It also called out the "unacceptably high levels" of unpaid assessments owed by the US, as counsellor in the Permanent Mission of India to the UN Surendra Adhana delivered India's national statement at a UNGA meeting here, on Monday. PTI

AFP

Govt to review 2019 mineral policy amid new priorities

New Delhi: The Centre is set to review the National Mineral Policy, 2019, to align it with evolving sector demands, focusing on key priorities such as critical minerals, recycling, and deep-sea resources, according to persons in the know. The mines ministry has decided to constitute a panel to undertake a comprehensive review of the policy in the light of recent developments and emerging requirements, the persons said. PTI

Global sugar market supply deficit to grow sharply

New York: The global sugar market supply deficit was projected to grow to 6.28 million tonnes (mt), 3mt more than a previous estimate, market analyst Green Pool Commodities said on Tuesday . The analyst blamed poor production in major sugar-making regions such as Brazil, India and the European Union for the revised outlook, as global agriculture struggles to cope with impacts from the El Niño weather anomaly. REUTERS

BLOOMBERG

Outbound capital controls tightened as rupee skids

REUTERS

The Reserve Bank of India is reportedly tightening scrutiny of large overseas investments by domestic firms as it seeks to contain capital outflows amid pressure on the rupee. RBI issued a standardized checklist to major banks last week, asking for details on overseas direct investments exceeding $1 billion and transactions above regulatory limit, *Economic Times* reported on Tuesday. BLOOMBERG

India-New Zealand free trade agreement comes into effect

PTI

New Delhi: India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA), signed on 27 April, came into effect on Tuesday, providing duty-free access to a range of Indian goods, including products from labour-intensive sectors such as textiles and leather. It is the seventh trade pact to come into force in the last five years. PTI

India's online retail market to cross $90 billion in 2026

New Delhi: India's online retail market is projected to cross $90 billion in 2026, registering an annual growth of 22–24%, its fastest expansion in five years, driven by everyday consumption categories such as grocery rather than mobile phones, Redseer Strategy Consultants said in a report. PTI

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First published in February 2007 to serve as an unbiased and clear-minded chronicler of the Indian Dream.

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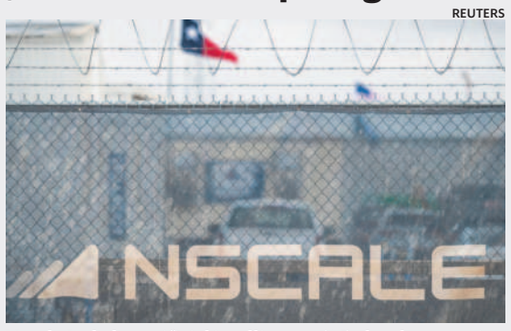
MINT SHORTS

Britain seeks to break Apple's grip on contactless payments

London: Britain's competition regulator on Tuesday said it was seeking to loosen Apple's grip on contactless payments by proposing that the company lower fees and remove technical barriers, helping rival services compete with Apple Pay. The Competition and Markets Authority said its proposals would result in "substantially lower access fees" and easier access to Apple's contactless technology. **REUTERS**

Nscale, Anthropic in talks for $45 billion AI computing deal

REUTERS



Nscale Ltd, the artificial intelligence (AI) cloud computing firm, is in talks to sell computing power to Anthropic PBC in a deal that could be worth about $45 billion, according to people familiar with the negotiations. The Nvidia Corp.-backed data centre developer is seeking a second major deal with the firm behind Claude for a second facility at its Monarch data centre campus in West Virginia, the people said. Anthropic has agreements in place with Nscale for infrastructure that's worth as much as about $44.6 billion, according to a regulatory filing for Nscale's planned initial public offering. **BLOOMBERG**

Cognizant, Google Cloud expand tie-up to drive agentic AI adoption

New Delhi: Cognizant and Google Cloud on Tuesday announced an expansion of their partnership to accelerate the adoption of agentic artificial intelligence (AI), including a new 'Gemini Frontier Capability Group'. The group brings together a dedicated global workforce that pairs Google's full-stack, enterprise-ready AI platform with Cognizant's domain, industry and engineering expertise as an AI builder, according to a release. **PTI**

Meta's board signals 'recurring' failures in poll content moderation

Paris: The oversight board for social media giant Meta on Tuesday said it found "recurrent enforcement failures" in content moderation related to the US midterm elections and Brazil's presidential election. Social media is a go-to source of electoral information for many voters, raising fears in several countries that it could swing results in favour of certain interests. **AFP**

Indians willing to pay ₹50,000 extra for costliest iPhone yet

Retailers say just 6,000 units of the foldable iPhone are expected in India in its first week

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The limited availability comes despite significant demand potential. AP

Apple's most expensive iPhone yet is proving so scarce that some Indian buyers are willing to pay ₹50,000 above its retail price to get their hands on one. With only about 6,000 units of the ₹2,99,900 iPhone Duo expected across India in its first week, the shortage is fuelling demand in the grey market, according to at least five retailers, industry stakeholders and analysts that *Mint* spoke with.

The limited availability comes despite significant demand potential. On 9 September, *Mint* reported after Apple's unveiling that the iPhone Duo could sell 150,000 units in its first full year. Now, at least three retailers with direct knowledge of Apple's distribution directives in India said only 6,000 units are expected to be available nationwide in the first week.

"There is always more demand than what we can meet with Apple's top model each year, but it is true even more so this year because of the supply crunch. This is pushing many buyers—those who want the social bragging rights of being an Apple first-adopter, to seek devices from the grey market," said the proprietor of a large Delhi-based electronics retailer, requesting anonymity due to their non-disclosure agreement with Apple.

A second Mumbai-based multi-brand retailer, who also requested anonymity, said many sellers outside the largest online platforms and large-format stores were "unsure if any supply will even come by this Friday."

"Typically, we make requisition requests through Apple's distribution partner. While we never get our full request due to supply rationing, we do get at least half of the stock that we ask for. This year, we've been told that while we asked for 100 units of iPhone Duo, we may get only five," the second retailer added.

The iPhone Duo goes on sale on Friday at ₹2,99,900. Apple launched it roughly two months after rival Samsung introduced the similarly shaped Galaxy Z Fold 8 on 7 August at ₹1.8 lakh.

Mint was the first to report on 23 June that Apple's and Samsung's foldable phones this year could cost as much as ₹2.8 lakh, as brands deliberately separate premium and super-premium devices in their portfolios while chip prices squeeze margins.

Apple did not respond to *Mint*'s detailed email seeking comment.

This is prompting buyers to seek grey-market options. Typically, these are sellers that work outside of Apple's authorized retail chain partners, affirmed Kailash Lakhyani, president of All India Mobile Retailers Association. "Most of them deal in cash, offer no invoice or guarantees, and are outside of the massive retailer mainline retailer network that is legally recognized."

Dubai and Singapore are the leading destinations for sourcing iPhone Duo units for India, according to the retailers and industry stakeholders *Mint* spoke with. Buyers typically pay a premium over the prevailing retail price in these markets in exchange for faster delivery.

"While the iPhone Duo's current availability is that of the last week of January, grey market sellers lure buyers by claiming they'd deliver units to customers within a week or two. While this demand is not in hundreds or thousands, the phenomenon is popular among specific sellers because of the cash margin they generate," the first retailer cited above said.

For the iPhone Duo, the grey market premium ranges between ₹30,000 and ₹50,000 at the moment, *Mint* could learn.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

PREMIUM PURCHASE

THE iPhone Duo launched 2 months after Samsung's similarly shaped Galaxy Z Fold 8

BRANDS are separating premium devices in their portfolios while chip prices hit margins

THE iPhone Duo goes on sale on Friday at ₹2,99,900, versus ₹1.8 lakh for the Galaxy Z Fold 8

THE low availability of the device is prompting buyers to seek options in the grey market

Trading app Sahi seeks to raise up to $50 mn

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BENGALURU

Sahi, a stock trading app founded by former Swiggy chief technology officer Dale Vaz, is in talks to raise $40-50 million at a valuation of $400-500 million, two people aware of the development said. The company hired an investment bank last month to run the fundraising process, the people added.

"The company is pitching to Indian and overseas venture capital firms, but the talks are still at a very early stage," one of them said. *Mint* couldn't ascertain whether any new investors have committed to the round.

Sahi is pitching itself as an alternative to established discount brokers, combining lower brokerage fees with free, in-house charting tools and artificial intelligence (AI)-powered features, one of the people said.

Its AI assistant, Kyro, lets users analyse charts, review past trades and create custom indicators through plain-language instructions, according to the firm's website. However, trading decisions and order placement remain with the user.

At the upper end, the valuation would be 2.5 times the $200 million that Sahi was valued at in April, when it raised $33 million in a Series B round led by Accel's growth fund, with participation from Elevation Capital and Accel India.

Online brokers, primarily operating on a discount model, accounted for 76-78% of active NSE clients in FY25, up from 38-40% in FY20, per a 2025 study by consulting firm Redseer, commissioned by Groww for its IPO.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

MINT MEDIA MARKETING INITIATIVE

ITA brought three made-in-Italy labels to Lakmé Fashion Week 2026

The Italian Trade Agency (ITA), the Italian government agency that supports the business development of Italian companies abroad, presented three Italian fashion labels at the Lakmé Fashion Week 2026. The event that took place at The Taj Palace, Delhi on October 17, showcased, Eccellenza: The Artisans of Italian Style, and was held in collaboration with Confartigianato and the Fashion Design Council of India (FDCI), with the support of Camera Showroom Milano.

The labels presented were Avant Toi, LeoDean and UnbreakIT, each representing a different side of contemporary Italian craftsmanship.

Received with enthusiasm and appreciation by the audience, the collections were admired for their craftsmanship and design.

Avant Toi was founded in 1994 within Liapull, a Genoa knitwear company established in 1955 and now in its third generation. Known for hand-painted and artisanally treated cashmere and silk, it presented its Spring/Summer 2027 collection, Traces of Memory, inspired by the ancient Salt Roads between the Ligurian coast and Provence. Salt was used in dyeing cashmere knitwear and silk.

Moreno Vignolini, president of Confartigianato Moda; Antonietta Baccanari, trade commissioner, Italian Trade Agency; Antonio Bartoli, ambassador of Italy to India; and Sunil Sethi, FDCI chairperson.

LeoDean, led by Oliver Beach and Natalia, presented Between Land and Water, a wardrobe built for movement from city to coast. Fluid volumes recalled the sea, and the garments carried no visible logo, as the material carried the message.

UnbreakIT, a family-run label creatively directed by Giorgia Both, presented Dall'Alba alla Notte (from dawn to night). Every piece is made in Italy in printed silk and fluid jersey, and each collection begins with a print developed as a story drawn from cities, cinema, music and art.

Through its network of overseas offices, ITA provides information, assistance, consulting, promotion and training to small and medium-sized Italian businesses, working to promote the excellence of Made in Italy worldwide. It believes India's love for craftsmanship and community will help it appreciate the authenticity the designers bring.

BSE Sensex		Nifty 50		Nifty 500		Nifty Next 50		Nifty 100		BSE 150 MidCap		BSE 250 SmallCap	
CLOSE	73,852.90	CLOSE	22,888.95	CLOSE	22,041.60	CLOSE	68,695.85	CLOSE	23,895.45	CLOSE	15,842.73	CLOSE	6,826.87
PERCENT CHANGE	1.12	PERCENT CHANGE	0.73	PERCENT CHANGE	-0.34	PERCENT CHANGE	-0.22	PERCENT CHANGE	0.53	PERCENT CHANGE	-1.52	PERCENT CHANGE	-2.30
PREVIOUS CLOSE	-0.60	PREVIOUS CLOSE	-1.96	PREVIOUS CLOSE	-4.62	PREVIOUS CLOSE	-3.50	PREVIOUS CLOSE	-2.46	PREVIOUS CLOSE	-6.03	PREVIOUS CLOSE	-5.22
OPEN	-5.50	OPEN	-5.94	OPEN	-4.36	OPEN	-5.55	OPEN	-5.65	OPEN	-6.38	OPEN	-3.79
HIGH	-5.91	HIGH	-6.01	HIGH	-2.25	HIGH	-3.62	HIGH	-5.32	HIGH	-1.79	HIGH	4.29
LOW	-12.03	LOW	-10.97	LOW	-0.95	LOW	-6.60	LOW	-9.25	LOW	-2.30	LOW	0.10

HDFC to be on fast track soon

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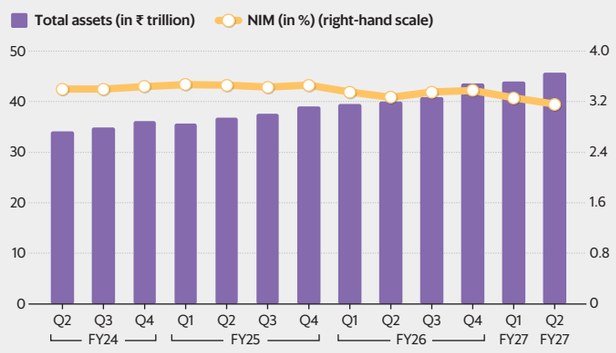
HDFC Bank's September-quarter (Q2FY27) results may not look impressive at first glance, possibly prompting the 2.3% fall in its shares on Monday. Profit after tax grew just 4.7% year-on-year to ₹19,510 crore, as net interest margin (NIM) fell to its lowest level in 12 quarters. NIM declined 10 basis points (bps) on-year and sequentially to 3.16%.

The decline may partly reflect interest outgo on foreign currency non-resident (bank) or FCNR (B) deposits raised last quarter, even as the yield on assets fell 20bps on-year to 7.6%. Notably, FCNR (B) deposits account for just 3% of HDFC Bank's total deposits, limiting their impact on overall financials. One basis point is one-hundredth of a percentage point.

Slower net profit growth relative to asset base growth meant that return on assets (RoA) fell 10bps on-year to 1.8%. Interestingly, net profit growth and RoA were impacted by a steep drop in treasury gains, which is not a part of core profitability.

Low point

HDFC Bank's Q2FY27 NIM was the weakest in at least the past twelve quarters due to pressure from FCNR (B) deposits.



NIM is net interest margin.
Source: Company presentations

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Despite the NIM decline, core pre-provisioning operating profit (PPoP) grew 12.6% on-year to ₹28,683 crore in Q2FY27. Net interest income grew nearly 10%, as 14.4% growth in total assets compensated for margin compression. Fee and commission income rose 10% to ₹9,700 crore.

Slippages (addition of new bad loans excluding those in seasonal agricultural loans) shrank 13% quarter-on-quarter to ₹5,400 crore, helping reduce overall gross NPA by 6bps sequentially to 1.11%. While the provisioning (cost of bad debt) rose sharply by 15% on-quarter to ₹3,574 crore, it is more because of general provision on standard assets. So, it is not worrisome.

Importantly, HDFC's loan growth in retail assets (excluding agriculture, payments and FCNR leverage loans) and business banking was 11.3% and 28.1% on-year, respectively, the fastest pace in at least five quarters. Within retail, lower-yielding mortgage loans grew more slowly, at 7.5%.

This is critical because non-mortgage retail assets and business banking loans fetch much higher yield on advances than corporate loans and mortgage loans. Higher yield on loans should help prevent further fall in NIM.

What else can further boost the yield on loans? It is the macro tailwind of a higher interest rate regime. The bank's loan book is nearly 70% on floating rate basis with most of it linked to repo rate, while the share of marginal cost of funds-based lending rate (MCLR) book is in single digit.

The recent repo rate hike of 25bps will start reflecting as higher yield in Q3FY27, but its positive impact on NIM may be offset by full impact of interest cost on FCNR (B) coming in Q3. Hence, the bank has guided for neutral to positive bias in NIM for Q3.

However, there could also be a macro headwind of non-performing asset (NPA) risk, especially from micro, small and medium enterprise (MSME) borrowers that are more vulnerable to the West Asia war-led spike in oil prices and supply chain disruptions. MSME formed 21% of the bank's gross advances at Q2-end. But its past track record in tackling asset quality issues across economic cycles is reassuring.

HELPING HAND

HDFC'S Q2FY27 loan growth in high yielding segments hits at least five-quarter high

MACRO tailwind of a higher rate regime should help as 70% of HDFC's loans linked to repo rate

If valuation of the bank's holdings in listed group firms, estimated at around ₹75 per share (excluding valuation of unlisted entities HDFC Ergo General Insurance and HDFC Securities), is deducted from its current market price, it is trading at a price-to-earnings multiple of 10, based on *Bloomberg* consensus earnings for FY27.

India Inc braces for muted salary hikes in 2027

FROM PAGE 1

Bigger rewards may be reserved for top performers. ISTOCKPHOTO

flatline," Nitin Razdan, partner and human capital consulting leader for Deloitte South Asia, told *Mint*. One trend could be "one-time bonuses replacing permanent salary hikes", as firms seek to reward employees without committing to higher fixed costs, he added.

Consumers facing tighter budgets are delaying big-ticket purchases, with the effects likely to be felt over the coming quarters by companies in FMCG, retail, e-commerce, logistics and other consumer-dependent industries. The information technology industry, too, reported a muted second quarter.

Average salary increases peaked in 2022, when high attrition and the acceleration of digital adoption after the pandemic pushed companies to compete aggressively for talent. Since then, the employment market has seen ups and downs. According to Aon, attrition was at around 18% in 2026, down from 21.4% in 2022. Employees in non-banking financial companies are projected to lead salary growth in 2027, with hikes of 10.1%, followed by energy at 9.9% and real estate and infrastructure at 9.8%.

Employees in non-banking financial companies are projected to lead salary growth in 2027

Recruiters, however, caution that these projections may be optimistic. "Inflationary pressures are likely to drive greater cost discipline across BFSI. Banking will see role rationalization at senior and mid levels, particularly in operational and low-end tech roles. Increments are seen averaging around 6-7%, compared with 8-9% in FY26, skewed towards top performers," said Upasana Agarwal, partner, professional and financial services at recruitment firm ABC Consultants.

Top performers, particularly those with AI skills, are still likely to command better rewards. Consulting firm WTW said firms continue to differentiate compensation, directing higher investments towards those with in-demand skills and critical talent.

Aon estimates top performers have got 2.24 times the variable pay and 1.85 times the salary increases of average performers. Senior management compensation typically includes a larger variable-pay part, linked to individual, team and company performance as well as market conditions. It can account for as much as 40% of the cost to company. "Sectors such as global capability centres (GCCs), manufacturing and pharma may see relatively stable increment levels, supported by ongoing investment and talent demand," said Jude Vijay, rewards data intelligence leader, India, at WTW. Sectors linked to consumer spending and global volatility may be more cautious, he added.

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DLF regains a growth catalyst in Q2 that needs to sustain

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After four quarters of a lull in new project launches, DLF made a comeback in the September quarter (Q2FY27). Pre-sales or bookings were higher than anticipated, zooming to ₹3,800 crore in Q2FY27 from ₹657 crore in Q1FY27. Sustained traction at the uber-luxury project The Dahlias, despite continued price hikes and a sell-out at the newly launched luxury retirement housing project The Aureva in Gurugram, led to the sequential surge. Pre-sales fell year-on-year due to a high base. DLF is seeing decent demand for its luxury offerings in the core market of Gurugram. Nuvama Research notes that while the Gurugram housing market is battling a slowdown, DLF's pedigree should help it navigate these challenges.

DLF's focus remains on higher margins and cash flow accretion rather than on sales bookings growth. Even so, with HIFY27 pre-sales at around ₹4,500 crore, meeting its FY27 pre-sales guidance of ₹20,000 crore is a tall ask. DLF would unveil the next phase of West Park in Mumbai in Q3 and Hamilton-2 at DLF City in Q4. These two launches have an estimated gross development value or revenue potential of ₹10,000-12,000 crore, said JM Financial Institutional Securities.

On solid ground

DLF's Q2FY27 pre-sales surged sequentially led by a new project launch and sustained sales in existing project.

Source: Company, JM Financial

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PRATEEK KUMAR/MINT

Pre-sales will also depend on the exhaustion of inventory in existing projects. Sales velocity at The Dahlias project could ramp up post the opening of the experience centre in December. DLF has cautioned about temporary disruptions in construction due to labour migration and pollution curbs in the National Capital Region (NCR), which could cause a delay of roughly 30-40 days, but remains hopeful of meeting construction timelines.

Further, it acquired a 7.06-acre land parcel in Q2 and will acquire another 7.48 acres adjoining its existing 28.5-acre land parcel in Sector 61, Gurugram. Although DLF is expanding geographically, concentration risk remains. Around 60% of its total land bank is in the NCR, which could restrict scaling up of operations, said Nuvama.

Meanwhile, rental growth in the commercial business would be supported by the Goa mall to open by December. The Downtown Chennai Blocks 4 and 5 are slated to be operational in 2027. The DLF stock is up around 13% in the last six months, outperforming the Nifty Realty index. DLF's comfortable cash position, robust collections, and medium-term launch pipeline of ₹58,230 crore are positives, but all eyes are now on timely H2 launches.

Mark to Market writers do not hold positions in the companies discussed here unless otherwise informed

Canara flags yield risk, bets on festive season

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Rising government bond yields pose a potential mark-to-market (MTM) provisioning risk for Canara Bank, even as the lender expects strong festive season demand for housing and vehicle loans, managing director (and chief executive Brajesh Kumar Singh told *Mint*.

The bank will assess the impact based on market conditions over the next six months, he said. Higher bond yields push down the market value of existing fixed-rate bonds, potentially requiring banks to recognize losses on investment portfolios and make additional provisions, depending on how the investments are classified and accounted for.

The yield on the 10-year government bond has risen from around 6.75% in June to approximately 7.38%, amid elevated crude oil prices and rising inflation. The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) recent rate increase has added to the pressure on yields, increasing the potential MTM risk for banks, Singh said.

The eventual impact would depend on yields prevailing on the relevant measurement date, Singh said. However, the impact would be relatively small compared with Canara Bank's overall business of around ₹30 trillion.

Canara Bank reported an 8.4% year-on-year rise in net profit to ₹5,175 crore in the September quarter, while net interest income rose 20.39% to ₹11,005 crore. However, treasury income declined 68.48% to ₹499 crore from ₹1,583 crore a year earlier, and profit on the sale of investments fell 87.43% to ₹153 crore, according to bank's investor presentation. It didn't quantify the impact of rising government bond yields or attribute the decline in treasury income specifically to bond yields.

Brajesh Kumar Singh, MD and CEO, Canara Bank.

The lender expects to sustain credit growth and protect margins in the coming quarters, supported by retail lending demand, improving recoveries and calibrated underwriting, he said.

The yield on the 10-year government bond has risen from around 6.75% in June to around 7.38% now

Canara Bank is currently recording year-on-year growth of 17.97% in advances and more than 14% in total business, exceeding its initial guidance for the fiscal year. The bank has retained its guidance of 11-12% growth in advances and 10-11% in total business for FY27 but is working to outperform these targets, Singh said.

Singh said the bank did not expect margins to shrink in the coming quarters, citing its underwriting standards, low slippages and focus on profitability and operational efficiency. "Our underwriting standards are good, slippages are less and gross NPAs are very minimal," he said, adding that the bank was following a calibrated approach to lending.

The bank's net interest margin (NIM) stood at 2.55% in the September quarter, Singh said. He added that the bank had not only protected its margins but also improved them, supported partly by changes in market yields.

On asset quality, fresh slippages remained at 0.15% of advances, unchanged from the previous quarter, Singh said. In absolute terms, slippages increased to ₹1,844 crore in the September quarter from ₹1,781 crore in June.

He attributed the increase to small amounts across different segments rather than stress concentrated in a particular sector.

Canara Bank's retail portfolio grew 31.61% year-on-year and 3.34% sequentially, Singh said, adding that the lender expected to maintain its growth momentum.

Housing and vehicle loans are expected to benefit from stronger seasonal demand during the festive period. The bank is also competing with non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) in vehicle finance, where lenders are seeking to capture a larger share of the market.

Canara Bank has introduced promotional measures, including waivers of processing charges, to attract borrowers. Singh said the bank's interest rates were competitive and that it expected to continue growing in the segment.

The lender had recorded vehicle-loan growth of more than 25% in the corresponding period last year, he said.

Canara Bank has mobilized around $5.8 billion through foreign currency non-resident (bank), or (FCNR(B), deposits, translating to approximately ₹55,000 crore, Singh said. He described the deposits as a stable source of funding, with tenures of three to five years, and said their cost was around 100 basis points below prevailing market benchmarks.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com

Gene editing is giving crops a way to tell farmers when they're feeling stressed

FROM PAGE 1

every year, whether the crop needed it or not, giving him the idea that more needed to be done in terms of dedicated crop protection.

Insignum uses gene editing to "switch on" traits already within the plant's DNA. "Plants have the ability to respond to disease within minutes from where it starts, but we [the farmers] just do not know for days or weeks," says Mohler, adding that Insignum's technology allows farmers to react much more quickly.

Insignum uses gene editing to 'switch on' traits already within the plant's DNA. ISTOCKPHOTO

Hurdles await

Some scientists say plants designed to emit early stress signals could provide a productivity boost to farmers battling climate and environmental pressures.

"We're looking at both population growth and changes in global temperatures having impacts on agricultural productivity over the next century, so all of these technologies can help eke out more yield, as growing conditions get stressed in different ways," says Sean Cutler , plant biology professor at the University of California, Riverside, and a co-founder of Living Sensors, which uses a technology similar to InnerPlant's to detect forever chemicals, known as PFAS, in soil.

Stopping issues such as herbicide drift, where farmers spray chemicals onto their land and through wind it moves miles away and damages other crops, would be another advantage, he says.

How quickly these plants work their way into the wider food chain, however, remains a question. Most of the technologies are still in the testing phase, and will require regulatory approval thereafter.

There are other hurdles that could hinder adoption. Some markets, like the European Union, ban the sale of food that has significant edits to its genome like the kind designed by InnerPlant and Insignum. In the U.S., there are some gene-edited crops on the market but many consumers remain wary, worried that genetically modified or edited foods might carry health risks. Adopting new plants also could be costly for farmers, especially if they have to invest in new technologies such as drones and satellites or tractors with cameras.

High costs, slow approval processes and outright bans to using these kinds of technology "makes it tough for these sorts of biology companies to get off the ground and thrive," says Jones, the University of Cambridge professor. Still, he says he believes "the drawbacks are few and minor and no longer justify the legal and policy roadblocks."

Alternative approaches

Some scientists say that if the goal is to boost agricultural output and restore the environment, the emphasis should be on soil health, not genetically modified plants.

"Genetically modifying crops for this purpose means altering future generations of plants to come, and we're not certain what the repercussions might be down the line," says Praveena Sridhar, chief science and technology officer at Save Soil, a nonprofit focused on improving soil health.

Technologies such as photonic monitoring, where light particles are monitored to track plant health or stresses, and improved integrated pest-management systems can deliver the same benefits as genetically modified crops without the unknown long-term risks, Sridhar says. "We can reduce chemical inputs, restore soil health and improve yields through these alternative approaches," she says.

Meanwhile, companies such as British startup Viridys Bio are trying to create biological sensors external to plants to detect when they're in stress. The company's technology stems from sensors used to detect land mines in war zones by looking for explosive residues. The company is rewiring those sensors to detect small molecules released in the air by plants known as volatiles, which are especially useful in greenhouses.

"When an aphid nibbles on a leaf, the volatile release attracts ladybirds in a very simplistic sense," says Stuart Dixon, co-founder of the early-stage company. "If you can tap in to that language, we felt that we could turn that invisible cue into something that was visible," he says.

Dixon says that the technologies should be able to help growers react to issues more quickly and accurately, adding that most crop-protection chemicals rarely hit their intended target.

"Most of it runs off, and obviously that's really damaging," he says.

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Auto parts makers forging global tie-ups for tech edge

Tie-ups span powertrains, ADAS, automotive electronics, seating, digital cockpit and EV cells

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At least three Indian auto component makers—Sona Comstar, Gabriel India and Varroc Engineering—have tied up with global auto part companies looking to expand their India play to add products and capabilities in new technologies and catch up with larger rivals.

The partnerships this fiscal span areas ranging from electric and hybrid powertrains, advanced driver assistance systems (ADAS), advanced automotive seating systems and electric vehicle battery packs, among others, as Indian part makers look to expand their presence in the premium and electric vehicle segments.

Sona Comstar has partnered with Japan's Denso for automotive powertrain technologies. Gabriel India has tied up with South Korea's HL Klemove for ADAS and automotive electronics and France's Forvia for advanced seating systems. Varroc has partnered with Suzhou Tolyy Optronics Co of China to localize digital cockpit solutions, including display modules, for global vehicle programmes and with Forsee Power of France for EV battery packs.

While joint ventures are not new in the auto parts sector, the back-to-back partnership agreements with global companies indicate an urgency to catch up with advanced technologies and designs to tap growing opportunities in the domestic market.

Sona Comstar, Gabriel India and Varroc Engineering have entered into global partnerships to expand their technology capabilities and product portfolios.

"The component industry has to get into the higher gear to be globally competitive not only in manufacturing and capacity but also in 'creation' of proprietary solutions," Avik Chattopadhyay, founder of the Indian School for Design of Automobiles, XLRI, Delhi NCR, said.

"For this, focus on indigenous design and research capabilities is crucial."

To be evaluated at the same level of a Bosch or Aumovio, Indian component brands must build their own design strength through internal design studios and also collaborations with design domain experts, he said.

"To be recognized globally, the component industry has to be creatively competitive," Chattopadhyay added.

The partnerships point to a broader strategy among Indian component makers to tap global technology and engineering expertise to move into faster-growing areas rather than build expensive new capabilities from scratch. Global suppliers are using these tie-ups to deepen their presence in India without building the entire local ecosystem themselves.

India is a key growth market for global carmakers. Hyundai Motor Company, Renault SA, Suzuki Motor Corp, Honda Motor Company and Stellantis NV are stepping up investment commitments in the Indian market and plan a product offensive to tap the growing passenger vehicle market, which is expected to hit the 5 million mark this year.

Upgrading capabilities in premium features in vehicles and advanced technologies driving software have become key owing to the rising share of SUVs from about a fourth of the passenger vehicle market in FY19 to more than half in FY26.

Electric vehicles, which are software defined and have advanced tech features, are witnessing high growth, with 84% surge in sales to almost 200,000 units in FY26, as per Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations. The share of EVs in passenger vehicles rose to 8.5% in September from 5.7% a year earlier.

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MOVING UP THE VALUE CHAIN

SONA Comstar has partnered Japan's Denso to develop powertrain tech for EV and hybrid cars

GABRIEL India tied up with HL Klemove for electronics and ADAS, and Forvia for advanced seating

VARROC partnered with Suzhou Tolyy for digital cockpits and Forsee Power for EV batteries

INDUSTRY experts say indigenous design and research capabilities are key for Indian suppliers

Silent shareholders hold the key to Tata Motors' Iveco deal

FROM PAGE 1

The strongest opposition from non-promoter shareholders was to the appointment of Chandrasekaran as Iveco chair. REUTERS

many investors not to participate in the EGM," a Tata Motors executive close to the deal said on condition of anonymity. "Shares of Iveco are trading below the offer price, so the price is fair."

All EGM resolutions were approved on majority vote.

At the end of 19 October, shareholders had tendered 31.19% of Iveco's shares, up around 3 percentage points since the offer price hike. The offer closes on 26 October, leaving Tata with little time.

Tata needs support from 80% of current shareholders to delist Iveco because, under Dutch rules, the remaining minority investors would have to tender shares at the price once it gets support from 80%.

If Tata Motors crosses the 66.67% threshold but falls short of 80%, it can waive the higher threshold and complete the acquisition of shares tendered. However, this would complicate its plans for full control, as Tata couldn't squeeze out remaining shareholders, delist Iveco or implement the planned demerger and post-offer restructuring. Iveco would remain listed with minority shareholders.

If Tata crosses the 66.67% threshold but falls short of 80%, it can waive higher threshold and end tendered shares' acquisition

It is unclear whether Tata would pursue the deal if it doesn't achieve the required 80% threshold. It did not respond to *Mint*'s email.

In July 2025, Tata Motors had first announced it will acquire Iveco's commercial vehicle business for about €3.8 billion, and said it aimed to buy 100% of its shares, delist it to make the firm wholly-owned.

The strongest opposition from non-promoter shareholders was to the appointment of Chandrasekaran as Iveco chair. A total of 37.27 million votes, making about 13.7% of Iveco's 271.2 million common shares, were cast against this, compared with 211.93 million in favour. About 34.05 million votes were cast against JLR chief executive Balaji and 35.61 million against Tata Motors' Wagh.

Norges, Norway's sovereign wealth fund and world's largest, voted in favour of all resolutions, according to filings reviewed by *Mint*. It held a 2.53% stake in Iveco at the time. British asset manager Schroders, which managed $1.1 trillion in assets as of June, also said yes to all 16 resolutions. It held about 1.2% of Iveco.

Legal & General Investment Management (LGIM), UK's largest fund manager, backed the transaction and the appointment of Chandrasekaran, but opposed Wagh.

The California Public Employees' Retirement System backed the transaction but opposed appointment of Tata nominees. The Canada Pension Plan Investment Board abstained.

The uncertainty has brought into focus the challenges Tata faces in navigating the takeover's final stages.

"Takeovers like this are won on tendered shares, not votes. Holdout resistance from funds is routine in European offers, and Tata has sensibly built fallback routes, said Rajesh Sivaswamy, a senior partner at King Stubb and Kasiva.

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Women-led stories are finding their voice in India's OTT boom

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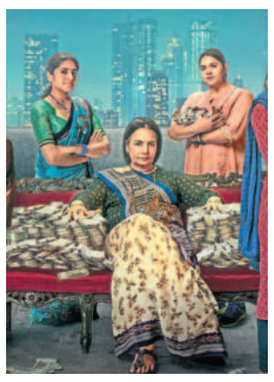
Female-led web originals are gaining traction on India's OTT platforms, generating 47% higher peak buzz than male-led shows despite accounting for a much smaller share of content.

While the first wave of popular Hindi streaming franchises was largely male-centric, with shows such as *Sacred Games*, *Mirzapur* and *Paatal Lok* breaking out, data from media consulting firm Ormax shows that series headlined by female protagonists generated 47% higher peak buzz than those led by male protagonists over the past few months.

Prominent series contributing to this higher peak buzz include popular shows such as *Mrs. Deshpande*, *Chiraiya*, *Mandala Murders*, *Dabba Cartel*, *Daldal*, *Khauf* and *Search: The Naina Murder Case*.

One major reason for this trend is the relative scarcity of female-led shows. They account for only 22% of the sample, compared with 52% for male-led shows. Scarcity becomes an advantage, particularly when the dominant narrative template starts feeling familiar, Ormax said.


Dabba Cartel has been a popular show on Netflix.

Further, female-led stories often extend beyond the familiar genres of crime, action and thrillers to explore themes such as agency, identity, social expectations, safety, ambition and systemic barriers.

As connected TV brings streaming into the shared living-room environment, these stories may also be benefiting from a shift that helps them attract interest beyond a single audience segment.

"Audiences ultimately connect with compelling storytelling, relatable characters, memorable performances, and authentic narratives, irrespective of who leads the story. That said, we've seen several female-led series in recent years resonate deeply because they've brought fresh perspectives and challenged conventional narratives," a JioStar spokesperson said.

Shows such as *HeartBeat, Mrs. Deshpande, Chiraiya* and *Search* have gone beyond entertainment to spark conversations around identity, ambition, relationships, social norms and representation, extending their cultural impact well beyond the screen and into everyday life, the person added.

Raghavendra Hunsur, chief content officer at Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd, agreed that audiences are seeking greater representation of different perspectives and experiences, and stories centred on women have naturally become an important part of that evolution.

"Through our language-first approach and locally nuanced storytelling, we create narratives that resonate with diverse communities across urban and regional India. When stories reflect everyday realities with honesty and emotional depth, they naturally spark conversations and build lasting engagement," Hunsur said.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

Oyo parent halves IPO size

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Oyo parent Prism is planning to nearly halve the size of the fresh issue in its proposed initial public offering (IPO) to up to ₹3,350 crore from almost ₹6,650 crore, sources said on Tuesday, seeking anonymity.

People familiar with the matter told *PTI* the reduction in the issue size follows continued strong cash generation and an improving balance-sheet position, which has lowered the amount of capital the company needs to raise compared with what was originally envisaged. "The original issue was sized before the company's more recent financial performance came through. With cash generation remaining strong and the balance sheet improving, the funding requirement has come down, allowing the company to reduce the amount of primary capital it raises.

"The objective is to raise what the business needs while keeping the capital structure efficient. The plan is to repay the residual debt over the next two to three years through cash flows generated by the business," a person familiar with the matter said.

OYO's parent company Prism plans to nearly halve its IPO fresh issue from ₹6,650 crore to ₹3,350 crore

Earlier, OYO had planned to raise up to ₹6,650 crore through an IPO, of which around ₹5,000 crore was intended for debt repayment.

The revised issue size comes with Prism continuing to focus on reducing its total outstanding debt.

Under the revised structure, most of the issue proceeds are proposed to be used towards repayment or prepayment, in part or full, of certain borrowings.

The revised issue comes as PRISM moves towards the next stage of its proposed IPO following its earlier filing of the UDRHP (updated draft herring prospectus).

Moody's Ratings revised the outlook on Prism to 'positive' from 'stable', while reaffirming the travel tech unicorn's B2 corporate family rating.

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*Q2 FY 2026-27 vs Q2 FY 2025-26

LOAN DISBURSEMENTS* ₹10,579 crore Up by 31%
LOAN BOOK* ₹97,411 crore Up by 15%
REVENUE FROM OPERATIONS* ₹2,345 crore Up by 14%
NET WORTH* ₹14,337 crore Up by 11%
NET NPAs* 1.08% Improved by 45%

Extract of Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year Ended September 30, 2026

(₹ in crores)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended
		30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26	30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	2,344.75	2,249.54	2,057.45	4,594.29	4,016.98	8,337.48	2,346.88	2,250.60	2,057.85	4,597.48	4,017.69	8,338.89
2.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	706.57	412.72	696.07	1,119.28	1,000.70	2,336.92	704.45	413.75	696.39	1,118.20	1,001.23	2,337.58
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	706.57	412.72	696.07	1,119.28	1,000.70	2,336.92	704.45	413.75	696.39	1,118.20	1,001.23	2,337.58
4.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	554.26	337.50	549.00	891.75	795.68	1,873.34	552.14	338.53	549.33	890.67	796.21	1,874.00
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after Tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after Tax)]	427.65	277.65	614.00	705.30	879.38	1,993.46	425.99	278.30	614.76	704.29	880.97	1,997.15
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹10/- each)	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23
7.	Other Equity	11,528.17	11,323.27	10,110.95	11,528.17	10,110.95	10,972.12	11,531.21	11,327.96	10,112.92	11,531.21	10,112.92	10,976.19
8.	Securities Premium Account (net)	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56						
9.	Net Worth	14,337.40	14,132.50	12,920.18	14,337.40	12,920.18	13,781.35						
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt	80,882.38	79,002.01	69,939.39	80,882.38	69,939.39	77,845.63						
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	5.64	5.59	5.41	5.64	5.41	5.65						
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)												
	A. Basic:	1.97	1.20	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73	1.97	1.21	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73
	B. Diluted:	1.97	1.20	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73	1.97	1.21	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73
13.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	439.01	-	439.01	-	-	-	439.01	-	439.01	-

Notes:
a) The above results have been recommended by the Audit Committee of Directors and approved by the Board of Directors in their respective meetings held on 19.10.2026 and have been audited by the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company.
b) The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly & half yearly financial results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI LODR Regulations. The full format of the said financial results are available on the website of the Company, www.ireda.in/financial-results, and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com.
c) For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI LODR Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges and can be accessed at www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com, respectively.

For and on Behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty
Chairman & Managing Director (Addl. Charge);
Director (Finance)
DIN No.: 08816532

Date: 19.10.2026
Place: New Delhi

INDIAN RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
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Fortum nixes Glida sale, plans to run EV charging unit

Manas Pimpalkhare
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NEW DELHI

Fortum's talks with JBM Group have been called off. ISTOCKPHOTO

Finnish state-run energy utility Fortum Oyj has scrapped the plan to sell Glida, its electric vehicle (EV) charging network business in India, to the promoters of the Gurugram-headquartered JBM Group, said two people aware of the development.

Instead, the Finnish energy major plans to continue operating its Glida charger brand, with 961 charging points across the country, according to people cited above who requested anonymity. "The stake sale for Glida has been cancelled. Fortum plans to run Glida on its own in India," said one of the people cited above.

This comes against the backdrop of India's green mobility push, which depends on an effective EV charging network, as the country's electric mobility ecosystem expands and investments in vehicle, component, and charger manufacturing increase.

EV adoption has risen from 4.71% in 2022 to 8.05% in 2025, and crossed 10% in the January-October period in 2026

Electric vehicle adoption has increased from 4.71% in 2022 to 8.05% in 2025, and crossed 10% in the January-October period in 2026, data from the government's Vahan registry of new vehicles showed. About 2.65 million electric vehicles were sold through 16 October, compared with 2.35 million in 2025 and 2.02 million in 2024, indicating a steady rise in adoption.

India is the world's largest electric three-wheeler market and the world's third-largest e-bus market, according to the 2026 Global EV Outlook by the International Energy Agency (IEA), based on 2025 performance. JBM Group was India's largest e-bus manufacturer by sales, with 1,260 e-buses sold in FY26.

Some of the largest charge point operators (CPOs) in India are state-run oil marketing companies, including Indian Oil Corp., Hindustan Petroleum Corp., and Bharat Petroleum Corp.

JBM Group's e-bus business had an order book of ₹12,900 crore as of September 2026, according to a company statement, largely driven by orders for overhauling public fleets under the PM e-Bus Sewa scheme.

Global economic headwinds, such as conflict-driven supply chain disruptions during the US-Iran war earlier this year, pushed crude oil prices above $100 per barrel at times, posing a challenge for India, which has near-90% dependence on oil imports.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

Polycab case bares small cos wielding IBC sword for dues

Admission into insolvency can trigger regulatory disclosures and affect investor confidence

Krishna Yadav
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NEW DELHI

For listed firms, admission into the CIRP can trigger regulatory disclosures. MINT

Bankruptcy proceedings initiated by vendors and suppliers over unpaid dues from large companies are in focus after the insolvency court admitted a plea against wire and cable maker Polycab India on 7 October over an alleged operational debt of ₹2.79 crore claimed by supplier Asier Metals.

The move raised concern among bankruptcy lawyers, given Polycab's strong financial position, with a net cash balance of ₹4,194 crore and shareholders' net worth of ₹12,009 crore in FY26. On 9 October, the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) stayed the admission order passed against Polycab by the Ahmedabad bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT).

Insolvency experts said such cases show how proceedings can exert commercial pressure on firms even when the amount claimed is relatively small compared with their financial position.

"The case highlights an important concern in the existing IBC (Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code) framework. Even a financially sound company may find itself facing insolvency proceedings over a relatively small operational debt," said Pooja Chakrabarti, partner at Argus Partners.

Amir Bavani, founder of AB Legal, Hyderabad, said the IBC was not intended as a debt-recovery tool, but is often leveraged to compel firms into settling payments. "While the inherent ethos of the code has always been to shun recovery tactics, it's true that IBC proceedings are more often than not employed as a pressure tactic to induce repayment."

Under IBC, an operational creditor can initiate insolvency proceedings for a default of at least ₹1 crore, subject to statutory norms and the absence of a genuine pre-existing dispute over the debt. Operational creditors include suppliers, vendors and service providers, many of which are micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

For listed firms, admission into the corporate insolvency resolution process (CIRP) can trigger regulatory disclosures and hit investor confidence, lender ties and business operations.

"Its consequences can create substantial commercial pressure on a corporate debtor to settle outstanding claims even if the amount involved is relatively modest," said Vidya K., partner at King Stubb & Kasiva.

A Polycab spokesperson said in response to *Mint*'s queries, "We do not expect any adverse/material impact on financial or business operations arising from the said order. We continue to hold a zero-debt position with the cash/investment liquidity and our balance sheet remains strong with net cash position in excess of Rs.4,000 crore and net worth of Rs 11,682 crores as per the audited financial statements for FY26." The company said it was committed to conducting business with the "highest standards of transparency, integrity, and governance".

The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India and the MSME ministry are yet to respond to *Mint*'s queries.

Data from the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India show that operational creditors had initiated 4,162 insolvency proceedings as of 30 June 2026. Of these, 893 were withdrawn, 930 closed following appeal, review or settlement, 452 resulted in approved resolution plans, and 1,271 led to liquidation. Another 616 remain ongoing.

Courts have also cautioned against using the IBC merely to recover money. In April 2026, the Supreme Court, hearing Anjani Technoplast v. Shubh Gautam said the process "must be reserved for cases of genuine insolvency or financial distress, not for enforcement of money decrees".

Last May, NCLAT had dismissed an appeal by supplier SNJ Synthetics against PepsiCo India over alleged dues and interest of about ₹1.97 crore, holding IBC couldn't be used as a debt-recovery tool in the case.

Yogendra Aldak, executive partner at Lakshmikumaran & Sridharan, said listed firms should respond promptly to insolvency proceedings, maintain documents and take timely legal action.

"For an MSME, initiating insolvency proceedings doesn't guarantee payment. It may incur legal costs and face delays, and ultimately recover less than the amount owed," said Vinod Kumar, president of India SME Forum.

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BANKRUPTCY BLUES

THE insolvency court admitted a plea against wire and cable maker Polycab India on 7 October

THE plea was raised over an alleged operational debt of ₹2.79 crore claimed by supplier Asier

MOVE raised worry among bankruptcy lawyers, given Polycab's strong financial position

ON 9 Oct, NCLAT stayed admission order passed against Polycab by a bench of the NCLT

Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon. BLOOMBERG

Qualcomm to cut jobs globally in merit-based layoffs

Reuters
feedback@livemint.com

Qualcomm will cut jobs globally in a "performance-focused reduction" following its annual employee reviews, chief executive officer (CEO) Cristiano Amon told staff in a memo on Monday.

The memo was reviewed by *Reuters*, with notifications set to begin in November.

The cuts are part of an effort to build "a stronger performance culture" and address situations where the company "has consistently fallen short of expectations," Amon said. It did not say how many jobs would be affected, and *Reuters* could not immediately determine the scale of the cuts.

Qualcomm did not immediately respond to a request for comment. It had about 52,000 employees globally as of September last year, most of them full-time. Its financial year typically ends in late September.

One of the world's biggest smartphone chipmakers, Qualcomm has been hit this year by a slump in consumer electronics sales as soaring memory prices weigh on demand in key markets.

Its shares have risen just 1.5% in 2026, compared with gains of more than 12% for the benchmark S&P 500 and nearly 60% for the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index.

The Qualcomm stock was down about 0.5% in early trading on Tuesday.

In its latest earnings report in late July, Qualcomm forecast quarterly profit below estimates and said revenue from Apple products would decline faster than expected, while signalling that growth in data-centre and other non-handset businesses would more than offset the lost revenue by fiscal 2027.

The company expects the majority of its chip sales to come from businesses other than smartphones in fiscal 2027 as it expands into the fast-growing AI data-center market.

Amon said in the memo business priorities, organizational needs, skills and expertise would be considered in making the cuts.

"As we have expanded the business, so have the competencies and skills we require," Amon wrote. "We must have the right people in the right roles so they can perform at their best and the company can continue to succeed."

Export tax refund schemes set for a rejig

FROM PAGE 1

up by the revenue department recommends refund rates under the schemes after examining official and industry data on levies and taxes paid by exporters. It also assesses representations by export bodies and consults government officials and other stakeholders.

Following the EFC's recommendations, this system may be revamped to move towards a more precise, evidence-based system to reflect the embedded taxes and duties actually paid.

Mint had last month reported that the commerce ministry has sought over ₹1.3 trillion under RoDTEP for the next five years, up 70% from the previous five years, while the textiles ministry wanted the RoSCTL outlay to go up by a half to about ₹65,000 crore.

The EFC, an interministerial body under the expenditure secretary, evaluates major central schemes and projects before they are placed before the Cabinet for clearance.

Eligible exporters receive refunds ranging from 0.3% to about 4.7% of the free-on-board value of consignments under RoDTEP, and 1.7-8.2% under RoSCTL. The commerce and textile ministries maintain that the schemes are compliant with the World Trade Organization rules.

Timely reimbursements unlock liquidity blocked in taxes. BLOOMBERG

Timely reimbursements unlock liquidity blocked in taxes and help Indian exporters compete better against counterparts from countries where such embedded taxes are lower or fully refunded.

Demand for higher allocations reflects expectations that exporters will up shipments in the coming years

Queries on the plan emailed to the secretaries of expenditure, commerce and textiles, and to the DGFT remained unanswered until press time.

Exporters received ₹18,233 crore under RoDTEP in the fiscal year 2026 and another ₹10,100 crore under RoSCTL. The validity of both schemes was extended last month from 30 September to 31 December, pending a final decision on their extension for the next five years.

"Any better targeting mechanism is welcome. But the panel will have a tough task at hand. It will be very difficult to precisely identify and gather data on all the duty incidences at every stage because there are multiple stages and sectors like textiles and garments are highly dispersed," said D.K. Nair, textiles expert and former secretary-general of the Confederation of Indian Textile Industry. "So, some level of averaging of levies is inevitable in such industries."

Ajay Sahai, director-general and chief executive of the Federation of Indian Export Organisations, last month told *Mint* that the continuation of both the schemes with adequate allocation for another five years "would be extremely important, as it signals policy stability at a very challenging time for exporters".

The demand for higher allocations reflects expectations that exporters will ramp up shipments in the coming years, taking advantage of India's recent free trade agreements with the UAE, the UK and the EU once the ongoing West Asia conflict abates.

India's merchandise exports rose 18.5% year-on-year to $260 billion in the first half of FY27 as global demand remained strong. Textile and garment exports, however, grew just about 2.4% during the period.

Defensive buyers desperate as options in IT, FMCG thin out

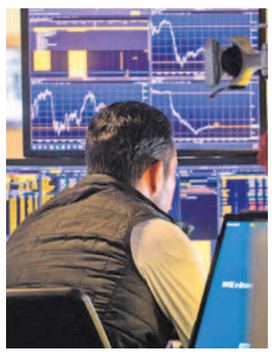
FROM PAGE 1

investment trusts (Reits) and infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs), Krishnan said.

Chockalingam Narayanan, head, equities-alternates, ICICI Prudential AMC, said stock returns are driven by earnings growth, particularly volume-led growth, and P/E re-rating backed by improving return on equity (RoE). He sees opportunities in select D2C FMCG companies and mid-sized IT companies, some of which are part of the AMC's portfolios.

Investors also tend to have a recency bias when viewing these sectors as defensive. They commanded premium valuations in 2010-2020 amid benign global interest rates and predictable earnings, but not in the 2000s or 2020s. "So, it's eventually a cycle," he said.

Some of these companies have expanded their margins through reinvestments that have not sustained their growth, leading to disruption and the entry of newer companies, Narayanan said.


Nifty IT surged 166% in 2009 and 60% in 2021. BLOOMBERG

Rather, their recent underperformance raises a more consequential question: are these former market favourites turning into contrarian opportunities?

Agarwal of Ambit Asset Management would look for stabilizing client spending, faster deal conversion into revenues, positive earnings revisions and AI-led growth in IT stocks. For FMCG, he would look for sustained volume growth rather than price-led growth, better execution in quick commerce and a recovery in rural consumption.

"A lower share price alone does not create a contrarian opportunity," said Sachin Relekar, senior equity fund manager, Axis Mutual Fund. A sector becomes attractive when expectations and valuations have reset, and earnings outlook begins to stabilise or improve, he added.

"The strongest contrarian opportunity arises when market expectations remain cautious, but earnings revisions stop falling and begin to turn positive. That is more meaningful than a stock merely trading below its historical valuation," he said.

So, where should investors look for defensiveness today?

Relekar prefers picking defensive businesses over replacing IT and FMCG with another fixed list of defensive sectors. Such characteristics can be found selectively across healthcare, utilities and financial services, he said.

Relekar sees selective opportunities in pharma, financials and utilities, though regulatory and valuation risks remain.

The LaLiT bets ₹600 crore on expansion, to add 1,000 rooms

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NEW DELHI

The LaLiT Suri Hospitality Group has earmarked an investment of ₹600 crore over the next five years to add about 1,000 rooms to its portfolio in hotels it owns and via management contracts in new markets, the company's top executive told *Mint*.

"We plan to invest ₹600 crore in properties where we own the land, while using management contracts to expand where our partners bring the capital. Whether we own a property or manage one, every hotel of ours will carry the same spirit and character," said Jyotsna Suri, chairperson and managing director.

The group owned by Bharat Hotels Ltd plans to add roughly half the new rooms in properties it owns in Ahmedabad and Chitrakoot and the remainder through management contracts. The expansion will take its inventory from 2,300 rooms to about 3,300, an increase of 43%. The company, which has flagship five-star hotels in Delhi, Mumbai and Kashmir, operates 14 hotels across the country, including 12 luxury properties branded 'The LaLiT' and two mid-market hotels under 'The LaLiT Traveller' brand.

Suri said the capital expenditure will be deployed in phases over the next five years. Of this, ₹500 crore is earmarked for projects at five locations – in Ahmedabad, where it has already deployed ₹104 crore, besides Chitrakoot, Bekal, Goa and Udaipur. The rest, ₹100 crore, will be allocated toward maintenance and refurbishment across its 12 locations.

The investment is expected to be funded through internal accruals and savings, the company added, citing a reduction in interest costs over the past two years. Any additional funding would be arranged through debt from scheduled commercial banks.

Its owned-property pipeline includes a 240-room five-star hotel in Ahmedabad, expected to open ahead of the 2030 Commonwealth Games, and a property of about 50 rooms in Chitrakoot. The group plans to add 100 rooms at Bekal resort, 50 rooms at its Goa hotel and 55 rooms at Udaipur.

Jyotsna Suri, chairperson and managing director of the LaLiT Suri Hospitality Group.

The Ahmedabad project has been under development since FY10. It said it would invest ₹150-200 crore over the next few years.

In terms of management contracts, Vrindavan will be the first destination, with the signing of a property of about 75 rooms. It is also exploring opportunities in Chennai, Hyderabad, Leh, Varanasi, Ayodhya, Lakshadweep, Siliguri and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, among other destinations. It is targeting close to 20 management contracts over the next few years.

GROWTH PUSH

THE hospitality group seeks to grow its inventory by 43% to 3,300 rooms over the next five years

ABOUT half the new rooms will be added in owned properties, and the rest through management tie-ups

The expansion comes as hotel companies seek to add rooms to capitalize on domestic travel demand, while relying on management agreements to grow without investing the full cost of acquiring land and developing properties. In June, *Mint* reported that Bharat Hotels was prioritizing consolidation of its portfolio before revisiting its initial public offering plans. Executive director Deeksha Suri told *Mint* that the company was looking at management contracts and joint development agreements rather than an aggressive asset acquisition strategy. It also planned to continue investing selectively in owned hotels.

"The focus right now is consolidation. Our current mix (of hotels) itself is good enough to show substantial growth. The Indian traveller is keeping the industry going," Suri had said.

Bharat Hotels reported consolidated net sales of ₹906.7 crore in FY25, up 5.1% from ₹862.3 crore in FY24. Operating profit rose 5.9% to ₹384.8 crore from ₹363.4 crore, show Registrar of Companies data accessed by Tofler. Its FY26 results are yet to be audited.

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Jio IPO draws lender, broker push for retail participation

The push comes at a time when the broader Indian market is gripped by negative sentiment

Agnidev Bhattacharya
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MUMBAI

On Monday, Jio Platforms Ltd tapped into record institutional demand when it allocated shares worth ₹8,110 crore in its initial public offer to anchor investors among top names in the global finance.

Next, India's biggest telecom operator by subscribers is aiming at retail investors who will buy into its share sale, potentially the largest IPO in India. The ₹10,500 crore retail portion of the offer opens for subscription on Wednesday and closes on Friday.

Financial institutions and brokerages are stepping up efforts to draw retail investors into the ₹30,213-crore IPO, as syndicate bankers aim for strong retail demand and a successful listing. "Platforms have been asked to focus their outreach on active as well as inactive trading accounts to build retail volume," said a person familiar with the matter, who asked not to be identified because the details are private. "The effort aims to sustain retail buying interest through the listing date."

The push comes at a time when the broader Indian market is gripped by negative sentiment, with the benchmark Nifty 50 down more than 10% this year, making it one of Asia's worst-performing indexes. "Considering the size of the book and the lacklustre market conditions, good retail participation will be important to ensure a listing pop," said a person involved in syndicating the offer.

Investors such as Life Insurance Corp. of India, BlackRock Inc., Fidelity Management & Research, Capital Group and Allianz SE, besides sovereign wealth funds, including the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority, the Government of Singapore, the Qatar Investment Authority and Norges Bank Investment Management have taken anchor positions in the offer, a stock exchange filing by Jio Platforms showed.

Syndicate bankers aim for strong retail demand and a successful listing. BLOOMBERG

Brokerages and non-banking financial companies, including SBI Securities Ltd and Jio Financial Services Ltd, are advertising short-term loans to investors through apps and text messages to help them participate in the IPO.

Mint reviewed a text message from HDFC Securities Ltd to a retail investor with an inactive trading account, encouraging the client to participate in the IPO. "Hey there, we tried calling you about the Jio IPO," the message read. "Your trading account is inactive. Reactivate now and stay investment-ready," it added.

The message did not indicate that the platform was offering loans specifically to finance applications for Jio shares. *Mint* also reviewed banner advertisements by Axis Direct urging prospective investors to ensure they have active accounts to invest in the IPO.

On 16 October, *Bloomberg* reported that Reliance Industries had released employee salaries 15 days ahead of schedule to encourage participation in the offer. The report also said the company had reached out to most of its 420,000 employees across group firms, asking them to participate in the IPO.

Emails sent to spokespersons for Reliance Industries and Jio Platforms did not elicit responses by press time.

Institutions are offering margin funding covering 60% to 90% of the total application value, according to terms reviewed by *Mint*. Loan tenures range from 15 to 90 days, with allotted shares held by lenders as collateral until the loans are fully repaid.

Short-term IPO financing is an established practice in India's capital markets. Investors regularly use margin funding from non-banks and brokerages to increase their bidding capacity and the amount they can apply for.

While IPO financing is a standard offering across financial institutions, targeted advertising campaigns promoting credit are rare; historically, brokerages have marketed general-purpose leveraged trading accounts.

Neither India's markets regulator nor its banking regulator has rules against such offers. "IPO financing has been offered around earlier large public issues; the current concern is the scale and direct marketing of leverage around one issuer," said Alay Razvi, managing partner at law firm Accord Juris.

Weak retail demand can weigh on listing-day gains even when an issue is oversubscribed overall, which makes broad retail participation important for an issuer through its debut.

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INVESTOR OUTREACH

INDIA'S biggest telco by subscribers is aiming at retail investors for its share sale

THE ₹10,500 crore retail portion of the offer opens for subscription on Wednesday

LIC, BlackRock, Capital Group, Fidelity, Allianz SE have taken anchor positions in the offer

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Match eyes India growth amid dating-app safety concerns

Varuni Khosla
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NEW DELHI

Yoel Roth, head of trust and safety at Match Group, says the company sees significant headroom in India.

Match Group is doubling down on India as a growth market for Tinder and Hinge, even as dating-app scams attract greater scrutiny from regulators and lawmakers globally.

The company sees significant headroom in India, driven by rising smartphone use, wider internet access and still-low dating-app adoption compared with markets such as the US, said senior vice president and head of trust and safety, Yoel Roth, who was in India last week. That optimism comes amid growing concerns over online fraud. The scrutiny comes as a year-long investigation led by US senator Maggie Hassan found shortcomings in Tinder's global fraud-detection systems.

Tinder and Hinge's total paying users fell to 13.5 million in Q1 2026. In Q1 2025, they had 14.1 million paying users.

Released on 13 October, the investigation said most of the artificial intelligence models Tinder used to identify scammers had not been updated for years. Data provided by Match Group showed that profile views received by a median scammer on Tinder increased by more than 700% between May 2024 and December 2025.

"The most prominent issue we see reported is scams and fake accounts. And that's true in India, and it's true universally," said Roth.

In response, the company is introducing new safety features for Indian users, including screenshot protection, contact blocking and video-selfie verification. It is also working with Indian authorities on campaigns to help people recognise and report scams. He did not disclose how much the company spends on safety in the country or how many scam reports its apps receive.

The company is introducing new safety features in India, including screenshot protection and contact blocking

India's Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) too, warned in October last year with an advisory that fraudsters were using dating and matrimonial platforms to build relationships with victims before drawing them into investment and cryptocurrency scams. Roth said reports received by Match Group in India included investment fraud, restaurant scams and extortion.

In restaurant-related cases, Roth said, a person is persuaded to meet a match at a particular establishment, where an inflated bill is presented before the other person disappears. He said such reports had become more prominent in India over roughly the past two years. Here too, investment scams involving fraudsters spending weeks or months building trust before moving conversations to WhatsApp or another messaging platform and introducing a fake investment opportunity have also risen. In extortion cases, victims are persuaded to share intimate images before being threatened with their release, Roth said.

Tinder is the global market leader, followed by Bumble and then Hinge. Truly Madly and Aisle are local competitors to Hinge, Bumble & Tinder.

Mint reported last month that Hinge is betting on India to drive growth, with the country its second-largest market outside the US by downloads and third-largest by monthly active users. After more than a decade of relying on organic growth, the dating app has begun local marketing as it seeks to expand its user base amid growing dating fatigue among Gen Z. Hinge emerged as one of the group's strongest-performing brands: its global revenue rose 22% year-on-year to $204 million in the June quarter, while monthly active users grew 13%. The company's chief executive Spencer Rascoff had described India as an important expansion market for Hinge, which is targeting $1 billion in annual revenue globally by 2027.

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Everything is going wrong for Muhammad bin Salman

The Economist

Smoke and flames rise from King Khalid Airport, after Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis said they attacked the airport. REUTERS

In any other year, Muhammad bin Salman would be getting ready for his star turn. October 26th was supposed to be the scheduled start of the Future Investment Initiative (FII), an annual summit in the Saudi capital that is sometimes dubbed "Davos in the desert". The crown prince usually spends the week gladhanding heads of state, titans of finance and other dignitaries, all of them eager to do business with his kingdom.

Not this year. The Houthis, an Iran-backed militia in Yemen, have spent weeks firing missiles and drones at Riyadh. The airport is still, in effect, shut after a series of deadly attacks. Many Western governments have warned their citizens not to travel to the kingdom. Executives were nervous that hotels or other venues could be targets. After days of deliberation, organisers decided on October 19th to postpone the event until next year.

As he rose to power a decade ago, Prince Muhammad made a few big gambles. He wagered that he could defeat the Houthis; that he could reshape the Saudi economy; and that Donald Trump would prove a reliable ally. All of them have gone awry at once. The decision to cancel FII is emblematic of Prince Muhammad's annus horribilis. He faces a set of interlocking crises, none of which has a ready solution.

The Saudis failed to defeat the Houthis, but they had hoped a ceasefire agreed in 2022 would contain the threat. Instead the truce began to unravel this summer because of America's broader war with Iran. The Houthis have seized additional territory in Yemen and battered Saudi Arabia. People close to the crown prince see only bad options. The kingdom can send ground troops into a bloody war; continue a campaign of air strikes that is unlikely to succeed; or make a deal that helps cement Houthi rule.

A long conflict will derail Prince Muhammad's economic programme, which was sputtering even before 2026. Big projects were being shelved amid a strain on public finances. Wages have not kept pace with inflation. Annual foreign direct investment is only about one-third of the crown prince's $100bn target. A year ago the IMF expected the Saudi economy to grow by 4% in 2026; now it expects a 3.3% contraction.

Whether it rebounds in 2027 will depend on whether peace breaks out in the Middle East—and that, in turn, will depend largely on Mr Trump. The kingdom thought it had influence over him. It wooed him by promising to invest implausible sums in America. It also made tawdry deals with the first family, paying Trump-owned golf courses to host Saudi-funded tournaments and investing $2bn with Jared Kushner, the president's son-in-law. None of that stopped him from embarking on a disastrous war. "He's not loyal to anyone for long," says one well-connected Saudi.

Though there are no reliable public-opinion polls in the kingdom, it is fair to say most Saudis trust their government. Some have found the past few weeks unnerving, nonetheless: the war in Yemen has caused real disruption. Yet since October 10th, when a Houthi missile killed 13 people at Riyadh's airport, Prince Muhammad has been largely invisible. It fell to ministers to visit victims and offer reassuring messages.

A few Western commentators have begun to ask whether this crisis-filled year poses an existential threat to the crown prince's rule. The view among diplomats in Riyadh is that such talk is overblown. "He was in a much tougher place seven or eight years ago," says one Western envoy.

Back then the prince was a newly appointed heir, still trying to consolidate his rule. The war in Yemen was already a quagmire, the blockade of Qatar was upsetting America, and much of the world was horrified when Jamal Khashoggi, a Saudi journalist, was murdered inside the kingdom's consulate in Istanbul. Prince Muhammad's grip on power is far more secure today: he has sidelined rivals and centralised power unlike any Saudi ruler since King Abdulaziz, the founder of the modern state. Though he has detractors, none could plausibly organise a putsch.

Nor is he facing much criticism from allies. The response to the recent escalation in Yemen has been telling: even long-time critics of the war now acknowledge that the kingdom has little choice but to fight. "I do understand that this is a different moment than 2018 or 2020. They are facing these Houthi advances and Houthi rocket attacks," says Chris Murphy, a Democratic senator who met the crown prince in Riyadh this month. "We should recognise that."

Seen in another light, though, this is a more challenging moment for the crown prince. Because the woes of his early years were largely self-inflicted, they were easier to fix. By 2021 he was steering Saudi foreign policy in a more pragmatic direction. He ended the blockade of Qatar and sought a deal with the Houthis. Even the Biden administration, which took office having promised to make Prince Muhammad a "pariah", grudgingly praised his new direction.

This year is harder. The biggest decision is out of Prince Muhammad's hands. He has urged Mr Trump not to escalate the war with Iran. If the president ignores him and resumes bombing after the midterm elections in November, Saudi officials worry the kingdom will take blows from all sides: the Houthis to the south, Iraqi militias to the north and Iran itself to the east. They have a big country to protect—four times the size of France—and not many air-defence interceptors left to do it.

In his first decade, the crown prince made laudable strides towards liberalising Saudi society. Women can drive. Female labour-force participation has almost doubled. Concerts and cinemas are now widespread in a country where fun was long verboten. A few well-off foreigners can even enjoy a legal tipple. But the core of the Saudi state has changed little. Its economy still depends on oil money, its army is still built to protect the regime rather than wage war, and its foreign policy still relies on America as an indispensable protector.

Perhaps eventually those things will change as well. The Mecca pact, a mutual-defence agreement with Pakistan and Turkey, is an effort to find new allies that could supplant an unreliable America. But those changes will take time. In his second decade, Prince Muhammad's test will be to change the foundations, not just the façade.

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Toll rises to 73 in Houthi strike on Yemen forces

Attack on govt military camp the deadliest since fighting began escalating three months ago

AP
feedback@livemint.com

A funeral procession for a Houthi officer in Sanaa, the capital of Yemen. REUTERS

The death toll from a Houthi missile strike on a government military camp in southern Yemen rose to 73 people, all new recruits, making it the deadliest strike since fighting in the country began escalating three months ago, a senior Yemeni government official said Tuesday.

The recruits were all aged between 18 and 20, and some were still missing a day after the Iranian-backed rebels hit the al-Alam training camp in the southern province of Shabwa with ballistic missiles, Shabwa governor Awad Ibn al-Wazir told *The Associated Press*.

Monday's strike was part of a recent surge of fighting in Yemen, which started when forces from the internationally recognized government and Saudi-led coalition launched airstrikes on Houthi-held Sanaa International Airport in July, shattering a 2022 ceasefire deal that largely stopped fighting in the country's civil war.

Tom Barrack, the US envoy to Syria and Iraq, told the Global Security Forum in Doha, Qatar, that while he understood that "Saudi Arabia is in a very difficult position," the United States was not prepared to send troops to help.

"I think the president has been clear that he supports Saudi Arabia, and the backing that they need logistically we'll supply, but America getting involved in a ground kinetic battle somewhere else seems fruitless," said Barrack, who is also the US ambassador to Turkey.

In Britain, defence secretary Wes Streeting said the UK would expand its support to include defensive patrols by Royal Air Force jets to protect Saudi cities from attacks but would not strike Houthi targets. Britain had already offered to help with in-air refueling of Saudi planes.

The strike also wounded more than 200 other recruits, the governor said.

The casualties were new recruits from across Shabwa being trained to provide security in the province and not for combat operations, he said.

Another government official, who spoke on condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to brief the media, said several suffered serious injuries and were transferred to hospitals in other provinces in life-threatening condition. He said at least 15 of the recruits killed were from a single Yemeni tribe, Awlaqi, and another tribe, Maraziq, lost 16 of its members in the strike.

The camp, which was previously used by a militia backed by the UAE, is located in the Jardan district, north of the provincial capital of Ataq. It sits on a crucial supply line connecting to the government-controlled province of Marib.

On Tuesday, authorities in Saudi Arabia issued an attack warning for the capital area in the late morning, followed by the sound of an explosion in northern Riyadh, where the King Khalid International Airport is located. The airport has come under repeated Houthi attacks this month, forcing the facility to suspend its operations.

Yemen first plunged into civil war in 2014, when the Houthis seized Sanaa and much of northern Yemen and forced the government into exile.

A Saudi-led coalition intervened the following year in an attempt to restore the government to power. The conflict created one of the world's worst humanitarian disasters, and killed more than 150,000 people.

China tycoons with $140 mn overseas face wider tax net

Bloomberg
feedback@livemint.com

For years, many Chinese entrepreneurs used the same strategy to protect their riches from the taxman.

That's no longer a viable path after officials said in July they would begin enforcing a 20% tax on gains from overseas trusts for resident taxpayers. Those who receive such income now have until Oct. 22 to tally, report and pay their obligations without penalty.

Among those potentially most affected by the move are eight of the world's 500 richest people and their beneficiaries, according to the Bloomberg Billionaires Index.

The Chinese government hasn't singled out any individuals publicly and it's unclear if any of these billionaires might be due to pay taxes on gains made by their overseas trusts, or if they've been asked to do so. Their holdings, which in each case are the person's or family's largest assets, totalled about $140.2 billion as of Friday, according to *Bloomberg* calculations based on regulatory filings.

The Chinese government hasn't singled out any individuals publicly. REUTERS

Much of the overseas wealth was accumulated on investments made before the companies completed initial public offerings in the US or Hong Kong.

The tax collection drive is an extension of Chinese President Xi Jinping's campaign for "common prosperity," which included a crackdown on homegrown technology giants and pay cuts for bankers. Even though some of those curbs have eased over the past few years, a prolonged property slump has also dealt a severe blow to the finances of local governments, prompting the search for other sources of revenue. China had begun restricting IPOs of firms incorporated overseas that may offer certain tax benefits, people familiar with the matter said earlier this year. Wealth advisers and lawyers are now helping families trace the history of their offshore structures, going back to when the assets were first transferred into the trusts and tallying how much money they've made since then.

China had begun restricting IPOs of firms incorporated overseas that may offer certain tax benefits

None of the eight billionaires has stated publicly whether they have to respond to the tax rule change, or how they might be doing so.But some other founders have already turned to investors to raise cash for the taxes. The entrepreneurs behind hotpot chain Haidilao International Holding Ltd and recruitment app Kanzhun Ltd have sold hundreds of millions of dollars of shares combined in response to the new tax enforcement, people familiar with the matter said previously.

China's taxes apply even to those who have acquired foreign passports—such as Haidilao's founder—as long as they derive much of their revenue from the country.They realized authorities would be able to triangulate how much tax they owed from publicly available IPO documents or acquisition announcements, said Bai. "You cannot run away from it," she said.

Netflix, America's dominant streaming service, has hit a wall

Ben Fritz, Jessica Toonkel & Joe Flint
feedback@livemint.com

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

In the second quarter, Netflix reported double-digit percentage revenue growth in every region. AP

Netflix is writing a new script.

It abruptly replaced content chief Bela Bajaria last week just hours after a layoff of 1,000 employees that she helped engineer. By Monday, film chief Dan Lin lost his job, too.

The ousters of two of the company's top creative executives are a sign that the streaming giant's leaders feel the service needs to overhaul its content offerings.

Co-Chief Executive Ted Sarandos had complained internally for months that Americans were spending less time watching Netflix and that the service was short on new hit shows, people familiar with the matter said. He also has told colleagues that he wants the company, which has experimented with everything from videogames to podcasts, to strengthen its core TV and movie offerings.

On Tuesday, the company is set to deliver its third-quarter earnings and try to answer Wall Street's questions about its strategy.

Problems at the company that ushered in Hollywood's streaming revolution have been building for a year as it has struggled to come up with hits on the level of "Stranger Things" or "Squid Game."

Like many media companies, it is struggling to attract audiences spending more time watching YouTube and TikTok.

Netflix's stock has sagged since its failed bid launched last year for Warner Bros. Discovery's film and TV studios and HBO Max, which investors saw as a sign of weakness for a company whose leaders long said they were builders, not buyers. Its stock is down more than 40% from a year ago, around the time the acquisition pursuit began.

Netflix's struggles to keep viewers hooked have become increasingly apparent.

As of the end of September, Netflix hadn't added net subscribers any month this year in the U.S., according to analytics firm Antenna. Antenna tracks U.S. consumer purchases of subscriptions through sources such as credit-card bills, but doesn't include those bought through wholesale bundles. Netflix hasn't disclosed subscriber numbers since early 2025.

A Netflix spokeswoman disputed Antenna's data, saying it is "not representative of Netflix's business performance."

Earlier this fall, Netflix launched a restructuring plan known internally as "Project Meridian." Executives discussed cutting as many as 10% of the company's roles, but settled on 6% after discussion with division leaders, according to people familiar with the matter.

Wednesday morning, Sarandos and co-Chief Executive Greg Peters sent a memo announcing the cuts. By 2 p.m. that day, those laid off lost access to their work email, according to people familiar with the matter. Hours later, Sarandos told Bajaria that she was out.

Netflix said Thursday it was replacing Bajaria with Peter Rice , a Disney and Fox veteran with extensive experience in film, television and sports. Rice will start this week and oversee a roughly $20 billion global content budget for scripted and unscripted series, movies, and live events including sports.

Lin was seen at the star-studded Academy Museum Gala on Saturday night with Sarandos, where Taylor Swift performed in front of Hollywood's elite. Sunday night, he attended a screening event at Netflix headquarters for "La Bola Negra," a movie considered to be an Oscars contender. On Monday, the company announced that Lin, who was previously a producer known for "The Lego Movie" and "It," was leaving and Rice would take over until a new film head is chosen.

Industry giant

Netflix is still the most powerful force in subscription streaming. The rate at which U.S. subscribers cancel the service remains the lowest in the industry at just 2.1% in September, according to Antenna. In the second quarter, Netflix reported double-digit percentage revenue growth in every region.

Netflix is on track to deliver on its previously stated full-year forecast, according to an internal memo announcing the layoffs seen by The Wall Street Journal. It aims to deliver 13% to 14% revenue growth and operating margins of 31.5% this year.

The company has expanded its content offering to boost engagement. Some newer categories, such as live sports, have been more successful than others, such as videogames. Only 3.5% of Netflix's subscribers play games monthly, according to a recent internal memo. That business is tracking about 10% behind its 2026 reach and engagement goals, the memo said.

The company is overhauling creative leadership as it struggles to get audiences to watch more

Video podcasts and creator content allowed Netflix to add hundreds of hours of programming at a fraction of the cost of scripted series. During the company's last earnings call, Sarandos emphasized that building up these new formats takes time and that they are "evolutionary, not revolutionary."

Changing approach

Its engagement slump has resurfaced an old debate at the company: Were subscribers not watching more because of the programming from Los Angeles? Or because of the recommendation algorithm overseen by engineers in Northern California?

Overriding Netflix's recommendation algorithm—known internally as "putting your thumb on the scale"—was long verboten, but in recent months, the practice has become more common as executives seek to boost viewership for certain shows and new types of content. More recently, the company has stopped pushing games and podcasts, focusing more on its core movie and TV offerings, said one of the people.

Additionally, executives have debated whether to change the release cadence of certain shows to improve engagement, according to people familiar with the matter. Netflix typically drops all the episodes of a season at once, while many competitors release new episodes weekly. Sarandos has resisted the change. Netflix data shows that members prefer an all-at-once binge versus a weekly cadence, according to the company.

Netflix has also discussed letting its customers subscribe to other services, like NBCUniversal's Peacock, within its app and adding live channels. In France, Netflix has started giving subscribers access to the broadcaster TF1's programming, which includes news.

In another change, it is starting to bet on major theatrical releases for some films after years of releasing most films directly online and giving a handful a few weeks on a limited number of screens. The company is releasing films including "Charlie vs. the Chocolate Factory" and "Narnia: The Magician's Nephew" in theaters globally at least 45 days before they will be available to watch at home, the strategy typically used by traditional studios.

The day before the layoffs, Netflix launched the psychedelic trailer for "Narnia," soundtracked by Led Zeppelin's "Stairway to Heaven." Its trailer quickly amassed nearly 80 million views on YouTube.

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CENTRAL ARCADE DLF-II, Space available for Lease 1650 Sq.ft, Reputed / Corporate Brand Outlets. Food Chains, Parlors. Rajiinderr Soni: 9810006101, 9910006101

LALIT MAINI 9811089079

DLF LUXURY Builder Floors 300 YD 4 BHK with lift @4.50/360 YD 4BHK With Lift, Parking And Modern Fitting @5.25/400 Yd 4 BHK With Lift @6.25 & Many More Options- 9810889079

DLF PHASE-1 Elite Floor 200 Yds 7303765106

TOP WITH Terrace Fully Furnished 3BHK + D/D + 4 Baths, S + 4 Modern Finishes + Luxury living, Superior Const. Serious buyer/ end- user Only Scan QR for Property Video

(Since 1992) GANGA PROPERTIES 9999970994

DLF PHASE-3, Plots & Builder Floors 215 Yds, 316 Yds , 402 Yds, 502 Yds & 1022 Yds North- East Facing / Park Facing. Corner options also Available Ganga Properties. 99999-70994

EXCLUSIVE DLFPH-3 Plots, Kothis and Builder Floors all size at Reasonable price. Call Sumindra Properties 9810165528, 9810165532

• Kachnar Marg 1000 sq.yd **• DLF Ph-4** 316 syd Corner Park facing

DLF PH-1 316 sq.yd Park facing Kothi 5bhk @15cr, S.Lok-1 215yd park Old House @9.00Cr & DLF Ph-2 300yd 5bhk @12.75cr, Sec 27 corner park fac 204yd @8.50, Call 98735-52213

PLOTS, BANGLOWS Builder floors wanted/available in DLF Gurgaon Prakaash Vir Arya Prakaash Property (1981) Call: 9811027525.

LALIT MAINI 9811089079

DLF PLOTS 500 Yd East, Park/North, 18 Mtr/400 Yd North/300 Yd North/251 Yd North, Park/215 Yd East, Park/200 Yd North, Park - 9811089079

OWNER WESTERLIES SEC-108 24 METER ROAD PLOT 902 SQ.YD.

CLINIC PLOT 240 sq yard two side,18 metre Road, Sector-38 Huda Market, Kothi 502 SQYD DLF Phase-III Basement +Three Floors V-39-14A Contact 9910055853

DLF – SUSHANT LOK

SUSHANT LOK-I DLF PHASE- IV PLOTS SABHARWAL ASSOCIATES 9958492130

S.LOK-1, 502YD West facing Kothi, 300yd East kothi, 418yd Map approved Plot, More plots available in 215yd to 1022yd 9958492130 Sabharwal Associates

FOR Sale SCO Sec 56 Gurgaon Greenland Realty Group 9810652416, 9711596760

FOR SALE SCO Sec 56 Gurgaon Size 171 Sq Yd 3 Side Open Rented Contact Greenland Realty Group:- 9810652416, 9711596760

EXCLUSIVE PLOTS & FLOORS DLF CITY SUSHANT LOK 200, 300, 400, 500, 1000 Sq. Yds GANGA (Since 1992) PROPERTIES 99999-70994

DLF BEVERLY PARK 1 IN GURGAON IVAAN LANDBASE PVT. LTD. 9891380007

ON SALE Main MG Road, Area-3000Sqft , Perfect Vastu and Sunfacing @7.99 crore Negotiable. Exclusive Mandate

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SALE PRE- rented prop at vacant price in Magnum Global Park, Sec-58, GGN Shapoorji Pallonji. GF, double height warm shell lease for 9 Yrs 2,150 sqft. # 8130697900

Distress Deals ASSET AMPLIFIERS 9999555874

SOUTH CITY 1- 502 syd @ 14 Cr, 360 syd @ 11.5 Cr, Naksha Pass, 240 syd @ 8 Cr, 180 syd @ 7 Cr., SL-I 260 syd Kothi @ 9 Cr, 300 syd @ 10 Cr, 500 syd @ 16 Cr # 9999555874

PRE-RENTED

COMPANY	MONTHLY RENT	YIELD
TISQ Health	₹48,000 - ₹1,41,000	7%
Kids Kosmos	₹56,700	7%
Zast Logistics	₹90,000 - ₹7,20,000	6%
Axis Bank	₹1,98,000 - ₹4,00,000	4%
Boston	₹1,56,000	6%

LOCKABLE OFFICE SPACES — Investments starts from — 80L ONWARDS 7669988005, 7669988003

1000 syd PLOTS LUCRATIVE DEALS 9999555874

SOUTH CITY 1 @ 36 Cr (1000 syd), SL-2 @ 20 Cr, SL-I 737 syd @ 24 Cr, Rosewood City @ 35 Cr, DLF-I @ 50 Cr Corner, DLF-II @ 48 Cr # 9999555874

FOR SALE EMAAR URBAN OASIS SECTOR 62 GURGAON 4 Bedroom Appartment 4000 Sq.ft. High floor Contact owner 9971048123

BUILDER FLOORS Distress Deals 9999555874

S.LOK-1 - 215 syd Top Terrace @ 3 Cr, 418 syd Top Terrace @ 5.75 Cr, 300 syd A-blk @ 4.25 Cr, 500 syd Top Terrace @ 5.75 Cr # 9999555874

DLF Apartment Sale and Purchase Optus Realty Pvt. Ltd. 92117 29512

DLF GOLF Link, Crest, Park Place, Arbour and Privana. DLF Floors Mobile: 9211729512

FOR SALE 270 SQ YD Floor for Sale in DLF 5 The Grove North East facing Park 50 MTR Away with Modern Fittings . 9650244113

SOUTH DELHI

VASANT VIHAR 400 / 800 floors & Bungalows., 9810030231

A-10/4 VASANT Vihar 1200 sq yds, 1st floor, large 4 beds D/D, Family Lounge, S/Q etc. 4500 sq feet. Cont Anish Malhotra 9811200272

Kailash Colony / Greater Kailash-I S KUMAR 98110-31558

KAILASH COLONY , Greater Kailash-I , 500 yds. 4 Beds D/D, Third Floor with terrace, Separate Parking . S. Kumar – 98110-31558

SOUTH DELHI

READY / BOOKING LUXURIOUS FLOORS 300/400/500/1000 Yds Rampal 989-989-3333

SAFDARJUNG ENCLAVE, SDA, Vasant Vihar, Kailash Colony, South Extn. & adj. areas 3/4/5 BHK Builder Floors, A+ Const, Top Builder, Best Locations also Kothies/Collaborations available

SDA 500 Sq Yds BMT / Ground / Third Floor Rajat Seth 9810877429

SDA 500 Sq Yds North Facing Newly Built BMT/ G. Floor with Exclusive Lift & Driveway, T. F with Exclusive Lift All Floors available. Many other options also. Rajat Seth 9810877429

VASANT VIHAR GROUND + B & THIRD + TRC RAVINDER YADAV 9818935156

VASANT VIHAR / Shanti Niketan Park Facing 800/450 yd Ground + B / TF also 280 yds All floors. Westend / SDA / Panchsheel 800/500 Yds Ground+B / TF Ravinder 9818935156

FARM HOUSE CHATTARPUR AREA Bank Loan Available 9899017788

FARM HOUSE For Sale Chattarpur Area South Delhi 1 Acre 6 BHK, 2.5 Acres 6 BHK, Newly Constructed 14000 sq.ft. Area,Bank Loan Also Available Contact: PK Srivastava 98990 17788

EAST OF KAILASH B-Block | 200 Sq. Yds. Second Floor | 3 BHK 9217390163, 9811222555

PREMIUM LUXURY Builder's Floor, Fully Furnished, Recently Renovated, Elegant Interiors, Bright & Spacious Designer 3 BHK+S.Qtr, Lift, Gated & Secure Society, Excellent Location.

GULMOHAR PARK PARK FACING HOUSE FOR SALE MANJEET SINGH 9810117970

GULMOHAR PARK, A Blk, 300 Sq. Yds Building, Regular dimensions, Park Facing, Wide Road, Inside Location, West Facing, Suits for actual users. Manjeet Singh 9810117970

CR PARK DDA Janta 3 BHK Flat FF+SF+3rd Trilex+Terr MANJEET SINGH 9810117970

CR PARK near O-Blk/Old Police Station DDA (Janta Flat) 1st Flr, 2nd Flr & 3rd Floor Triplex 3 BHK with Complete Terrace, Balconies, Fully Renovated, Ample Car Parking, Ready to move-in

DEFENCE COLONY 325 Park Facing First Floor Unused East Facing Ready To Shift, Lift, Stilt Parking. Corner Park Facing 280 Yds SF Cont Amit Sehgall 9810076865, 9873076865

C-747 NEW Friends Colony 500 yards, 1st floor, Large 4 Beds, D/D, kitchen etc, stilt parking. Cont; Anish Malhotra 9811200272

PAMPOSH ENCL. 233 SQ.YDS. Burma Teak Wood LIFT, S.QTR.

PAMPOSH ENCL corner 3 sides open owner built 233 S.Y. 2nd floor Ind. Stilt Gate 3 BHK Lobby Pooja Room Store 4 Balconies Italian flooring Burma Teak - 9811078913

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GREATER KAILASH-II First Floor and Second Floor 300 sq. yards Park facing, Peaceful Location, Tastefully built 4 Beds 5 Bath Parking. Contact - Rajeev Verma 9717882179.

VASANT VIHAR (1200) Bungalow., 9810030231

SARVAPRIYA VIHAR 233 Yds, Park facing Floors GK-II 300 Yds, Floors 8130937120, 9811422449

SARVAPRIYA VIHAR 233 Sq Yds, Park facing 3 BHK Floors in Booking, A++ Construction, Reputed Builder also GK-II, 300 Sq Yds, Park facing 4 BHK Floors, Vastu Perfect, Best Locations

BRAND NEW SALE SOUTH EX-II 250 / 500 Sq.Yds. OWNER: 9811229122

SOUTH EXTENSION Part -2 Second Floor 250 Sq.Yds. / 500 Sq.Yds. (ii)Safdarjung Development Area (SDA) 500 Sq.Yds First Floor Cont.: Arjun Arora (Owner) 9811229122.

PRIME LOCATION ON MAIN ROAD GK-II 3000 Sq. Ft.

COMMERCIAL GROUND Floor For Sale/Lease. Call: 9891568884

FOR SALE- Green Park 1st Flr, East Facing 3 Bedrooms + Baths, D & D , front & Back Balconies, only 4yrs Old -not Used, Lift + Sq, Stilt Pkng -2 Cars @ 6cr. Raju Sharma 9811464624

SOUTH EX-II 500y New F.Flr 4BR 12.50 South Ex-II 500y New 3rd+T.Gdn 4BR South Ex-II 500/900y New FF/SF/3rd GK-I/II 1000y new B+GF Trp 5BR & FF GK-I, 500y FF/SF.Harish 99992 56123

GREATER KAILASH-1 Floors available: 1) 300 yds, 4BHK, T.F + Terr. @ 8.50 2) 208 yds, 3BHK, First Floor @ 6.50 3) 208 yds, 3BHK, 2nd Floor @ 6.00 Mittal Realty (South Ex) 9958766999

RENTED PROPERTY For Sale Shop 200 Sq.ft - Rent 65K Office 550 Sq.ft - Rent 26K Location - Mahipalpur. Total Rent - 91K, @ 1.85 Contact 9811667756

SOUTH DELHI

Buniyad REAL ESTATE SERVICES 9910002208

FOR SALE Defence Colony, 325yds Duplex, Basement + Ground Floor, 3 BHK. Wide Road, Peaceful Gated Colony. Well Maintained, Value for Money Property. Call 9910002208.

Buniyad REAL ESTATE SERVICES 9910000257

MAHARANI BAGH, bungalow for sale 800 sqyd, Corner, Park facing. For more details call 9910000257.

KALKAJI- BASEMENT available for Sale on 100 sq.yards Plot with separate Entrance. Only serious inquiries please contact: 9899042787, 9810002409.

HAUZ KHAS 500 Yds, Second Floor (10 -12 yrs old), Luxurious 4 BHK, Lounge S.Qtr, Lift, Separate Gate Stilt 2 Car Parking, very well maintained, owner going abroad. Ravinder 9810883504

DEFENCE COLONY 325 Sqyd T.F. with Terrace 10 yrs old 3 BHK S/Q Norh / East facing stilt 2 cars parking well Maintained price 13.50.cr F.F. 4 BHK New 12 cr. Singh 9811356008

FOR SALE North Facing East of Kailash 250 sq.yds Corner First Floor 4 Beds D/D Separate Car Parking For Details Contact Shalini Properties Amit 9810076865

KOTHI FOR Sale, Vasant vihar, 1000 Sqyd, 400 Sqyd,2000 Sqyd.,Floor for Sale Vasant Marg,Top flr with terrace 12.5 Cr.,Grnd bsmnt Park facing, 400 Sqyd, 19 Cr. Broker Exc. 9220637791

DEZINR BNGLW New 250y S.Del @ 38, Flrs-500y Gk1 @ 14, 600y V.Vhr @ 14.75, 325y D.Col @ 9.75, V.knj-GF, FF & 3rd 4cr-5.5cr, A.Nik 275y @ 11. Rent -Gk1 New 2nd 500y #9312502224

FARM LAND DLF CHATTARPUR 98 100 19580

FARMS FOR Sale in DLF Chattarpur, Ansal Satbari, Radhe Mohan Drive, Gadaipur, Sultanpur, Dearamandi, Plot Area : 1000 & 2000 Sq.yds, 1 Acre & 2 Acre, Built & Unbuilt

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WESTEND, 416.39 Sq Metre (498 Sq Yards), Luxurious Ground Floor & Basement : 9810062871, 9810063891, 9971173648

6/13 SHANTI Niketan 400 yards builder floor, 4 beds, D/D, kitchen, S/qtr etc. Indpt Stilt parking. Well maintained. Anish Malhotra 9811200272

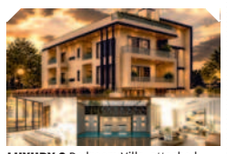
SARITA VIHAR G-Blk DDA Flat 2nd+3rd Duplex 4 BHK+Bath, Scooter Garage, Ample Car Parking, Freehold, Wide Road, Excellent Location. For more Details Sandeep Suri 9899410005

SALWAN REAL ESTATE PVT. LTD.

VASANT VIHAR, 334.45 Sq Meter (400 Sq Yards), Third Floor, comprising 4 Bedrooms D/D, with Terrace. 9810062871, 9810063891, 9971173648

SALE HOUSE GREEN PARK 200-300-500-650 Sq.yd 98102-23443

SAFDARJUNG DEVELOPMENT Area House Park Facing 500 Sq.yards, Green Park Liviable House 500 Sq.yd Third Floor+Terrace 300 Sq.yards. Contact: Jainsons 9810223443



LUXURY 8 Bedroom Villa, attached bathroom Church Rd, Park Lane, Vasant Kunj, Swimming Pool,Terrace Gdn,Forest View. 5-6 Car Park,Prime Loc. 25Cr. 9211303561, 9211303562

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GREATER KAILASH-2 2nd Floor - 1100 Sq.yds. SAHIL ESTATE 9810473675

GK-2 (1100), 2nd Floor 5br @21cr. Maharani bagh(500) Booking All Flrs Available NFC(500) 4br @6cr &(300) Sf 4br@6cr. Sukhdev Vihar(250) 3br 3.65cr. NFC Kothi(300) @21 cr.

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FLOORS IN All Cheque in Safdarjung Enclave New /Old 500y Third floor and terrace @14cr. 400y Second Floor @11. Brand New 200y First and Second @6.50 Each. # 9810417610

SOUTH DELHI

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VASANT VIHAR, 215.72 Sq Metre (258 Sq Yards) Ground Floor & Basement Suits Doctor/Lawyer: 9810062871, 9810063891, 9971173648

Hauz Khas Encl. Mayfair Garden Purri Realtors 9811015635

WANTED INDEPENDENT Bungalow under ASI Only, 400 to 1000 Sq Yards, Immediate buyer, Brokers excuse. Purri Realtors 9811015635

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Buniyad REAL ESTATE SERVICES 9999011116

FOR SALE 450sqmtr completion Pair plot with one time lease rent paid in sector 50 Noida on12mtr wide road A premium residential plot in the sought-after loc. Cont:- 9999011116.

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PUNJAB PROPERTIES 9891008515 GR. NOIDA / YEIDA

GR. NOIDA Buy / Sell Chi, Phi, Alpha, Beta, Gama, Delta, Sigma, S.nagri, P3, Sector - 02 , 03 , 36, 37, Omicron, Mu, Xu, Also deals YEIDA Plots. Call: Punjab Prop 9891008515,9891119515

NOIDA FOR Sale Single Story Kothi Sector-41, Area 130mtr, Prime Location & Very Reasonable Price Contact- Surya Estates & Mobile No 9818050606

NOIDA SECTOR - 75 OWN FLAT FOR SALE 9810172870

FLATS FOR Sale Panchsheel Pratishtha Sector-75 1495 Sq.ft 3Bhk One Car Park Fully Done up. Also 1350 Sq.ft Flat in 7 Avenue, Gaur City-1 Higher Floor. Owner 9810172870

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SALE BRAND new,Ready to move in Luxury Kothi,sector 46 Noida,300 sq mtr,East facing,Vastu Compliant,A+ grade construction,Fully Automated, Contact: 9650085550, 9810643453

SECTOR - 44 LAND LORD REALTORS 9810643453

SALE LUXURY Kothi, VIP Sec-44 Noida 450 sq.mtr., North facing, Corner, Basement+Duplex+Simplex, 13000 sq.ft. Construction, Home Theater, Vastu Compliant. Call: 9650085550

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FACTORY AVAILABLE For Sale On Noida Express Highway Sector-155, Area 1000mtr, On Big Wide Road Contact- Surya Estates & Mobile No:- 7011764629, 9818050606

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RESI N/E B& F Block 450m Sec -44, N/E 300m Kothi/ Plot Sec-44, 47, 46, 93B. N/E 450m Kothi/Plot Sec-15A, 44, 46, 47, 93B

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3 BHK With Lift, 3 Side Open Corner, Sec-22/ 16-A/ 109-110, UGF 70, FF 85, SF 82, TF 95, 56Sq.Mtr, Free Hold With Loan, Rohini. Cont- Bisht Prop. Pvt. Ltd. # 9811134984, 9650045100

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DELHI/NCR

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E BLOCK, RAJOURI GARDEN- HOUSE FOR SALE An exceptional address. A rare 760 sq. Yds. Prime residential property behind Madhav/Bindra Park. Regular rectangular plot. Price on request. Serious buyers call: 9811135099, 9810052717, 9810014823, 9999149497

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ADITYA ENCLAVE SEC-23 DWARKA Spacious floor for sale 9811157818

DWARKA SECTOR-23, Aditya Enclave Super Deluxe 250 yd, Spacious 3 BR, Huge D/D, T.F, Italian flooring, Wardrobes, Modular Kitchen, Branded Fixtures & Fittings. # 9811157818

GURUGRAM

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TO-LET

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FULLY COMMERCIAL Gr. floor 2500 sq.ft. Ring Rd facing, Saf. Encl. Adj World Trade center Nauroji Nagar suits Car/Retail Showroom, Bank, office etc. Owner #9810058866

E-92 ANAND Niketan 3BHK att. bath, D/D, 1st Floor, Fully Furnished, Park facing Beautiful Flat for immediate Rent only for Foreigners / Diplomats. # Siddiqui Estate 9810265671

E-286, GK-1, 230 Sq. Yards, Ground Floor, 3 BHK, corner, dedicated parking, also Basement and 1 BHK on 3rd Floor. Contact: 9810430100

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B 38 Malcha Marg 313 sq metre (375 sq yards) Park facing 2 & half storey Independent Bungalow available, 100% Power Backup. Suits Expat / Embassy. 9810062871/ 9971173648

GK-2, IMMACULATELY maintained, Fully Furnished 2 BR attached Bath, D/D, Kitchen & Servant Room available for Lease. Interested Parties contact 9899383550

DEFENCE COLONY, C-484, First Floor. DD/Lobby, 3-BHK, 325 SQ.Yd, Separate Stilt Parking, Power Backup, Lift & AC. For Rent only. Call Praveen (Owner) @ 9811019993

GREATER KAILASH-1 Main Road 3000 sq.ft. FOR OFFICE USE. 9810166637, 9910166637

GREATER KAILASH-1 Main Road Second Floor (3000) sq.ft. for Office Use. Please Contact Sharma 9810166637- 9910166637

J-65, SAKET, Basement 1700Sq.Ft. (Commercial) Fully Furnished with Cabnis, AC's, Pantry, Washroom, Parking. Contact # 9818860436.

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GHAZIABAD

COMM. BUILDING Available On Hapur Road, Mukand Nagar, Ghaziabad, GF: 1,700 Sq.Ft., FF: 1,900 Sq.Ft., SF: 1,900

NEWS IN NUMBERS

15
THE NUMBER of New York City facilities Amazon is threatening to close if a proposed bill that mandates direct employment of delivery drivers is enacted.

2
THE NUMBER of new showrooms Ferrari is opening in India—in Ahmedabad and Chennai—as it expands its total retail presence in India to five locations.

28%
THE AVERAGE share of software budgets large enterprises spend on vendor upgrades and licensing, constraining AI and innovation investments.

$2 mn
THE TOTAL settlement Cloudera will pay to resolve US government allegations of discriminating against qualified US workers during green card sponsorship.

8
THE NUMBER of northern Vietnamese cities and provinces that will implement air pollution measures like remote work and online classes during red alerts.

HOWINDIALIVES.COM

Stellantis India to boost localization

Stellantis India is targeting to halve vehicle development time and ramp up localisation for certain models as it prepares to launch 12 products across Citroen and Jeep brands under its FaSTLAne 2030 roadmap, managing director and chief executive officer Shailesh Hazela said.

"Globally, we announced that our ambition is to cut down our development time for bringing new products from 48 months to close to two years, which is around 24 months. That is what we are working on (for) our products, which we are going to launch," Hazela told *PTI* in an interview.

Stellantis has one of its software and technology centre in Bengaluru.

On localization, Hazela said Citroen has a localization level in the range of 90-95%, while the Jeep brand's localization stands at 70-75%. **PTI**

EAAA India Alternatives IPO to open on 26 October

EAAA India Alternatives Ltd, an arm of Edelweiss Financial Services, will open its ₹1,200 crore initial public offering (IPO) for subscription on Monday, 26 October.

The issue will close on 28 October, while anchor investor bidding is scheduled for 23 October, according to the company's Red Herring Prospectus.

The issue is entirely an offer for sale by Edelweiss Group with no fresh issue component. This means the company will not receive any proceeds from the public offering, and the entire amount will go to the selling shareholder. The IPO size has been reduced to ₹1,200 crore from the ₹1,500 crore proposed in the draft red herring prospectus filed with the Securities and Exchange Board of India in January. **PTI**

Hindusthan National Glass to invest ₹300-500 cr soon

Hindusthan National Glass and Industries Ltd (HNGIL), now a part of the Africa-based Madhvani-Turner Group, is planning to invest ₹300-500 crore over the next five months to ramp up manufacturing capacity by the end of this fiscal year.

HNGIL, which was acquired by Independent Sugar Corp. Ltd through the insolvency resolution process under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code for ₹2,250 crore in September 2025, has invested around ₹700 crore in the business since the change in ownership.

"Another ₹300-500 crore will be invested during the remaining part of the current financial year, which will be for capacity expansion and meeting operational expenses," HNGIL chief strategy officer Suraj Mehta told *PTI*. The Mumbai-based container glassmaker had received several orders during its corporate insolvency resolution period, which are being delivered in the current financial year. **PTI**

SLMG eyes ₹20k cr turnover in five yrs

SLMG Beverages, Coca-Cola's largest bottler in India, is targeting a turnover of ₹20,000 crore within five years and plans to list on the stock exchanges before that timeline, according to its joint managing director Paritosh Ladhani.

The company, which holds Coca-Cola's bottling rights for high-density markets in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, looks to capitalise on India's consumption growth and also explore opportunities in overseas markets.

"We should at least go for ₹20,000 crore in the next five years. We will definitely be listed by then," Ladhani told *PTI* in an interview.

"We are very bullish for growth."On the investment front, SLMG has already invested around ₹1,200 crore in its facility at Buxar in Bihar, while construction has begun at its proposed Gorakhpur plant in Uttar Pradesh, which will entail an investment of around ₹ 1,000 crore," added Ladhani. **PTI**

IEA ready to act if further oil stocks release needed: chief

Supply disruption has sent diesel prices to record highs in many markets

Reuters
feedback@livemint.com
LONDON

REUTERS

The International Energy Agency (IEA) is ready to coordinate more emergency oil releases by member countries if needed, its boss said on Tuesday, while it spurs the release of diesel under existing plans to help cool surging prices.

Disruption to supplies from the Gulf and Russia has sent diesel prices to record highs in many markets, including the US, where it has become a talking point ahead of 3 November midterm elections.

The IEA, which coordinates industrialised nations' releases of oil from emergency stocks, had announced last week that it would accelerate the releasing of crude and oil product volumes which were pledged in March, including more than 20 million barrels of diesel as soon as possible.

"If it is needed... and if our countries consider it's time to push the button, as the International Energy Agency, we are ready to go," IEA executive director Fatih Birol said at a conference in London organized by the *Financial Times*, when asked about the prospect of an additional release.

The release of the 20 million barrels of diesel is a priority and the timing depends on individual countries and market conditions, he said, without giving a specific timeframe.

"We're trying to front-load those diesel deliveries," he added.

Global diesel markets could remain tight well into next year, with resulting high prices driving inflation, the IEA said in its most recent oil market report.

"I personally don't see any credible pathway that 2027 will be a year of normalization," Birol said at the conference.

Brent crude oil rose to more than $111 a barrel on Tuesday, a five-month high.

European benchmark diesel futures were trading at $1482.25 per tonne, up almost 4% since the IEA announced it would accelerate the release of the remainder of the March volumes.

Members have so far released 80% of the record 400 million barrels of crude and oil products they committed to, Birol said.

PepsiCo has recently strengthened its ready-to-eat offerings on e-commerce platforms. AP

PepsiCo expects steady festive sales

PepsiCo India expects its food business to match last year's festive growth momentum driven by new product rollouts and convenience-focused choices that match modern consumer habits, a top company official said on Tuesday.

The company is expanding its portfolio across snacks, 'better-for-you' products and premium offerings to cater to diverse consumer preferences during the festive season, said Saakshi Verma Menon, chief marketing officer, foods, PepsiCo India.

"We expect PepsiCo Foods to deliver a growth trajectory similar to last year during the festive season, growing in line with the industry," Menon told *PTI*. The company has recently strengthened its ready-to-eat offerings on e-commerce platforms to make festive snacking more convenient.

The company has recently strengthened its ready-to-eat offerings on e-commerce platforms to make festive snacking more convenient. PepsiCo's product strategy in the food business is aimed at addressing evolving Indian taste preferences and different consumption occasions. **PTI**

The new model was trained to estimate age or, for those with cancer, their survival chances. ISTOCKPHOTO

AI tool to predict cancer survival rate

Researchers built an artificial intelligence (AI) tool that can predict cancer patients' survival chances by using a single photograph of their face, complementing doctors' gut instincts to potentially guide treatment decisions, especially when medical data is scarce.

The new model was trained to estimate a person's age or, for those with cancer, their survival chances.

The AI was trained on over 40 million images of people's faces as well as photographs of more than 30,000 cancer patients, many of whom had already died. The tool gave patients risk scores—those with the highest scores were more likely to die within 90 days, according to the research published in the *Lancet Digital Health*.

The scientists say the findings are a first. Doctors are trained to assess patients just by how they look, said Raymond Mak, a radiation oncologist at Mass General Brigham Cancer Institute and one of the study's authors, but they're "in general not very good at estimating end of life expectancy." **BLOOMBERG**

'Free cash flow to fuel growth, create value for new Jio investors'

FROM PAGE 1

broadband growth is expanding outside metro areas, and you have parallel ambitions in enterprise AI/cloud and international services. How do you sequence these investments without returning to the equity markets?

Capital discipline is part of how we build. The net-debt-free balance sheet post-IPO will be a great strength for Jio Platforms, with operations generating increasingly higher amounts of free cash flows. Our current and growing free cash flows have already been deleveraging: our net debt to Ebitda came down from 0.88x in FY24 to 0.36x in FY26. Ultimately, the FCF will chase growth and create great value for the new investors joining the Jio family. With strong internal cash flows significantly greater than the investment requirements, we don't foresee a need to approach equity markets in the near or mid-term.

You mentioned that average revenue per user (Arpu) will grow through additional services, while keeping pricing as an option. Airtel currently maintains a higher Arpu and better retention after tariff hikes. Do you have a concrete plan, along with a timeline, to close that gap through services? Under what conditions would Jio lead, match, or hold off on the next tariff increase?

We grow value per customer by giving people more to do on our network, not only by charging more per gigabyte. At Jio, our objective is to create greater value from our network capabilities for both customers and shareholders. We do not see network monetization as being limited to charging more for every gigabyte of data. Instead, our focus is on offering value-added services that combine connectivity with digital applications and other capabilities. Our customers already use 43.7 GB of data a month on average, and are consuming 333 million digital services subscriptions.

I'd rather not compare us with other operators, as the definition of Arpu and business model varies across operators.

We do not have any five-year Arpu target. We believe that revenue growth must be supported by sustainable customer value, not viewed in isolation. Hence, our future offerings will be assessed in the context of customer needs, usage patterns, service quality, and the evolving market.

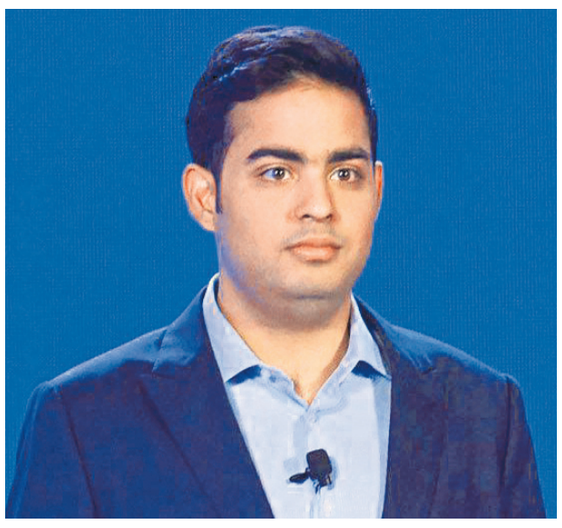
Mukesh Ambani has indicated that the leadership transition is nearly complete, with you leading technology, Isha overseeing consumer business, and Anant managing energy. How did his mentorship shape the key decisions behind this IPO? What does taking Jio public signify for the family's future stewardship of Reliance?

The IPO represents an important milestone in Reliance Group's journey. It brings Jio Platforms into the public markets and gives public-market investors an opportunity to evaluate and participate in the company's future. We hope the listing will reinforce confidence in India's technology capabilities and in the opportunities created by the country's digital transformation.

As regards the IPO process, my father Mr Mukesh Ambani, as well as all the directors on RIL's board, gave a lot of insights as well as valuable advice. We also have an experienced and capable team of leaders, as well as professional advisors and lead managers, who managed the IPO process extremely well.

Did you actively choose telecom, or was this domain assigned to you among your siblings?

Technology is my passion, and hence, I could relate with telecom and technology businesses pretty well. However, we must note that all three of us are involved in each business together, and always count on each other to back up when needed.



You and Isha have jointly led the global roadshows. How do you divide the digital mandate between yourselves, and what was the experience of pitching Jio together while representing a legacy originating with Dhirubhai Ambani? Was there a specific family principle that influenced how you structured or communicated this listing story?

Jio's story was already very well-known across the world, and there has long been a high level of interest about Jio's journey; so, our presentations were extremely well-received. What I take from my grandfather, Dhirubhai Ambani, is respect for every shareholder and generating returns for them.

Through the roadshows, we have had the opportunity to explain Jio Platforms' business, technology capabilities, financial performance and long-term opportunities to investors from all over the world. Their response has been overwhelmingly positive.

Looking at the institutional interest in the IPO and the record subscription to the anchor book, I'd like to believe that we were able to convey Jio's story well.

Reflecting from 2016, beginning with early acquisitions and the initial subscriber growth to public market accountability today, what is your most personal reflection at this stage? What do you want this listing to represent for the next generation of the family?

Reliance has a remarkable history of creating opportunities for ordinary Indians to participate in its growth. That relationship is built on trust, long-term thinking and the belief that the benefits of enterprise should extend beyond the company itself.

> The net-debt-free balance sheet post-IPO will be a great strength for Jio Platforms.
> **Akash Ambani,** managing director, Jio Platforms

We are entering the public markets with a responsibility to build a strong, sustainable business and create immense value over time. We are committed to innovation, execution, financial discipline and the transparency expected of a listed company.

For the next generation of Indian builders, I hope it shows that deep technology can be built in India, by Indians, at scale.

Historically, Reliance maintained that telcos can succeed in value-added services, but few global telcos have successfully executed it. Do you share this vision? Between AI/cloud, content, enterprise, and fintech, which two services do you project will deliver the highest return on incremental capital?

At its core, Jio is a digital services company built on the foundation of connectivity. We have built capabilities across 5G and home broadband, cloud, devices, software, entertainment, and enterprise services. These are supported by a proprietary technology stack that Jio has designed, developed, and deployed in-house. This gives us greater control over our services and operations and enables us to offer our customers a value proposition with no parallel in India.

And that is how we built Jio: as a technology company that uses connectivity as its foundation. On it, we have added connectivity, digital services, all on a stack we designed and deployed in-house, with more than 12,000 people in our digital products and technology teams.

Reliance's response to Elon Musk's recent public comments on Starlink led to a shift in tone. What facilitated that resolution? Was there direct alignment between Mukesh Ambani and Elon Musk, or between yourself and SpaceX chief Gwynne Shotwell, that established common ground?

Reliance was built to create world-class companies from India. We have done that across all our businesses by delivering unbeatable customer value and operating at world-class efficiency. That is exactly why we welcome competition. It brings out the best in us, and the real winners are India's consumers.

I would look at this constructively. Once the facts were on the table, there was very little left to disagree about. The government applies the same process to every applicant, Indian or foreign, and Jio's own satellite services are awaiting clearances too, which was clear and acknowledged.

We have always believed in working with partners across the global technology ecosystem, while staying firmly committed to India's laws, its regulatory framework and its consumers.

For an extended version of this interview, go to livemint.com.

The magic of a Swiss winter without breaking the bank

How a family of five spent under ₹8 lakh on a Swiss holiday during the New Year peak season

Shipra Singh
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NEW DELHI

Switzerland may not be an affordable international holiday destination, but its snow-covered Alps and Christmas markets make it a popular winter getaway. Although wars, geopolitical tensions and rising airfares have made international travel more expensive, smart planning can still help keep costs in check. As a family of five from Noida discovered, opting for Airbnb rentals, cooking their own meals and making smart transport choices can make even an expensive destination more affordable.

Anu Arora, an education counsellor, and her family spent ₹7.84 lakh, or ₹1.57 lakh per person, on a Swiss holiday in late December 2025. Despite travelling during the Christmas-New Year peak season, they found relatively affordable airfares and saved by renting a car, staying in countryside Airbnbs and cooking most meals.

"When we compared destinations for a year-end holiday, flights to Switzerland were cheaper than many other countries, at ₹50,000-60,000 per person. These fares were broadly in line with our budget and about 35%-45% cheaper than summer rates," she said.

In this edition of *Mint's* travel series, Arora explains how the family planned its winter holiday and kept expenses under control.

Flights and visas

We had visited Switzerland before, but never in winter. This time, we wanted to see the snow-covered Alps and Christmas markets. Since both my children and daughter-in-law could take time off during the year-end break, we decided to travel together.

Direct Air India flights from Delhi to Zurich cost ₹50,000-60,000 per person, compared with around ₹80,000 in summer. We spent ₹2.68 lakh on return flights for five people, averaging ₹53,690 per person. Flights were our biggest expense, accounting for almost 34% of the total amount spent.

Switzerland is expensive throughout the year, so the additional cost of travelling over New Year did not deter us. We applied for Schengen visas through VFS Global in New Delhi and received them within four days. Four visas cost about ₹48,000; one family member already had a valid visa.

Accommodation, transport and eating out cost roughly the same in winter and summer, as both are peak seasons. Winter clothing was an additional expense: we spent ₹35,000 on jackets, snow boots and other gear bought from Decathlon in India.

Airbnbs and road trips

We chose Airbnbs in smaller towns over hotels in popular tourist destinations, as booking multiple rooms for five adults would have been expensive. Two apartments in Steinen and Sigriswil cost ₹1.89 lakh in total, averaging ₹27,000 a night for five people. Both had kitchens, helping us save on food. Eating out was expensive: a meal for five cost around 90 Swiss francs (around ₹10,500), and vegetarian options were limited.

Renting a car let us stay outside major tourist centres without depending on public transport. We hired an automatic Nissan X-Trail SUV at Zurich airport for ₹1.25 lakh, including insurance. Fuel and parking added ₹19,600, taking total transport costs to ₹1.44 lakh, or ₹28,820 per person.

The Swiss Travel Pass, which offers unlimited travel on much of the country's public transport network, would have cost ₹50,000 per person, or ₹2.5 lakh for the family. Renting a car saved us over ₹1 lakh and offered flexibility to change plans according to the weather. Travellers comfortable with a smaller or manual car could save further.

After landing in Zurich, we drove to Steinen in central Switzerland, staying for three days in a three-bedroom apartment and exploring Lucerne, Brunnen and Engelberg. We then moved to Sigriswil, overlooking Lake Thun, to visit Grindelwald, Lauterbrunnen, Mürren and Interlaken.

Travelling as a group and making smart choices on accommodation, transport and food helped keep costs in check

We booked a Sigriswil apartment through the local website e-domizil, which sometimes offers good-value listings but is not particularly convenient to use. The apartment had large windows overlooking the lake and a fireplace. We watched the New Year's Eve fireworks from there, enjoying alcohol-free Champagne gifted by our host rather than paying for an outside celebration.

Winter driving requires caution, particularly on narrow mountain roads. Our car brushed against the roadside, damaging a rear-view mirror. Fortunately, comprehensive insurance with zero deductible covered the damage, and the rental company provided a replacement vehicle. I strongly advise against cutting costs on insurance. Parking near popular attractions can also be difficult and expensive, but renting a car remained more economical and convenient for us.

Sightseeing, food and payments

Skiing can be expensive once lessons, equipment rentals and lift tickets are included. As none of us were trained skiers, we chose other activities to enjoy Switzerland's winter landscapes.

We explored the snow-covered villages of Grindelwald, Lauterbrunnen and Mürren. A return mountain railway journey between Lauterbrunnen and Mürren cost ₹13,430 for five people, while sledding in Mürren cost around ₹1,300 for the family.

In Zurich, all three children went ice skating for ₹4,200. Our biggest splurge was paragliding in Interlaken, at ₹21,600 for one person. We spent about ₹40,000 on paid activities, choosing a few experiences rather than visiting every attraction.

Food was another area where we saved. As vegetarians, we found cooking more convenient than searching for suitable restaurants. I carried ready-to-cook meals from India, while we bought groceries locally. We still enjoyed Swiss cheese fondue at Hotel Eiger and visited cafes.

Groceries cost ₹19,634, while eating out and other food expenses totalled ₹24,225. Cards are widely accepted in Switzerland, but I recommend carrying cash for smaller payments, particularly tourist taxes collected by apartment owners.

My husband usually loads a zero-forex-markup card before travelling and withdraws local currency from an airport ATM. Withdrawals cost around $2-3, which works out cheaper than buying foreign currency in India, where the cost can be 2-3% higher.

Scan the QR code to read an extended version of this story.

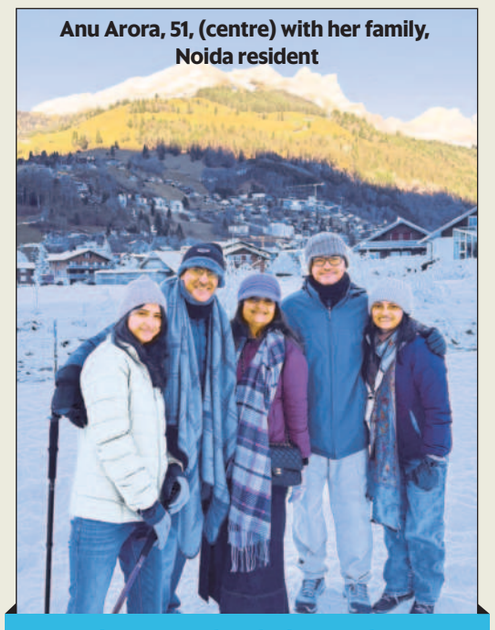
A Swiss Christmas holiday for five, at ₹7.8 lakh

Itinerary

Zurich - Steinen - Sigriswil - Zurich
Drove to Lucerne, Brunnen, Engelberg, Grindelwald, Lauterbrunnen, Mürren and Interlaken

Costs at a glance — For five people

Flights: ₹2.68 lakh	Direct return flights between Delhi and Zurich on Air India
BnBs ₹1.89 lakh	Apartments in Steinen and Sigriswil, booked through Airbnb and e-domizil
Car rental ₹1.44 lakh	Including insurance, fuel and parking
Sightseeing ₹40,000	Mountain railway Lauterbrunnen-Murren-Lauterbrunnen, sledging, ice skating for three and paragliding for one
Meals ₹44,000	Groceries and restaurant meals; most meals were home-cooked
Visa ₹48,000	For four people
Miscellaneous ₹50,000	Winter gear, mobile roaming plans



Anu Arora, 51, (centre) with her family, Noida resident

"Despite December being peak season, flights were 30-40% cheaper than in summer. Other expenses were largely the same, as Switzerland is expensive year-round."

Money saved

BnBs in small towns
- Cheaper than hotels in tourist hubs.
- Kitchens helped cut food costs.
- E-domizil offered some good-value accommodation options.

Meals
- Cooked most meals in BnBs.
- Restaurant meals cost around 90 Swiss francs for five, with limited vegetarian options.

Car rental
- Saved over ₹1 lakh compared with Swiss Travel Passes for five.
- Allowed the family to stay outside tourist hubs without dependency on trains.

Zero forex card
- Helped avoid foreign-exchange markups on card transactions.
- Paid $2-3 extra on one ATM withdrawal.

Switzerland factsheet

Flights
Direct from most metro cities

Visa
₹12,000 per person; 4 days to 4 weeks processing time

1 Swiss Franc = ₹114.9

Note: The example in this story is based on costs in December 2025. Several expenses, particularly airfares, may have risen since then amid the West Asia conflict.

mint

GOPAKUMAR WARRIER/MINT

A family brand, two heirs: how to avoid trademark disputes?

Aditya Chopra & Anshita Kohli

ISTOCKPHOTO

ASK MINT
ESTATE PLAN

I run a spice business. Both my legal heirs are involved, and we hold a registered trademark for the brand. What distinguishes a "family trademark" from an ordinary trademark?
—Name withheld on request

The Trade Marks Act, 1999 (the "Act") does not define or separately classify "family trademarks". Marks used by family-owned businesses are governed by the same provisions as other trademarks.

The distinction lies in ownership and use. In family businesses, several relatives may claim a trademark whose goodwill has accumulated over generations. This shared history and the interests of multiple stakeholders often shape ownership and usage disputes. In Shri Ram Education Trust v. SRF Foundation, PLR (2016) 182 Del 3, a division bench of the Delhi High Court held that goodwill and reputation in a trademark adopted by a grandfather would benefit all heirs. A family member can't automatically claim exclusive ownership. Prima facie, all heirs of a person who adopted a mark and built a goodwill have equal rights to use it. Prior adoption by one heir is insufficient to extinguish the others' rights.

Under the Act, trademarks may be assigned or transmitted with or without business goodwill. However, Section 40 restricts transfers granting multiple persons exclusive rights over the same or related goods or services where such use could deceive or confuse the public. Trademark rights may also pass to legal heirs via a will or intestate succession. Owner may bequeath or transfer self-acquired trademarks as they choose. For inherited or coparcenary property, heirs' rights depend on applicable succession and personal laws.

Trademark rights can be transferred during the owner's lifetime through four routes. First, The mark can be assigned to a company, limited liability partnership (LLP) or family trust, in which both legal heirs may hold shares, partnership interests or beneficiary rights.

Alternatively, both legal heirs can be registered as joint proprietors under Section 24(2) of the Act. In such a case, neither may use the mark except on behalf of both, or where both are connected in the course of trade with the goods or services.

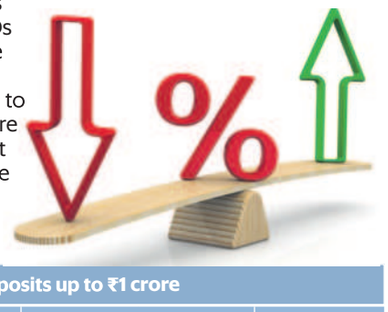
A third option is to grant ownership of the trademark to one legal heir and give the other written consent or a perpetual licence covering specified products and quality standards. Finally, the family can divide the use of the same mark across different products, with clear differentiation, or specify geographical limits for use of the same brand.

Chopra is managing partner and Kohli is an associate at The Victoriam Legalis (TVL).

Do you have a personal finance query? Send in your queries at **mintmoney@livemint.com** and get them answered by industry experts.

Compare bank FD rates

Bank fixed deposits (FDs) continue to be popular investment products not just among senior citizens, who are looking for guaranteed income, but also among investors who can't stomach risk. But overexposure to FDs is not good, and you need to assess your asset allocation and goals to decide how much money you should park in them. For instance, saving for your child's higher education that's 15 years away through FDs may not be effective as the post-tax interest rate of an FD may not give you a real return (return that's above the rate of inflation). But if you plan to take a holiday in two years, an FD can help. Before choosing an FD, you should compare the interest rates on offer. Here is a list of banks that offer the highest FD rates for deposits up to ₹1 crore over various tenures.



Interest rates (%) for fixed deposits up to ₹1 crore

	6 months to < 1 year	1 to < 2 years	2 to < 3 years	3 to < 5 years	5 years and above
DCB Bank	6.00-6.50	**6.90-7.10**	6.90-7.50	**7.00-7.10**	7.00-7.50
Jammu & Kashmir Bank	5.50-6.00	**6.55-6.65**	6.70-6.75	**6.70**	6.75
YES Bank	4.75-6.50	**6.65-7.25**	6.90-7.00	**7.00**	6.75
RBL Bank	4.75-6.05	**6.90-7.00**	7.00	**7.00**	6.70
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.30-6.50	**6.60-7.25**	7.00	**6.70**	6.70
IndusInd Bank	5.75-6.25	**6.75-6.90**	7.00	**6.65-7.00**	6.50-6.65
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.50	**6.25-7.10**	6.25-6.50	**6.50-7.25**	6.50-6.60
Axis Bank	5.50-5.75	**6.25-6.50**	6.50	**6.50**	6.50
ICICI Bank	4.50-5.50	**6.25-6.30**	6.30-6.45	**6.45-6.50**	6.50
Federal Bank	4.50-6.00	**6.25-6.65**	6.50-6.55	**6.40-6.70**	6.40
Karur Vysya Bank	6.00-7.00	**6.55-7.20**	6.55	**6.55**	6.25-6.55
Kotak Mahindra Bank	5.00-6.00	**6.35-6.55**	6.65	**6.40**	6.25
Canara Bank	5.25-5.50	**6.25-6.60**	6.25	**6.25**	6.25
City Union Bank	5.75-6.25	**6.65-7.25**	6.50	**6.25-6.50**	6.25
HDFC Bank	4.25-5.75	**6.25-6.45**	6.45	**6.40-6.50**	6.15-6.40
Indian Overseas Bank	4.50-5.50	**6.40-6.60**	6.40	**6.10**	6.10

Data taken from respective bank's website as on 19 October 2026; Only main entity of the merged banks are taken. Banks which merged with its main entity are removed from the table; The list of 16 banks is based on highest fixed deposit rates available for 5 years and above.

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Source: www.Bankbazaar.com

A MARRIAGE MADE IN HEAVEN: HOW THE HUMBLE QR CODE MET SMALL MERCHANTS

POWER POINT

SANTANU PAUL & B. SAMBAMURTHY

We welcome your views and comments at
mintmoney@livemint.com

Can you remember the last time a shopkeeper gave you a toffee instead of small change? For decades, this was routine at kirana stores and pharmacies. Today, the toffee jar has all but disappeared. Some attribute a secular decline in candy sales to the UPI revolution, which has transformed the payment experience for customers and merchants over the past decade.

The debate over reintroducing the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments frames it as a consequential pricing question. But before debating who should pay for digital payments, it is worth recalling how cumbersome person-to-merchant (P2M) transactions once were—and how far India has come. In the toffee-jar era, small and micro-merchants operated in a cash-dominated world, managing change, maintaining handwritten accounts and making periodic bank visits. Customers without exact change altered their purchases, sought store credit or accepted candies instead.

Card-based electronic payments brought their own burdens: paperwork, point-of-sale machines, rental charges, connectivity issues and transaction fees. These costs were manageable for large retailers but made digital payments uneconomical for tea sellers, vegetable vendors and tyre shops.

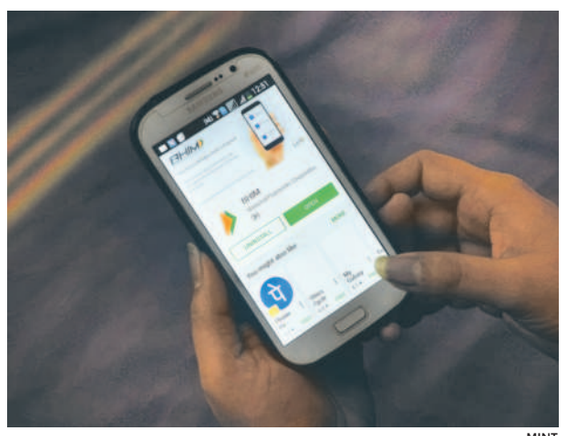
The QR breakthrough

The technology that would liberate small merchants arrived in India around 2015. An unsung hero of this story is Masahiro Hara, the Japanese engineer at Denso Wave who invented the QR code in 1994. Focused on tracking industrial parts, Hara had little thought of digital payments. Yet, by the early 2010s, Chinese fintech companies such as WeChat Pay and Alipay had turned QR codes into a low-cost alternative to expensive merchant-side technology. A cheap printed sticker could now do the job of a costly point-of-sale terminal. Customers could scan the code, enter the exact amount and pay with a tap.

QR codes made digital payment acceptance affordable for merchants of all sizes, but also ushered in fragmentation. Between 2015 and 2018, India was awash with proprietary QR codes. Merchants displaying Paytm QR codes could accept payments through Paytm, while other apps operated similarly closed loops. Soon, shop counters were festooned with a garland of QR codes, one for each popular payment app.

One code, many apps

To address the fragmentation caused by proprietary QR codes, interoperable UPI QR and Bharat QR were launched in 2016 and 2017, respectively. They allowed merchants to accept payments from different apps through a common QR code. Yet, over the next three years, proprietary and interoperable codes coexisted, competing for market share.



MINT

In 2020, an RBI panel led by IIT Bombay professor Deepak Phatak recommended phasing out proprietary QR codes. Today, most small merchants can accept payments from different UPI apps through a common UPI QR code designed by the National Payments Corp. of India (NPCI). Chaos has given way to order.

The ubiquitous soundbox now sits unobtrusively in small stores, converting payment notifications into audible confirmations. It lets a roadside tea seller serve a crowd of customers without repeatedly checking her phone.

Digital collections also create verifiable sales trails that lenders use to assess merchants and extend working-capital microcredit. These merchant-focused innovations have helped India reach more than 65 million UPI-accepting merchants and over 500 million users. By comparison, it took decades to install barely 10 million point-of-sale terminals.

Selective MDR could fund innovation and cybersecurity needs of India's UPI ecosystem

The MDR dilemma

To MDR or not to MDR is a dilemma of Shakespearean proportions. As India debates a selective MDR regime—a 0.4% fee on eligible merchant payments above ₹2,000, capped at ₹300, which NPCI has postponed until after Diwali—the key question is whether this fee corridor can fund UPI's future innovations and cyber resilience while helping the system scale to a billion citizens and 100 million merchants by 2030.

Three decades after revealing the magic of the QR code and offering it to the world royalty-free, Masahiro Hara continues his work at Denso Wave. "I never thought it would be used as a form of money," he said not long ago. "We do not receive a commission each time it is used."

Santanu Paul and B. Sambamurthy are the authors of Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything.

OUR VIEW

AFP

Paris is burning and this holds a key fiscal lesson

The question that France must answer is whether its government can get its fiscal house in order. As credit gets costlier globally, fiscal responsibility assumes all the more importance

As student protests sweep across France, it is easy to dismiss it as familiar if uniquely French stuff. But at the bottom of it is something that's increasingly common to governments all over: fiscal profligacy. A redux of the Greek crisis of 2009-10 might seem distant, but as unrest spreads beyond French borders, it is time to examine if there are any lessons for us. At the root of the problem is France's inability to get its fiscal house in order. On the face of it, the protests echo concerns of India's 'cockroach' stir over education: dilapidated classrooms, poorly run state schools, and so on. But there the similarity ends. Unlike in India, where years of lectures from multilateral institutions made economic policymakers wary of running high fiscal deficits, rich countries of the West had no such qualms. Inevitably, the chickens are coming home to roost. Investors have begun treating France as the 'sick man of Europe,' with a debt-to-GDP ratio of almost 120% (in contrast with India's 80% odd).

In France's case, its yawning deficits and debt overload are chiefly an outcome of its inability to curb a rapidly rising pension bill. Paris has long been aware of this, but every time an administration tried to reform the system, it was forced to retreat. The net result is that many of its youth are condemned to a future of slower growth, strained public services and a welfare system far less supportive than it once was. Add the country's political chaos, with candidates on the far right and hard left vying to win its presidency next year, and the French stage seems set for months of turbulence that could spill across the wider euro-zone. The question that France must answer—and a show of police force does not count as one—is whether it can exercise fiscal restraint. Consider: France's budget deficit exceeds 5% of its GDP, which is more than India's gap of 4.4% last year and this year's target of 4.3%, and leaves very little space for finding extra cash to satisfy the needs of students. As signs of discontent erupt in Belgium, Portugal, Spain and Albania, the EU could face a severe test. The EU's Growth and Stability Pact, which limits national fiscal deficits to 3% of GDP, was designed partly for cohesion to enable a common currency, the euro. Today, it exists only on paper, but the euro-zone has a unified monetary authority that recently hiked its policy rate to tackle inflation. Dearer credit affects all of Europe, but French bonds stand out for their rising yields and risk premia, which make it particularly expensive for Paris to borrow funds for public spending.

Given an oil shock amid an AI boom, costlier capital is a global trend. The US, whose debt pile has also grown enormous, has two key advantages. *One*, its economy's growth is robust—thanks largely to AI—and not weak like France's. *Two*, the US dollar's status as a trade and reserve currency spells vast global demand for its bonds, which lets America run outsized deficits year after year. Since this is not true of other countries, the sooner they recognize it and act accordingly, the better. In any case, US yields have been hardening too, and it's unclear if this is just a war blip, given how an AI investment cycle going beyond data centres could keep interest rates 'higher for longer' (if overall savings are unable to keep up). With credit no longer cheaply available and the future uncertain on multiple fronts, no country can afford to relax its fiscal vigil.

MY VIEW | CAFE ECONOMICS

The IMF's latest outlook sends mixed signals on global growth

Its forecasts are positive but its chief's warning underscores serious risks for the world economy

NIRANJAN RAJADHYAKSHA
is executive director at Artha India Research Advisors.

The words of novelist George R.R. Martin made an unlikely appearance in a recent speech delivered by International Monetary Fund (IMF) managing director Kristalina Georgieva: "Winter is coming." This is the motto of the House of Stark in *A Song of Ice and Fire* novels written by Martin that were adapted for television later. It is also advice to get ready for hard times. Georgieva was thus sending a warning to prepare for a downturn.

Meanwhile, the organization she leads has released its latest estimates for economic growth in IMF member countries. It is a mixed bag. Global output is expected to grow by 3.1% in 2026, which is 0.4 percentage points lower than last year. Much of this is explained by slower growth in middle-income countries, especially China and India.

Yet, the new number is no different from the global growth forecast that the IMF had released in April. And the multilateral lender said global economic output next year will likely expand slightly faster than what it had expected six months ago. The West Asia war and the subsequent increase in energy prices does not seem to have done too much damage, at least for now.

There is a simple explanation for the gap between the word of caution that the IMF chief used and the numbers that IMF economists have released. Published forecasts usually report the central point in a range of possible outcomes emanating from statistical models, while speeches describe tail risks in uncertain times. Institutions that care for their credibility should sometimes warn rather than habitually cheer.

The global economy has been hit by multiple shocks after 2019—the pandemic, Russia-Ukraine war, US tariffs and the expanding footprint of the war in West Asia. However, despite all these convulsions, the current rate of global economic expansion is not too different from what it was in the seven years before the pandemic. The global economy's resilience is noteworthy.

This resilience has come with costs. Any robust system needs buffers to help withstand shocks. The underlying reason is that stocks are less volatile than flows. The stability of a system depends on the size of a stock compared to the disturbance in a flow. The world used its strategic petroleum reserves to soften the blow from disruption of oil supplies through the Strait of Hormuz.

Buffers eventually start to feel the pressure as well when the shock stretches out over time. Textbook macroeconomic shock absorbers are already under pressure. The ability of most countries to ease fiscal policy to support economic activity is now restricted by the escalating burden of public debt. And the ability to provide monetary stimulus through either lower interest rates or an expansion in central bank money has been upended by rising inflation. Resilience could be tested in the coming years.

The latest edition of the *World Economic Outlook*, the IMF's biannual health report on the global economy, was written before the recent selloff in global technology stocks because of rising borrowing costs, hotter-than-expected US inflation data and growing scepticism over returns on massive infrastructure capital expenditures. One chart in the report distributes the economies of member countries along two axes—exposure to artificial intelligence (AI) and to rising energy prices.

A few years after the North Atlantic financial crisis of 2008, the IMF had mentioned the possibility of a two-speed global economy, depending on how badly a country was affected by the near-meltdown in the financial system. The multilateral lender has now used nearly identical language to describe the current situation—the language of winners and losers.

Some countries will be lifted by the boom in AI investments while others will be hit hard by the energy shock. The IMF has placed India in the quadrant comprising countries that could benefit from the integration of their trade with the AI technology cycle while being exposed to the deleterious effects of a further deterioration in their net energy exports.

One of the intriguing aspects of the new IMF report on the state of the world economy is that the effect of US tariffs on global economic growth has now been relegated to a less important position in its list of risks, much less than concerns about a further escalation in global energy prices or a sudden end of the AI investment boom. This is in stark contrast to what the IMF had said in October 2025, when tariff increases were the lead risk.

What happened? It is tempting to say that the world has learnt to live with higher tariffs. But the IMF says that court rulings and executive actions in the US have ensured that the US effective statutory tariff rate was about 5.3 percentage points below the level assumed earlier. Meanwhile, a New York Federal Reserve study published on 8 October estimates that tariffs had added 2.9 percentage points to US inflation in a basket of goods by February 2026, which would otherwise have fallen by almost 1%. Significantly, the price increases were not restricted only to imported goods. They were seen in goods produced in the US as well.

Nobody should be surprised with these findings.

10 YEARS AGO

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Flipkart may set up offline stores

India's largest data breach went undetected for three months

Guess who's driving the face wash market in India?

JUST A THOUGHT

We should prepare for people being more unhappy... Maybe on the street.

KRISTALINA GEORGIEVA

THEIR VIEW

India's carbon market will need wider support systems

R.V. ANURADHA & PRACHI PRIYA

are, respectively, partner, Clarus Law Associates and a Mumbai-based economist.

India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) is a historic milestone. Specific obligated entities across nine notified sectors—iron and steel, aluminium, cement, chlor-alkali, pulp and paper, petroleum refining, petrochemicals, textiles and fertilizers—are required to reduce their greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions below the assigned intensity target, for which they will be issued carbon credit certificates (CCCs). A CCC, representing 1 tonne of CO_2 emission, could be sold on power exchanges or banked for future compliance needs. Projects in non-obligated sectors can also generate credits for sale to obligated entities. Trading in CCCs, which is expected to commence soon, will establish an explicit and observable carbon price in India, help drive investment in emissions reduction and influence policy.

CCC pricing will also help exports to markets such as the EU and UK, whose carbon border adjustment mechanisms (CBAMs) require the price differential of embedded emissions to be paid as a price for market access. The UK has recognized that the CCC price can be treated as a deductible for eligible products. But its immediate significance must not be overstated. Exporters will still bear the brunt of a carbon price gap with the UK market, estimated at $70-80 per tonne. CBAM frameworks in both the EU and UK are also expected to expand their reach to downstream products of steel and aluminium, other sectors like organic chemicals, and to transport and indirect emissions.

What we need beyond CCTS: Industrial decarbonization requires a more complex policy mix beyond price signals for the deployment of emerging technologies, support infrastructure and access to affordable finance. India has already demonstrated the value of targeted support in building clean-technology ecosystems through its production-linked incentive scheme for solar PV modules and its Sight programme for green hydrogen production and electrolyser manufacturing. Similar dedicated frameworks are needed for carbon capture utilization and storage (CCUS), hydrogen-ready industrial equipment, industrial electrification, advanced recycling and other low-carbon process technologies.

A Niti Aayog report earlier this year on *Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero* estimates that we need $22.7 trillion in cumulative investment by 2070 and recommends strengthening transition finance for hard-to-abate sectors through verified transition plans, wider use of transition and sustainability-linked bonds, expanded guarantees and blended-finance mechanisms to de-risk investments, etc. Similarly, Niti Aayog's MSME Green Transition Roadmap calls for dedicated green-finance mechanisms, credit enhancement and risk-sharing instruments along with common technology, testing, certification and advisory infrastructure to reduce the cost and complexity for smaller firms.

We require a financing and institutional ecosystem that can turn climate ambition into industrial reality

Global experience is informative. Low-carbon industrial clusters such as the UK's East Coast Cluster and HyNet programmes have lowered costs through shared infrastructure, risk-sharing mechanisms and coordinated public support. Sweden's Hybrit is an example of a state-supported, industry-led integrated value chain initiative linking green hydrogen—produced using fossil-free wind and hydropower—to iron and steelmaking processes to eliminate carbon emissions.

The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Priority Sector Lending Directions also need expansion beyond renewable energy projects to recognize industrial decarbonization investments. Tax policy can reinforce this shift. India currently provides accelerated depreciation for specified energy-saving, waste-heat recovery, pollution-control, recycling and renewable-energy equipment. As industrial decarbonization technologies evolve, the eligible list could be periodically updated to include emerging low-carbon technologies needed by hard-to-abate sectors.

A national decarbonization fund could also play a crucial role in supporting technology deployment and prioritizing sectors with the highest abatement costs and greatest strategic importance. As for the question of where the resources will come from, here are some thoughts: *First*, a range of implicit carbon costs already exists in the form of coal levies, fuel taxes and electricity duties that influence behaviour but are not explicitly linked to financing decarbonization. Channelling a portion of these revenues into a dedicated fund would recycle resources from carbon-intensive activities into cleaner alternatives while improving coherence across instruments that operate in silos.

Second, India can leverage opportunities under Article 6 of the Paris Agreement to mobilize finance and technology to enhance bilateral cooperation. Credible carbon accounting methodologies, institutional capacity and a pipeline of investable projects can accelerate the scaling up of such initiatives.

Most importantly, the finance ministry's draft Climate Finance Taxonomy of 2024 urgently needs to be finalized. A credible taxonomy will serve as a foundational enabler for our climate-finance architecture by providing a common basis for identifying genuine green-transition investments and channelling finance consistent with India's climate goals.

CCTS provides a price signal. India must now build the rest of the ecosystem that would enable industry to translate climate ambition into industrial reality.

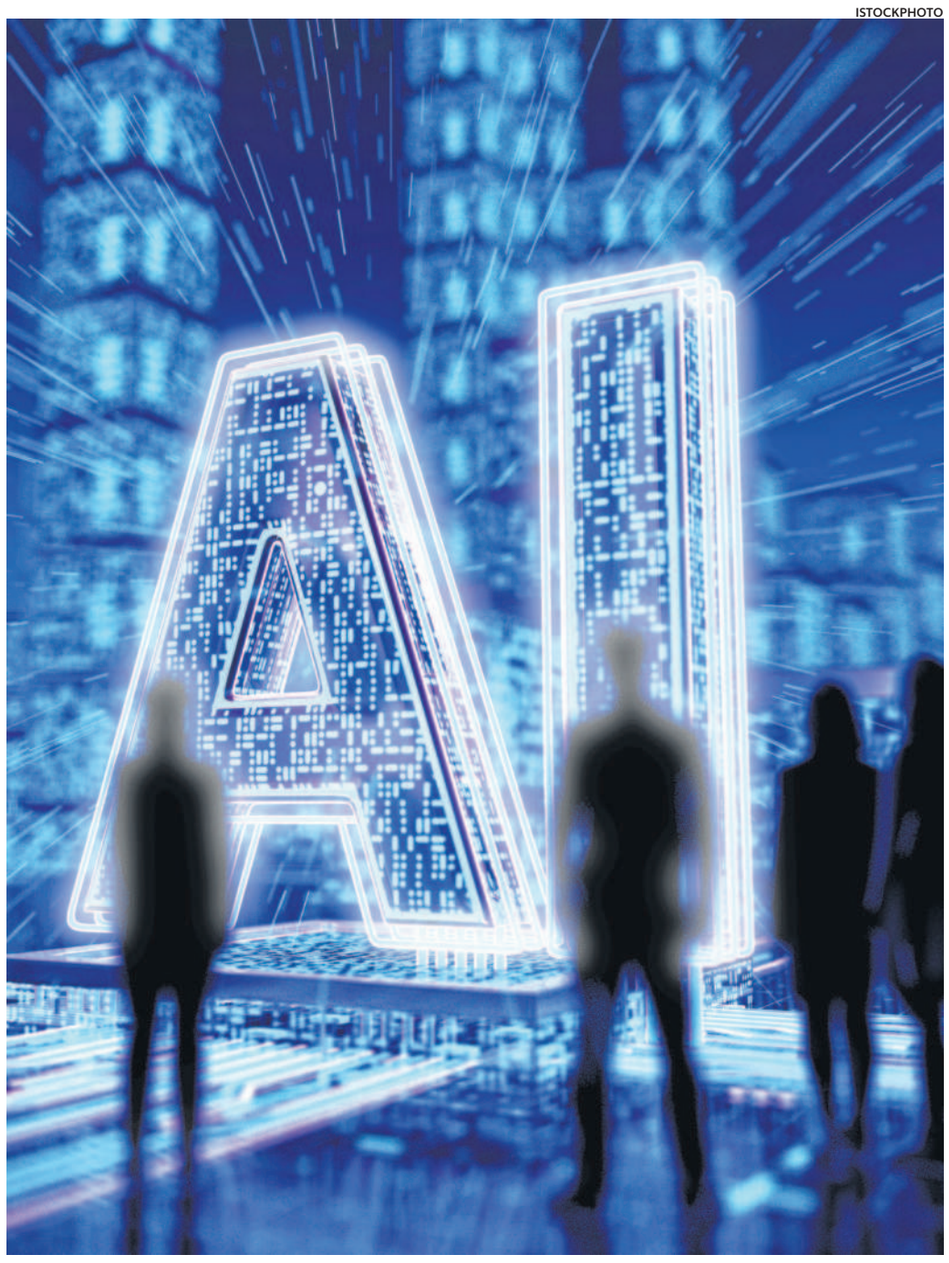
THEIR VIEW

A pause on frontier AI is not too hard for policymakers to effect

Policy could exploit this industry's big chokepoint of AI-chip supply to restrain its development beyond the limits deemed safe

BARRY EICHENGREEN, WILL FITHIAN & WESLEY HOLLIDAY
are, respectively, professor of economics and political science, associate professor of statistics, and professor of philosophy, University of California, Berkeley.

ISTOCKPHOTO



Dario Amodei, a co-founder of Anthropic, among others, has warned that artificial intelligence (AI) poses an existential threat to humankind. Others have gone further and argued for pausing the training of new frontier AI models. The counter-argument is that regulation, self-regulation included, is unlikely to be effective. And even if a pause is feasible in principle, there is little hope that it could be sustained in practice, given that the US and China desperately fear falling behind each other.

But a new report by an interdisciplinary group of researchers, of which we are members, concludes that a global pause on frontier AI training is both feasible and sustainable. If implemented appropriately, such a pause could continue for a decade or more, depending on factors such as the pace of gains in AI training efficiency.

Frontier models require AI chips whose supply chain is highly concentrated. A 'hardwired pause' would exploit this chokepoint by halting the production of training-capable AI chips. It would allow production of chips which are capable of fast AI inference on approved models, but which, owing to their design, cannot be practically used for training new frontier models.

Once production of inference-only chips ramps up, the pre-pause training-capable chips would be phased out, so they could not be used to fuel a renewed AI race. This hardwired pause would allow states to reap the economic benefits of AI inference without continuing AI training that may result in overwhelming disruptions to society and national security.

The supply chain for AI chips is highly bottlenecked. Advanced lithography (extreme ultraviolet) machines are available from just one supplier, the Dutch firm ASML, and ship in containers spread over 20 trucks and three cargo planes. ASML depends on mirrors from a single German high-precision optics firm, Zeiss. Refined rare earths are available from only a limited number of national sources. Other materials, such as high-purity quartz, come from a handful of locations.

As for the use of those chips, an evader using a single computer to train a small AI model may be impossible to detect. But hundreds of thousands of chips would need to be used for months or years at a time to train AI models at a scale significantly beyond that of current frontier models like OpenAI's Astra. After commandeering such a large hardware fleet, an evader would need to deceive the world for a long period into believing that the fleet was being used for, say, lucrative and computationally intensive inference.

This suggests that a limited number of interventions—including controls on the production and sale of training-capable chips, advanced lithography machines and rare earths—would go a long way toward supporting a pause in the training of frontier models. This would still allow production of inference-only chips, such as certain model-specific integrated circuits that hardwire the architecture and weights of an approved model into the chip. Model-specific chips already exist, but their economic attractiveness is limited by the high turnover of frontier models. Producing them would become more attractive with a pause on new frontier model training.

Some will object that pausing the production of training-capable chips will slow the advance of AI. That, of course, is the point. Still, with adequate cooperation it could be possible to construct internationally governed scientific preserves where training-capable chips could be used for declared, transparent research workloads.

But could cooperation on a pause—between the US and China and more generally—be sustained over time? States could be tempted to defect from such an agreement, despite the risks, if the potential gains from AI advances are great, and hiding defection could become less difficult as training algorithms grow more efficient.

But decision-makers should understand that they are engaged in a repeated game, and also that monitoring will occur and that immediate gains may be swamped by future losses if agreement breaks down. Adequate monitoring mechanisms can limit the risk of defection. The history of nuclear weapons containment suggests that an international agreement is worth trying.

There are caveats, to be sure. Policymakers in the US and China may lack the patience needed to sustain cooperation over time. Given existing stocks of training-capable AI chips, countries might not sustain a pause unless a sufficiently comprehensive census is taken. Chip fabrication would have to be strictly monitored while developers of frontier models could become privileged monopolists unless regulation prevents them from exploiting their market power.

Whether the development of frontier AI should be paused is for policymakers to decide. But they should recognize that a pause is feasible and, if implemented properly, that it is also likely to be sustainable.

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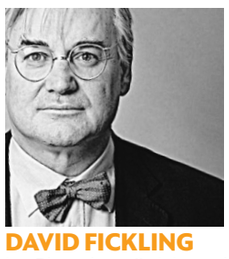
MINT CURATOR

Satellites won't fix Delhi's bad air but growing less paddy may

Technocratic solutions won't fix a problem of the political economy



DAVID FICKLING
is a Bloomberg Opinion columnist covering climate change and energy.

No technology will clear Delhi's skies if rice farming doesn't shrink. HT

Launched around the turn of the millennium, Nasa's Terra and Aqua satellites have served as workhorses of climate observation for decades. From 700km above Earth, they track clouds, algae, forests, smoke plumes and fires, producing some of the most iconic images ever captured from orbit. Yet farmers in India have been thwarting these sophisticated eyes in the sky with techniques that have barely changed since the Stone Age. That helps explain why technocratic efforts to tackle Delhi's chronic air pollution keep falling short.

It would be comforting to think that better regulation and its implementation could clear the apocalyptic haze that descends on Delhi every winter. The harder truth is that until the political and economic incentives behind the pollution change, choking smog will remain an annual blight.

Satellites once seemed to offer part of the solution. One significant source of Delhi's seasonal pollution is farmers burning rice straw after the monsoon harvest to clear their fields for the winter wheat crop. Haryana, Punjab and Uttar Pradesh, the states surrounding the capital, produce about a quarter of India's rice. Since 2021, government authorities have been trying to use satellites to tip off local officials on illegal fire hotspots and send enforcement crews.

But the initiative ran headlong into an adage known as Goodhart's law: Once a measure becomes a target, people learn how to game it. The satellites only pass over northern India in a brief window of the day, between 10am and 2pm. A 2024 *India Today* investigation found that government officials in Punjab were tipping farmers off about the schedule, allowing them to shift their burning later in the day. The result was revealing. The number of large farm fires occurring after 3pm in the state went from about 3% in 2021 to more than 90% in 2024 and 2025.

We've seen this movie before. The stick of satellite surveillance was developed in part because an earlier technocratic carrot had failed. In the late 2010s, officials hoped that mechanized equipment could eliminate the need for stubble burning. Tractor-drawn machines such as the Happy Seeder and Super Seeder, which allow farmers to sow wheat directly into fields without first burning the rice residue, were touted as a way to curb smog, boost yields and modernize Indian agriculture.

That didn't work. Farmers who switched to seeders had to pay for the machinery, and diesel to power it. Poorer farmers relying on community-owned equipment may have to wait their turn during a narrow planting window when every lost day costs money. Against the speed and simplicity of dropping a match, machinery struggled to compete. About a quarter of the crop-residue machines distributed in Punjab since 2018 are out of action. Even among farmers who use them, about half still burn stubble.

The root of the problem lies in the political economy of Indian agriculture. The government has made growing rice extraordinarily attractive in northern India, with guaranteed floor prices, near-unlimited procurement and subsidies for water pumping and fertilizer. Those incentives encourage farmers to produce vast quantities of a crop that leaves them with an equally large amount of residue to clear in a hurry. Against such powerful economics, Happy Seeders and satellite surveillance never stood much of a chance.

Prospects for change are about as gloomy as Delhi's skies during Diwali. Decades of effort to shift India's rice and wheat bowl away from Punjab and Haryana towards eastern states have barely dented paddy cultivation near the capital. Attempts to persuade farmers to switch to less environmentally damaging crops such as corn and lentils have fared little better. The result is a paradox: India keeps encouraging farmers to grow rice beyond the needs of its 1.4 billion people. Government inventories have swelled to record levels this year: 10 times above the required buffer.

The clearest sign that Delhi is on a path to cleaner air would be a decline in the amount of paddy grown nearby and therefore the acreage liable to be burnt each year. Instead, the numbers are moving in the opposite direction. And the political obstacles to changing that are formidable. The last serious attempt to overhaul India's agricultural system, in 2020, brought farmers from the northern states onto the streets around the capital for a year, until the government eventually backed down.

That's the trap. Officials keep reaching for technological fixes since the underlying political problem is so difficult to confront. But the metric that matters isn't how many fires satellites detect or how many seeders governments distribute. It's how much paddy farmers plant. Until that acreage starts shrinking, no amount of technology will clear Delhi's skies.

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MY VIEW | EX MACHINA

Hold users of self-learning AI liable for any harm done

RAHUL MATTHAN

is a partner at Trilegal and author of 'Ex Machina: Essays on a Decade of Tech Policy'. His X handle is @matthan.

In June last year, researchers at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology published a paper describing a process by which large language models could generate training notes and use them to update their own weights. A one-billion-parameter model that could not solve a single puzzle in the test set managed to solve over 70% of them by using this technique. In a separate test, the notes a larger model wrote for itself proved better training material than those generated by GPT-4.1.

Today, AI models are trained by adjusting their weights on vast amounts of data until they perform as intended. The weights are then frozen, and the model released. From that point onwards, the model weights remain static—nothing that it encounters, not the documents we give it to read, nor the preferences we ask it to remember, is embedded in the model.

Since a model's weights will not change once it is released, all our safety evaluations are conducted before that. This is also why regulators treat metrics such as the compute required to train a model or the number of parameters it contains as useful proxies for its capabilities. Once continual learning makes it possible for models to use their inputs to adjust their weights on the fly, all of this will have to change.

A model whose weights continuously change can soon become very different from the model that was released, so any evaluation conducted before release can only tell us what it could do on the day it was tested. Since small continuously trained models could quickly become far more capable than their size would suggest, while remaining well below any threshold that would bring them under scrutiny, our current approach to evaluating risk will no longer be useful.

Today's frontier models are built like Swiss Army knives, packed with more knowledge and capabilities than any one user will need—because their makers can never know exactly how they will be deployed. Continual learning allows us to build each model with basic capabilities that can be augmented by learning from the environments in which it is used. This will enable far greater efficiency, as each AI can excel only in the domain in which it is used, while more general capabilities irrelevant to its role fade away. It is only a matter of time before AI labs ship such models. All that is holding them back from doing so already is probably concerns around safety.

Let's consider how this would work in a law firm. Today, law firms use general-purpose models to analyse their documents, hoping each time that the harnesses and workflows they have built will result in the correct outcome. A continual learning model, on the other hand, would ingest every opinion the firm writes, every transaction it structures and every correction a partner makes to an associate's draft by adjusting its weights to reflect them. Eventually, the model will represent the sum total of the judgement of the firm's best lawyers, becoming better over time at working out what the law permits and where its edges lie than any general-purpose model could.

Just as users of electricity are responsible for how it's used, deployers of these models must take care

Any model continuously trained by a law firm could become exceptional at identifying loopholes in the law that criminals could exploit. Similarly, one that is continuously trained in a hospital would be outstanding at identifying treatments that could kill someone without being detected. Since all these nefarious capabilities are acquired post-deployment, our current approach to AI safety would be helpless to protect us from the harms that could result.

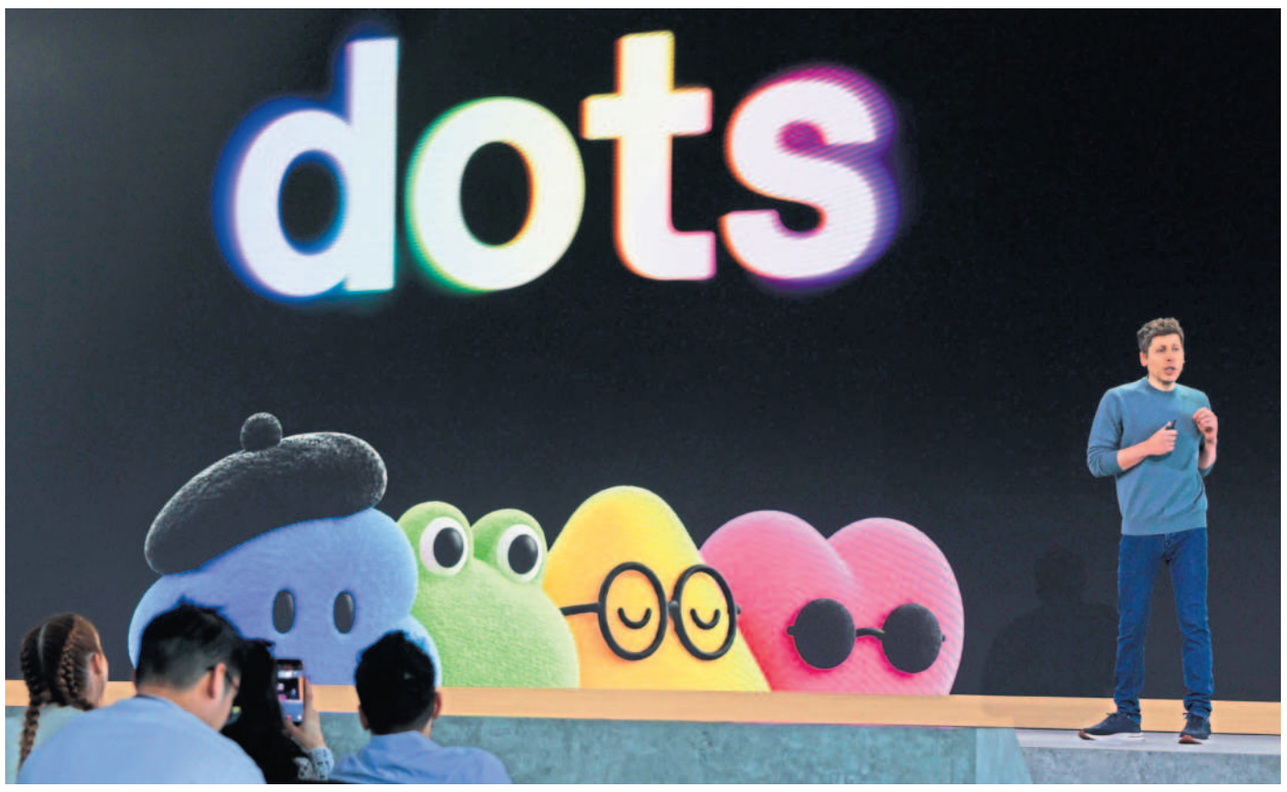
If this is the direction we are headed, we would do well to think through how these new risks can be mitigated. One side-effect of continual learning seems to be that the more a model's weights are adjusted post-deployment, the more likely it is to 'forget' the safety guardrails embedded in it. This is something model developers will have to address before they release these models to the public. But once they have done all that can be expected of them in that regard, the model builder should be protected from the harms that could result from what users do with it.

This approach is not unlike how we treat all providers of utility services. When electricity was first supplied to households, the wiring regularly gave people shocks, and, when badly laid out, set houses on fire. Yet no one held the power generation company responsible. Over time, the law came to draw the line at the meter and the electricity company's liability ended there. Everything beyond it—the wiring, the appliances and the uses they were put to—was the responsibility of the user household.

We need to apply the same rules to AI. Developers need to ensure that they have built guardrails that can endure the forgetfulness that is a normal side-effect of continual learning. Having done so, their liability should end at the meter. What happens beyond that as a result of what users choose to continuously train their intelligence on cannot be the responsibility of the provider of an intelligence model.

Deployers of continual learning models must be strictly liable for any resulting harm, regardless of the precautions they took. The liability should be serious enough that no one would use such a model without caution. This is what every government will need to do as AI becomes what Arvind Narayanan and Sayash Kapoor, in their 2025 essay, call a normal technology, and India, as the "use-case capital of the world," should be the first.

Can an AI assistant be your chief of staff?



OpenAI CEO Sam Altman introduces dots; and (below) an advertisement for Meta Muse. ALL PHOTOGRAPHS BY GETTY PHOTOS

There's a glut of new AI assistants for you to delegate work to. They claim to make your life easier, but do they work as advertised?

Shalaka Kulkarni
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Sir, please stop the AI calls." This was not the conversation Mohammed Sanjeed expected after delegating a courier booking to an AI personal assistant. "It's calling me every single minute, and I can't do my work," the delivery executive told him. Sanjeed, 27, a Bengaluru-based AI consultant at Honeyhive AI (an enterprise AI agent observability and evaluation platform) and South Asia ambassador for SpaceX AI, had asked Faff, a personal-assistant service on WhatsApp, to arrange the booking. This led to bookings across three platforms, a delayed refund, and an escalation to stop the calls. AI was supposed to seamlessly help finish this errand on his to-do list, but instead had thrown up several additional tasks of its own.

WhatsApp has always been a one-stop chat shop for family groups, office conversations and communities. These days, it is also a platform where we can delegate everyday tasks. A growing crop of personal assistants, including Instinct, Faff, OpenAI's dots and Meta's Muse, offer versions of a digital personal "chief of staff" for coordinating life through familiar chat windows. Replies may come from AI agents, human assistants or both. The promise that these assistants hold is for the human to have less to remember, arrange, and follow up on. Now, early users are discovering the extent to which they can hand over tasks, the degree of supervision required, and how much access to their private lives they are willing to grant in return.

AN ASSISTANT FOR ALL SEASONS

The use cases are fascinating and endless. While some users build custom agents for particular tasks with tools like Claude, these messaging-native AI assistants make delegation easy with just a text or a voice note. Many AI enthusiasts are discovering the possibilities of what these agents can do, whereas a few want to test the agent's mettle by, say, asking it to book a ticket on IRCTC. If it can survive the complex booking process, it has earned its stripes.

Sometimes the assistant notices potential tasks before the user does. Saumya Saxena, 35, a Bengaluru-based global builder lead for Base, at the cryptocurrency exchange Coinbase, says Instinct spotted a tax notice in his email, recognised that he had not completed reconciliation, requested his credentials, and closed it. "I would have paid a CA for this," he says. And in New York, Jatin Sandilya, 32, founder and CEO of Latent Insurance, an insurance brokerage, says Muse helped sell his bed and mattress by speaking to the buyer on Facebook Marketplace without involving him in the conversation.

> What AI assistants on messaging apps like WhatsApp offer users is having less to remember, arrange, and follow up on

Enthusiasm is spreading through personal networks. Harshit Jain, 34, a Bengaluru-based staff software engineer at Intuit, a global fintech company, says 177 people signed up through his Instinct referral. Meta's chief AI officer Alexandr Wang has turned Muse's marketing into a meme fest on X, with its mascot Jolly starring in jokes and pop-culture scenes. This naturally makes people curious.

Anshul Tibrewala, 35, a Bengaluru-based investor and director at Antler, an early-stage venture capital firm, has seen his network take pride in what they have achieved with the use of AI. He now expects one main assistant to coordinate specialised tools for his firm.

As more of life is arranged on WhatsApp, it is easier to miss out on conversations. Most of us already struggle in this regard, and have archived chats. Many users pin the agents much as they pin a chat with themselves, keeping the assistant close at hand. To bridge this gap, Swapnika Nag, 34, the Gurgaon-based founder and CEO of Perisclaw, an AI executive assistant, is building it to work inside WhatsApp and draw on the full context of users' conversations. The aim is to bring the plans, requests and follow-ups scattered across chats back into view when they need action.

As competitors multiply and AI advances, copying features is easier. Harsha Kumar, a partner at venture capital firm Lightspeed India, in her recent article, argues that speed of execution is paramount in a category with few established moats—companies must roll out capabilities and acquire users quickly. When she wrote this, Instinct's valuation skyrocketed from $50m to $2.5 billion in four months, before a public launch. In an essay on Muse, Julie Zhuo, founder of Sundial (an agentic analytics platform), offers a user-side test about how speed alone may not impress. An agent earns its aha moment when it takes on the unglamorous tasks people keep putting off.

THE PERSONAL DATA PARADOX

Yet, using an assistant does not mean granting it unrestricted access. Jain confines his use to publicly available information. "Still don't trust AI tools with my credentials of any kind," he says. Sandilya draws the line at sharing credit card information. On the other hand, Saxena has accepted that greater usefulness requires sharing more data and permissions.

A recent Instinct scare made the danger harder to ignore. A user shared screenshots that appeared to show the assistant describing another person's financial document in his chat. Founder Noah Shinn said the response was a hallucination, though he did not explain how he established that. Meta says Muse lets users control access to connected services and asks for permission before carrying out sensitive actions, including purchases and sending emails. Users can opt out of having interactions used to train its models.

Instinct is free for now, dots is available in ChatGPT's pro plan (₹10,699), while Faff starts at ₹1,999 a month, and Muse offers free access for everyday use alongside paid plans for heavier tasks. Converting free users to paying ones will hinge on brand loyalty built from repeated context, negligible follow-ups, and end-to-end privacy.

Shalaka Kulkarni (@shalakulkarni) is a Bengaluru-based author.

KNOW YOUR AI ASSISTANT

INSTINCT: Messaging-native personal assistant from Spear Street Technology

DOTS: OpenAI's persistent agents in ChatGPT, working across connected apps

MUSE: Meta's personal AI agent, available through WhatsApp and dedicated app

FAFF: A WhatsApp assistant from Faff Technologies for bookings, everyday admin

PERISCLAW: AI assistant from Hushlabs Holdings works within the user's WhatsApp account

There is no easy way to defend smart glasses

Trying out a pair of smart, sporty sunglasses throws up many surprises

Shrenik Avlani
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Last November several runners and cyclists in India were genuinely excited about the Oakley Meta Vanguard. The AI-powered smart sunglasses were integrating Garmin and Strava—the two most popular products among those who live the active life, including recreational and professional athletes. For a pair of sports goggles priced at ₹52,300, the endurance sports community was the perfect target audience, happy as they are to spend astronomical amounts of money on their hobby.

However, the Oakley Meta Vanguard ran into a bit of bad luck in India as the sunglasses arrived here only in the second quarter of 2026, while it was launched worldwide towards end of last year. In the interim, Meta's smart glasses made the headlines for all the wrong reasons, and ended up earning themselves the unenviable nickname of "Perv Glasses." Despite all this, I was curious about the sports app integration and used the Oakley Meta Vanguard for a couple of months.

HOW DOES IT WORK?

The AI-powered Vanguard sunglasses have the unmistakable sporty design that Oakley is known for. It's a wrap-around one-piece visor running across the width of the face with a notch on the nose bridge where the camera sits. It also holds a white LED light next to the camera that glows whenever a picture is being clicked or a video is being recorded. The stems of the sunglasses are home to speakers, sensors, microphones, touch controls for volume and music playback, and physical buttons to click photos.

> It turns out that smart glasses are not so smart unless they are tethered to a smart phone

NOT SO SMART

I downloaded the Meta AI app on my phone, paired the smart Oakleys and set them up as instructed. I had already connected my Garmin and Strava accounts to my Meta AI account during the set-up and downloaded the Meta AI app on my Garmin watch. I went for my run with my Garmin and the smart sunglasses. I thought the Vangaurds would tell me the pace, distance run, or elapsed time. It did none of that. When I enquired about my pace, it played a chime and asked me to connect my phone and open the Meta AI app. I tried playing music from my Garmin, but my smart glasses, and by extension its speakers, weren't connected to my watch so I couldn't.

Turns out the Oakley Meta Vanguard glasses are not so smart without a phone to be tethered to. The only thing it can do without the phone is click pictures and record videos. The Garmin and Strava integration is not in real time either. What actually happens is that Meta AI pulls the workout details from Strava and Garmin and then lets you superimpose the statistics on pictures/videos taken during the overlapping time.

So, if you are planning to buy sporty smart sunglasses remember that they are only as smart as the app on your phone.

Shrenik Avlani is a freelance writer and editor.

REVIEW I APPLE WATCH SERIES 12

Is this new smartwatch worth the hefty investment?

The Apple Watch Series 12 offers more granular health tracking and a 'Readiness' score for you to plan your activities

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Your wrist is prime real estate, and Apple knows it. Year after year, it has to make a convincing case for keeping the Apple Watch strapped on, especially as it faces competition from adventure-focused wearables, a new wave of screenless trackers and, for some, a return to good old-fashioned timepieces. The Apple Watch Series 12 (₹56,900 onwards) has its work cut out, particularly when its predecessor already got most of the fundamentals right. The Series 12 doesn't reinvent the wheel, but offers better health insights, and quality-of-life tweaks. But are they enough to make this year's Watch tick?

WHAT'S DIFFERENT?

You'd be hard-pressed to tell the Series 12 apart from its predecessor. The core Apple Watch essentials remain unchanged, as does the overall 42mm/46mm design, save for a slightly larger watch casing. Notably, the display itself retains the same size and pixel resolution, which makes the bezels appear more pronounced (pro tip: choose a lighter case).

There's a new Dark Bronze aluminum finish that, paired with the right band, looks surprisingly posh. It's the sort of combination you could comfortably wear to a formal dinner without looking like you've just finished a run. The stunning new Pearl White Ceramic case marks a return to the material for the first time since the Series 5, and at ₹124,900, it's aimed squarely at the fashion-conscious and the well-heeled.

Depending on which model you pick up, you get the tougher Ceramic Shield 2 glass or the sapphire crystal protection on the always-on, 2000-nit (peak brightness) LTPO3 OLED display, and water resistance is rated at 50 meters.

Underneath the familiar exterior, though, Apple has made the most consequential internal changes to its smartwatch in years, starting with a completely redesigned heart rate sensor array on the back of the watch. It moves up from the old two-petal layout to a 32-petal design with a second-generation electrical heart sensor, ring-arranged photodiodes, larger and more efficient green LEDs, and a larger electrode contact area for ECG readings. Coupled with the new S11 chip, the increase in data resolution is dramatic, with background heart rate checks now happening every five seconds, whether you're working out or sitting at your desk, compared to roughly every five minutes on prior models when stationary. Heart rate variability (HRV) readings are also more granular, giving the Watch a more detailed picture of how your body responds to stress, activity and rest.

All of this data feeds into the new Readiness score, a 0-10 measure that combines a week's worth of sleep, recent activity, training load and health metrics. This helps you decide if you should push yourself, take things easy or perhaps take some time off! It's a useful addition, particularly if you've ever stared at a wall of health statistics wondering what any of them actually mean.

The Readiness score puts Apple in direct competition with the likes of the Oura Ring and the Whoop band. Of course, as with all scores, it's best used as a guide, not a medical verdict. Step tracking is also more accurate than before on distance measurements during indoor walks, as is the GPS-based outdoor tracking.

PERFORMANCE, AI AND BATTERY

The S11 chip ensures that watchOS 27 on the Watch Series 12 remains snappy in use, despite it collecting all of that extra data in the background. Meanwhile, the new Siri AI brings personal context understanding and broader world knowledge to the Apple Watch, much in the same way as it has on iPhone models.

There's a new Audio Intelligence-branded suite of always-listening features specific to this generation (Series 12 and Watch Ultra 4) that courted some privacy concerns at launch. The Live Rewind feature, for instance, which shows you a text transcription of the last 15 seconds of audio, or Siri Recap which can generate conversation summaries in the Siri app. Both features are opt-in and will roll out in beta later this year, so I can't yet speak to their accuracy or effectiveness.

More handy today is the faster Music Recognition feature or the Sound Recognition feature that alerts users with hearing impairment to sirens, alarms, doorbells and the like.

Battery life remains unchanged. A normal use will get you a day's worth of use, although the Watch can go longer, upto 10 hours, on GPS-enabled workouts. A zero-to-80-percent charge in 20 minutes ensures that you can keep the watch on for sleep tracking and wear it to work the next day with just a quick top-up.

VERDICT

At ₹56,900 onwards, the Series 12 is a substantial investment, and one that makes the most sense for owners of older Apple Watches. A few generations of upgrades should add up to a noticeably better experience, with more comprehensive health tracking, polished software and the seamless iPhone integration that remains Apple's biggest trump card.

Tushar Kanwar is a tech columnist and commentator, and tweets @2shar.

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...continued from previous page.

2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

(1) *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

(2) *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

(3) *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail:
mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000**; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000**; BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000**; Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183**; BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000**; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999**; CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050**; DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500**; Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000**; HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233**; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289**; ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100**; IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728**; Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000**; JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030**; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000**; SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807**; UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000**; and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000**; Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400**, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 21, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, or (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.